BUILDER BRIGADE

HOMEBUILDING HELP FOR HOMEOWNERS

the ULTIMATE HOME BUILDING ✓checklist

HOMEOWNER EDITION

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Congratulations on Your Future New Home!

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST:

1 **Pick your selections** → Circle, highlight, or write notes in the "Notes" column.

2 **Cross off what doesn't apply** → Keep it clean and personal to your build. Note: If you bought the editable version (Word/Excel), just delete rows to make it your own. Click Here

3 **Share it with your builder** → Align expectations and get accurate pricing up front.

4 **Follow by phase** → As your house goes up, the checklist is in order of construction phases so you can confirm your choices are installed at the right stage.

5 **No surprises later** → This keeps features from being forgotten or added too late (save on those expensive change orders).

*Some items may be duplicated because they apply to multiple categories.

LEGEND

(I) = Images **(V)** = Video **(L)** = Link **(P)** = Product

*Some are affiliate links which I may receive a commission at no additional cost to you

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Choose Your Selections

	Checklist Items	Notes
Land Clearing		
☐	**Extra Parking** (I) (V) Clear 10' x 20' per vehicle for daily use or guest parking. Helps avoid parking on grass or blocking the main drive.	
☐	**Flag Trees To Keep** (I) (P) Mark trees you want to keep before clearing starts. Once they're gone, they're gone! Ask your builder what color to use.	
☐	**Future Structures** (I) (L) ➔ *Detached Building / Shed / Garden / Green House / Outdoor Sauna* Clear for future structures. It'll be significantly more expensive after the house is built.	
☐	**Alternate Driveway** (I) Clear for guest houses, detached garage, workshops, rental units, or large vehicle access.	
☐	**Extra Gravel for Driveway Base** (I) (V) Spread extra gravel early to reduce mud, keep the job site cleaner, and give contractors a solid place to park and work. Over time, the gravel compacts and creates a strong base for your permanent driveway.	
☐	**50' Minimum Tree Clearance** (I) (V) Consider at least 50' between trees and any structure to avoid root damage, falling limbs or trees, and constant leaf cleanup.	
☐	**Future Tree Issues** (I) Remove trees that may need to come down in the next 10 years due to growth, health issues, or proximity to the house. Much easier and less expensive to do before construction.	
Foundation		
☐	**Foundation Type** (I) (L) ➔ *Slab / Crawlspace (Pier & Beam) / Basement* Slab: Cheapest and fastest, but no access under the house. Great for warm climates, not so great if you want storage or easy plumbing repairs. Crawlspace (Pier & Beam): Keeps the house off the ground, gives access to pipes/wiring, but needs moisture control to avoid mold. Basement: Adds living/storage space and boosts resale, but costs more and needs good waterproofing to avoid leaks.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Crawlspace (Pier & Beam)		
☐	**Concrete Crawlspace** (I) (V) (L) A concrete crawlspace floor is a high-end upgrade, almost like pouring a second foundation. It solves moisture issues and makes the space clean, dry, and usable. You can even roll under the house on a mechanic's creeper. Expensive, but a serious improvement.	
☐	**Encapsulation** (I) (V) (L) Encapsulation seals the entire crawlspace with a plastic heavy vapor barrier on the ground and walls, often paired with closed vents and a dehumidifier. Blocks moisture, improves interior air quality, and protects your home from mold, rot, and pests. Highly recommended for long-term durability.	
☐	**Crawlspace Plastic** (I) (L) Not needed if you're fully encapsulating (recommended), but if not, a plastic should still be laid over the soil. It helps reduce ground moisture and lowers the risk of mold, rot, and musty air in the crawlspace.	
☐	**Crawlspace Vent Material:** (I) → *Plastic Vent / Metal Vent* Plastic vents are low-maintenance and won't rust, great for hidden areas. Metal vents are stronger and more durable, better for visible spots where appearance matters. Both can be built into veneer walls.	
☐	**Hidden Crawlspace Vents** (I) (V) Crawlspace vents can be built into the veneer wall for a seamless exterior look and include interior dampers so you can close them seasonally. Helps control airflow and moisture without affecting curb appeal.	
☐	**Automated Crawlspace Vents** (I) (P) Automatic crawlspace vents open and close based on temperature. No need to adjust manually. They help regulate moisture and airflow year-round without homeowner intervention.	
☐	**Interior Perimeter French Drain** (I) (V) A trench is dug along the inside edge of the crawlspace with a perforated pipe surrounded by gravel. The gravel collects water and directs it into the pipe, which drains to a sump pump or out through a sloped pipe. Keeps the crawlspace dry and reduces moisture under the house.	
☐	**Dehumidifier** (I) (P) (L) Highly recommended for sealed or encapsulated crawlspaces. With vents closed off, a dehumidifier controls moisture to prevent mold, rot, and musty smells. Helps protect framing, insulation, and anything stored underneath.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Basement		
☐	**Basement Type:** (I) ➔ *Walkout / Full / Partial / Storm Shelter* Basement options include walkout (built into a slope with exterior access), full (same size as the main floor with full-height ceilings), partial (covers only part of the home, often paired with a crawlspace), and storm shelter (a reinforced area for tornado protection).	
☐	**Basement Finish:** (I) ➔ *Fully Finished / Partially / Unfinished* Basement finishes range from unfinished (exposed concrete and framing) to fully finished with drywall, flooring, and livable space. You can also choose partially finished where some areas are complete and others left open for storage or utilities.	
☐	**Basement Wall Waterproofing** (I) (V) (L) Before backfilling, basement walls should be sealed with a rubber membrane and covered with a dimple mat. The membrane blocks surface water, and the dimple mat helps it drain away. Together, they protect against water intrusion and long-term damage, and can only be installed during construction.	
☐	**Basement Ceiling Height** (I) Finished basements typically require 7’ minimum height, but taller feels better and helps resale. Watch for dropped beams and ducts that can cut into headroom.	
☐	**Garage Door Entry** (I) Walkout basement with a garage door provides easy access to lawn equipment, tools, or bulky items. Ideal if you’re using the space as a workshop, storage area, or need direct exterior access without going through the main house.	
☐	**Basement Egress Window** (I) Required for any basement being used as bedroom or living space. Provides emergency escape and natural light. Local codes vary, but standard minimums are 20”×24” window and a sill no higher than 44".	
☐	**Oversized Opening to Outdoors** (I) (L) Creates a large, open connection between the basement and outdoor areas like a patio, pool, or backyard. Can be done with sliding doors, folding glass walls, or oversized windows that fully open. Adds light, ventilation, and indoor-outdoor flow.	
☐	**Basement Slide** (I) Built-in slide for fun, fast access from upstairs to the basement. Great for kids, playrooms, or just adding a unique feature to your home. Can be done alongside stairs or hidden behind a wall panel.	
☐	**Wood Stove** (I) Radiates steady heat and warms the basement efficiently even during power outages. Heat can rise and help warm upper floors if airflow is managed. Must be properly vented and installed to code for safety.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Slab		
☐	**Slab Type** (I) (L) ➔ *Monolithic / Stem Wall / Post Tension* Monolithic: slab and footings are poured together in a single pour with thickened edges, ideal for flat lots and stable soil. Stem wall slab: poured in two stages, with footings and short foundation walls formed first, then the slab inside, better for sloped lots or areas needing elevation. Post-tension slabs use steel cables tightened after the concrete cures to reduce cracking, often used in regions with expansive or unstable soils.	
☐	**Slab High Spots** (I) Check for uneven or raised areas in the slab that could cause issues with flooring. High spots may need to be ground down or chipped flat before finishes go in. After a light rain, watch where water pools to spot low areas.	
☐	**Slab Control Joints** (I) (L) Shallow cuts are made in the slab, usually within 6 to 12 hours after the pour to control where cracks form as the concrete cures. If you don't see them marked or cut shortly after the pour, ask your builder. They give concrete a place to crack out of sight, essential for garages and visible areas.	
☐	**Slab Utilities** (I) (L) Electrical conduit and plumbing embedded in the slab can't be moved later without cutting concrete. Plan carefully for things like kitchen islands, floor outlets, outdoor kitchens, and future additions to avoid expensive changes down the road.	
Misc. Foundation		
☐	**Foundation Drainage** (I) Exterior french drains collect and redirect groundwater away from the foundation. Installed below grade with a perforated pipe surrounded by gravel, they help prevent basement flooding, crawlspace moisture, and foundation damage. Most effective when paired with proper grading.	
☐	**Sump Pump** (I) (V) Automatically pumps out water that collects under your home in the basement or crawlspace. Keeps the area dry to help prevent mold, rot, and structural damage. Sits in a pit and kicks on by itself when water builds up. Especially important in wet climates or homes with drainage issues.	
☐	**Storm Shelter** (I) (L) Whether you're installing a pre-made unit or building one on site, most storm shelters need a thicker, reinforced concrete base to anchor properly. This often means extra rebar or deeper footers beyond a standard slab.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Heavy Load Support** (I) If you're installing something extremely heavy, like a large safe or aquarium, the floor may need added support. That could mean extra joists or piers underneath, especially for upstairs rooms. Easier to build it in now than try to reinforce later.	
Exterior Walls		
☐	**Exterior Wall Type:** (I) (V) → *Cinder Block / Wood Framing / Insulated Concrete Forms (ICF) / Structural Insulated Panels (SIPs)* Choose block for durability, wood for affordability and flexibility, ICF for superior insulation, and SIP for energy efficiency and fast construction.	
☐	**Exterior Wall Stud Size:** (I) (V) (L) → *2x4 Exterior / 2x6 Exterior* 2x4 walls are standard and offer lower cost. 2x6 walls offer better insulation, strength, and energy efficiency.	
☐	**Exterior Wall Stud Spacing** (I) (V) (L) → *16" OC / 24" OC* 16" on center (OC) is the standard. 24" OC is called advanced framing, a system that uses fewer studs, aligns with trusses and openings, and reduces thermal bridging for better energy efficiency. It saves on material but requires careful planning to do it right.	
☐	**Exterior Sheathing Thickness:** (I) → *3/8" Sheathing / 1/2" (7/16") Sheathing / 5/8" Sheathing* 1/2" is standard and works well. Thicker sheathing (5/8"+) adds strength, better fastener grip, and a flatter surface for siding.	
☐	**Exterior Sheathing Material** (I) → *Zip System / Plywood Sheathing / OSB Sheathing / Structural Weather Barrier (SWB)* Choose ZIP System for built-in moisture protection and faster install. Use plywood for added strength and durability. Go with OSB for a budget-friendly option. Avoid ultra-thin structural weather barriers unless cost is top priority.	
☐	**Exterior Wrap** (I) → *Traditional house wrap / Zip System* Seals the outside of the home to block water, drafts, and mold. House wrap is applied over sheathing and taped. ZIP System combines both in one panel, installs faster, and offers better long-term protection, but it costs more.	
☐	**Roll the Zip Tape** (I) (V) (L) If using the Zip System, zip tape must be rolled to activate the adhesive. It's required for water sealing and warranty coverage. Skipping it risks leaks and denied warranty claims.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Alternative Wall Sheathing** (I) (V) Not all homes are built with plywood or OSB on the exterior walls. Some builders use structural wall panels made of fiberboard, cardboard-like material, or even foam. These can meet code if installed properly, but they don't offer the same strength or durability. Ask early if your builder is using these so you're not surprised when materials show up on site.	
Exterior Continuous Insulation		
☐	**Insulated Sheathing (Zip-R)** (I) (L) Plywood with rigid foam attached to the back. Installs on the exterior framing to create a continuous insulation layer. Doesn't replace in-wall insulation, just improves energy efficiency by reducing heat loss through studs.	
☐	**Rigid Foam Board** (I) Rigid foam panels added over exterior sheathing. Similar to Zip-R, but installed as a separate layer. Creates continuous insulation over studs to reduce heat loss. Still used with standard sheathing and in-wall insulation.	
☐	**Mineral Wool Board** (I) (L) Rigid insulation made from stone wool. Installed outside the sheathing to add a continuous thermal layer. Fire-resistant, water-resistant, and great for soundproofing. Heavier than foam board and often paired with a gap behind the siding to let water drain and air flow (called a rain screen).	
☐	**Exterior Insulation and Finish System (EIFS)** (I) A system that adds foam insulation to the outside of the house, then covers it with a synthetic stucco finish. Looks like real stucco but adds insulation value. Common on commercial buildings and modern homes. Not typically used with wood siding or brick.	
Framing		
☐	**Bottom Plate Sealing** (I) (V) Seals the bottom plate to block air, moisture, and pests. Best: Foam gasket. Alternative: caulk or spray foam.	
☐	**Advantech Subfloor Panels** (I) More durable than OSB. Reduces squeaks and handles rain without swelling or delaminating. Often worth the upgrade if you want a more solid-feeling floor.	
☐	**Interior Wall Stud Spacing:** (I) (V) → *16" OC /24" OC* 16" on center (OC) is the standard spacing for interior wall studs, providing optimal strength and support. 24" OC, known as advanced framing, uses fewer studs to save materials but can result in wavy drywall and less secure mounting for heavy items.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Wall Blocking** (I) (V) (L) ➔ *Curtain Rods / Heavy Pictures / TV Mounts / Towel Rods / Porch Swing / Outdoor Hose Reel / Toilet Paper Holder / Toilet Grab Bars / Speaker Mounts / Stair Handrail / Shower Grab Bars / Shower Glass / Thermostat / Paper Towel Mount / Floating Shelves / Behind Door Handles / Doorbell (Stucco House) / Baby Gate (stairs and kitchen) / Tesla Power Wall Mount / Kitchen Cabinets / Garage Door Opener / Fireplace Mantle / Barn Door Tracks / Surveillance Cameras / Vanity Mirror* Install wood blocking between studs for mounting TVs, shelves, handrails, or anything heavy. Eliminates the need for drywall anchors. Measure the height and film or photograph before drywall so you can easily find them later.	
☐	**Stud Quality** (I) (V) (L) Avoid using studs that are excessively bowed, twisted, or crowned, as these can cause uneven walls, difficulty in drywall installation, and structural weaknesses. Select straight, true studs to ensure smooth construction and long-term stability.	
☐	**Covering Trusses and Lumber** (I) (V) Cover trusses and lumber with plastic sheeting to protect them from moisture and weather exposure. Some builders pre-cover, but since trusses often sit outdoors for months, additional protection helps prevent warping, mold, and damage, ensuring better structural integrity upon installation.	
☐	**Webbed Floor Trusses** (I) Allows easier routing of plumbing, HVAC, and electrical systems while supporting longer spans. They reduce the need for soffits and provide flexibility in open floor plans. Coordination between trades during rough-in is key.	
☐	**Exterior House Wrap Integrity** (I) (V) Ensure there's no ripped or missing exterior house wrap to maintain effective moisture and air barriers. For Zip System panels, all seams should be properly sealed with manufacturer-approved tape to prevent water intrusion and air leaks, preserving the building envelope's performance.	
☐	**Pipe/Wire Protection Plates** (I) (V) Pipe/wire protection plates (also called nail plates) should be installed during framing and before drywall. They act as a barrier, preventing nails and screws from penetrating electric wires or plumbing lines.	
Ceilings		
☐	**First Floor Ceiling Height:** (I) ➔ *8' / 9' / 10' / 12' / 14'* 9' is the standard for first floors. 10'-12' is even better but raises costs and impacts windows, doors, cabinets, and overall proportions. Make your decision early, changing this later affects everything.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Second Floor Ceiling Height:** (I) → *8′ / 9′ / 10′* Taller ceilings upstairs can make rooms feel more open and reduce the “builder-grade” look. Standard is 8’, but many upgrade to 9’ for better resale and overall feel. Ceiling height impacts window height and door size.	
☐	**Shade Pockets** (I) (V) (L) Built-in pockets hide motorized or manual shades in the ceiling or behind trim for a clean look.	
☐	**Doorway Arches** (I) Used in entryways or transitions between formal and informal spaces to add architectural interest. Consider ceiling height and room proportions to ensure the arch enhances flow without overwhelming the space.	
☐	**Barrel Ceiling** (I) Best for hallways, entryways, or large rooms to add architectural drama and a sense of spaciousness. They suit spaces with higher ceilings and can highlight focal areas.	
☐	**Tray Ceiling(s)** (I) Ideal for master bedrooms, dining rooms, or living areas to add depth and elegance. Add cove lighting to enhance ambiance by softly illuminating the ceiling recesses.	
☐	**Coffered Ceiling:** (I) → *Painted Trim / Drywall / Exposed Beam* These ceilings suit formal spaces like dining rooms, living rooms, or offices, adding architectural interest and elegance.	
Attic		
☐	**Catwalks** (I) (V) (L) Catwalks provide safe, stable pathways to access main attic areas without stepping on insulation or damaging the ceiling below.	
☐	**Access Door Size** (I) (L) The larger the opening, the easier it is to move belongings in and out. Ensure the framing accommodates insulated, sealed doors to prevent air leaks and maintain energy efficiency.	
☐	**Attic Flooring** (I) (V) Consider inexpensive or leftover flooring like vinyl or laminate. Keeps it clean and reduces messy attic plywood particles from being tracked back into the house.	
☐	**Attic Plywood for Storage** (I) Ask to utilize extra plywood in the attic for additional storage. Properly framed and supported, it distributes weight safely without damaging insulation.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Pest Control		
☐	**Bottom Plate Sealing for Air Gaps and Bugs** (I) (V) (L) Sealing the bottom plate where it meets the foundation or slab prevents air leaks and blocks entry points for insects and pests. Use appropriate sealants or foam to fill gaps, enhancing energy efficiency and pest control. Proper sealing is essential for a tight, durable building envelope.	
☐	**In-Wall Pest Control** (I) (V) (L) (L) In-wall pest control involves sealing gaps and openings within wall cavities to prevent insects and rodents from entering. Use pest-resistant barriers, seal around plumbing and wiring penetrations, and install mesh screens where vents or openings exist. Incorporating treatments during framing helps maintain a pest-free home long-term.	
☐	**Bora-Care Termite Treatment to Bottom of Wall Framing** (I) (L) Applying Bora-Care termite treatment to the bottom of wall framing provides long-lasting protection against wood-destroying insects. This borate-based treatment penetrates wood fibers, preventing termite infestation without harmful residues. Apply during framing for effective, proactive pest control integrated into the building process.	
☐	**Boric Acid on Bottom Plate of Framing** (I) (V) (P) (L) Applying boric acid to the bottom plate during framing provides a pest control measure for the life of your home. As a natural insecticide, boric acid penetrates wood to prevent termite and pest infestations. Combined with treatments like Bora-Care, it enhances long-term protection and durability of the structure.	
Misc Framing		
☐	**Fridge Recess for Flush Fit** (I) (V) (L) 2x6 wall with recessed cavity lets a standard-depth fridge slide back and sit flush with cabinets.	
☐	**Recessed Dryer Vent Mounted Up 6"** (I) Mounting the recessed dryer vent 6" above the floor allows easier access and helps prevent lint buildup near the floor level. This positioning improves airflow efficiency, reduces fire risk, and provides room for seamless floor trim. Ensure proper framing to securely support the vent and maintain wall integrity.	
☐	**2x6 Wall for Recessed Dryer Vent** (I) Using a 2x6 wall provides enough depth for a deeper recessed dryer vent, allowing your dryer to sit flush against the wall without crimping the hose. This framing choice protects the vent, ensures efficient airflow, and creates a clean, streamlined look. Verify structural integrity when modifying wall thickness.	
☐	**Garage Depth for Full-Size Vehicles** (I) (V) (L) Minimum 24' fits most trucks/SUVs without blocking the door. 26'+ gives extra room to move around the vehicles.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Window and Door Headers Alignment** (I) (V) (L) Window and door headers should be installed at the same height, creating a straight, level line across openings. This alignment enhances aesthetics and simplifies drywall and trim installation, resulting in a cleaner, more professional finish.	
☐	**Correcting Missed Nails "Shiners"** (I) (V) (L) Replace large sections of missed nails, or "shiners", with properly driven nails that fully penetrate studs or rafters. Secure fastening ensures structural integrity, prevents movement or squeaks, and maintains overall framing strength.	
☐	**Subfloor Fastening: Screws and Adhesive** (I) (V) (L) Use screws and adhesive instead of nails on subfloors to reduce squeaks and improve fastening strength. Screws offer better holding power, and adhesive bonds the subfloor to joists for added stability and noise reduction. This combination creates a quieter, more durable floor system.	
☐	**Oversized Hallways** (I) Wider hallways enhance flow, accessibility, and visual openness throughout the home. They accommodate furniture movement, strollers, and mobility aids more easily. Common widths range from 42" to 48"+ for a spacious feel.	
☐	**Christmas Tree Closet** (I) (V) (L) A small, dedicated storage space designed to neatly store holiday decorations like trees and ornaments. Efficient framing and shelving maximize vertical space while maintaining easy access. Proper ventilation and lighting help protect stored items from moisture and damage.	
☐	**Central Vacuum System** (I) (L) Features a collection canister usually in the garage or basement, with PVC tubing to wall suction points or retractable hoses in the living areas. Benefits include no exhaust dust/smell recirculation, more power, quieter operation, and longer life compared to portable vacuums. Tubing should be installed before insulation, but after plumbing and ductwork. Electrician should plan for a dedicated outlet at the canister location.	
☐	**Slideaway Safe (Picture Frame)** (I) (V) (L) (L) A slideaway safe disguised as a picture frame offers discreet, secure storage for valuables. These safes are mounted between studs so the mirror sits tight against the wall. Framing must allow smooth sliding action and conceal locking mechanisms.	
☐	**Hidden Room** (I) (V) (L) Requires precise framing to conceal entrances within walls, often disguised as bookshelves, closets, or panels. Carefully plan door location and door type to ensure smooth, discreet access without drawing attention. Maintain structural integrity and incorporate electrical, lighting, and ventilation systems early to keep the space comfortable and functional while preserving secrecy.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Safe Door Reinforcement** (I) Strengthen framing around the safe entrance to support its weight and resist forced entry. Ensure the door frame can handle a heavy safe door with reinforced headers, studs, and secure anchors. This maintains security without compromising wall stability.	
☐	**Budget Friendly Safe Room** (I) (V) (L) Build a cost-effective safe room using 2x6 studs spaced 8” on center with ¾” plywood for sturdy walls. Reinforce key areas like doors with steel plates and secure locks.	
☐	**Pressure-Treated Plywood on Bottom 2’ of Exterior Sheathing** (I) Installing PT plywood on the bottom 2' of exterior sheathing is not required but a good idea when the sheathing touches concrete. It protects against moisture, termites, and ground contact damage, extending the building’s lifespan by reinforcing vulnerable areas prone to water exposure and pest intrusion.	
☐	**Transfer Grilles** (I) (V) (L) Allows air to move between rooms when doors are closed, preventing pressure buildup, door slamming, and uneven temps. Best option is a dedicated return duct in each room. If that's not in the budget a transfer grille may be used.	
☐	**Built-In Storage for Unused Areas** (I) (V) (L) Maximizes functionality by utilizing awkward or small areas like under stairs or between studs. Custom framing and shelving create organized, accessible storage while maintaining clean lines.	
☐	**Access Door to Possible Unused Storage Areas** (I) (V) (L) Install access doors in walls or ceilings to reach unused storage spaces efficiently. Framing must accommodate door size while maintaining structural support. Concealed or flush-mounted doors help preserve aesthetics while providing practical storage access.	
☐	**Built-In Knee Wall Storage** (I) (V) Built-in storage within knee walls utilizes otherwise wasted space, ideal for bedrooms or attics with sloped ceilings. Custom framing creates shelves or cabinets that fit snugly, maximizing storage without intruding into living areas.	
☐	**Under Stair Access** (I) (V) Often closed off, under-stair space can be made usable by adding a door or access panel. Plan this early, before drywall installation, to keep the area accessible. Frame openings with reinforced headers to maintain stair integrity and ensure doors blend seamlessly with surrounding walls for a clean, functional storage solution.	
☐	**Laundry Chute** (I) (V) (L) Convenient drop zone to the laundry area. Can go between floors or two nearby first-floor rooms. Plan early to avoid framing conflicts. A lockable door is recommended if children are present.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Wall Niches/Art Niches** (I) Create recessed spaces for decor, storage, or displays without protruding into rooms. Proper framing ensures structural support around the niche and allows for electrical or lighting integration. Finish niches with materials that complement surrounding walls for a polished look.	
☐	**Shower Niches** (I) Offer recessed storage for toiletries, keeping the shower area organized and clutter-free. Proper framing supports waterproofing and durability. Shelves should be slightly sloped to prevent water pooling and mold growth. Avoid placing niches on exterior walls when possible, as this can reduce insulation and cause cold spots. Larger niches provide more storage and flexibility.	
☐	**Shaving Niche** (I) A shaving niche at knee height is great in a shower because it gives you a safe, sturdy spot to rest your foot at a comfortable height, making leg-shaving easier and reducing the need to balance or bend awkwardly.	
☐	**Shower Seat:** (I) (L) → *Bench Shower Seat / Corner Shower Seat / Floating Shower Seat* Corner seats save space with a compact design ideal for smaller areas. Floating seats mount to the wall without floor support, creating an open feel and easier cleaning underneath. Whenever possible, place seats outside the spray area to keep them dry.	
☐	**Solar Panel Friendly Roof** (I) A solar panel friendly roof considers pitch, orientation, and structural reinforcement for added weight. Ideally, it faces south with a slope between 15° and 40° for maximum sun exposure. Use durable, compatible roofing materials and plan roof penetrations and wiring pathways early.	
☐	**Staggered Framing for Noise Dampening and Insulation** (I) (V) (L) Staggered framing offsets wall studs to reduce direct sound transfer between rooms, enhancing noise dampening. This design also allows for thicker insulation, improving thermal performance. It's especially beneficial in shared walls like bedrooms and bathrooms for increased privacy and comfort.	
☐	**Built-In Package Drop Box** (I) (V) (L) (P) Provides secure, weather-resistant storage for deliveries. Framing must accommodate the box's size and weight, ensuring easy access from both outside and inside the home. Proper sealing and durable materials protect contents and integrate the drop box seamlessly with exterior design.	
☐	**Specialty Doors** If you're planning to use specialty doors such as wall-mounted pet doors, pocket doors, Costco-style doors, or oversized openings, be sure to include these items in your floor plan as they require specific framing dimensions and structural adjustments. See the doors section for making these selections.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Film Completed Framing** (I) (V) Capture video of every wall after framing, plumbing, and electrical work are complete but before drywall installation. This creates a valuable reference for locating studs, pipes, wires, or blocking behind the walls later. While primarily used in construction documentation, it also provides clear visual records.	
☐	**Final Note** (I) You should see the following once framing is complete (only if applicable): • Ceiling heights • Shower bench seat • Framing blocking/bracing • All window & door locations • Wall niches • Pocket door frame • Laundry chute • Attic flooring • Fireplace • Tray ceilings • Coffered ceilings • Door arches • Barrel ceilings • Half/knee walls • Skylight locations • Porch Swing • Staggered Framing	
Roofing		
☐	**Roof Pitch (Steep): ___/12** (I) (L) → *4/12 / 5/12 / 6/12 / 7/12 / 8/12 / 9/12 / 10/12 / 11/12 / 12/12* Roof pitch refers to the slope of your roof. Steeper pitches (typically 7/12 and up) shed water more effectively and add visual impact but may increase framing and roofing costs. Common steep pitches range from 4/12 to 12/12 - fill in the value that fits your design.	
☐	**Roof Sheathing Material:** (I) → *Plywood Sheathing / OSB Sheathing / Zip Sheathing* OSB is more budget-friendly and widely used, while plywood offers slightly better moisture resistance and strength. A ZIP System roof sheathing combines structural panels and a built-in weather barrier in one product, eliminating the need for separate underlayment. It creates a tighter, more moisture-resistant roof deck, speeding up installation while improving long-term durability and energy efficiency. All are code-compliant and commonly used in residential roofing.	
☐	**Roof Sheathing Thickness:** (I) (V) → *1/2" (7/16") Sheathing / 5/8" Sheathing* Standard roof sheathing is typically 7/16" OSB, suitable for most builds. Upgrading to 5/8" offers added strength, better support for heavier roofing materials, and improved performance in high-wind or snow-prone areas. Some local codes or HOA guidelines may require the thicker option.	
☐	**Radiant Barrier OSB for Roof Sheathing** (I) (L) (L) This sheathing includes a reflective layer that helps reduce attic heat and improve energy efficiency, especially useful in warmer climates. Installs just like standard OSB.	
☐	**Radiant Barrier + Spray Foam** (I) (L) If using radiant barrier OSB, avoid spraying foam insulation directly against it. Without an air gap, the radiant barrier loses its effectiveness, defeating the purpose of using it in the first place.	

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	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Heavier Underlayment** (I) Upgrading to a heavier-duty underlayment (like synthetic or peel-and-stick) offers better protection against moisture, wind, and extreme weather. It's especially useful in storm-prone areas or under metal and tile.	
☐	**Ice and Water Shield - Roof Edges & Valleys** (I) A waterproof barrier that protects against leaks from rain or ice dams. Useful in all climates, especially around edges, valleys, and roof penetrations.	
☐	**Roof Underlayment Check** (I) Underlayment should be securely fastened and fully covering the roof deck. If it's loose or flapping in the wind, it risks tearing or leaving areas exposed to moisture. Check before shingles are installed.	
☐	**Roof Color** (I) Pick a roof color that suits your home's style and climate, light colors reflect heat for warm areas, dark tones add curb appeal in cooler ones. Make sure it pairs well with your siding and trim.	
☐	**Material:** (I) → *Asphalt / Metal / Tile* Asphalt is the most common and cost-effective choice, easy to install and maintain. Metal offers superior durability, energy efficiency, and a modern look. Tile (clay or concrete) adds a high-end, timeless aesthetic and performs well in hot climates, but comes at a higher cost and weight.	
☐	**Asphalt Type:** (I) (V) → *3-Tab / Architectural* Go with architectural (dimensional) shingles. They're the standard for durability, texture, curb appeal, and longer warranties. Traditional 3-tab shingles are still around but mostly for budget jobs or patch repairs not the best long-term choice.	
☐	**Metal Roof: Standing Seam (not exposed fastener)** (I) (V) Standing seam metal roofs feature concealed fasteners for a clean, modern look and long-lasting durability. Unlike exposed fastener systems, they offer better weather resistance and lower maintenance over time.	
☐	**Nail Heads on Finished Roof** (I) All nails should be covered by shingles or properly sealed. Exposed nail heads can rust or let water in, leading to leaks and premature roof wear.	
☐	**Chimney Style** (I) Most common styles are brick, stone, stucco, or modern metal. Choose between traditional full masonry or prefabricated metal flue systems. Style and placement can also impact curb appeal and venting efficiency.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Faux Chimney to Hide Roof Penetrations** (I) A faux chimney can be used to conceal roof penetrations like vents, flues, or exhaust pipes, creating a cleaner, more cohesive roofline. It adds architectural interest without the cost or function of a real chimney.	
☐	**Roof Vent Pipe Boots - Lead vs. Rubber** (I) Lead boots are more durable and hold up better over time, especially in extreme weather. Rubber boots are budget-friendly and easier to install, but they can crack or degrade sooner, especially with sun exposure. Go with lead for long-term performance; rubber works for quick or low-cost installs.	
☐	**Small Roof or Awning Over Exterior Doors** (I) (L) Adds protection from rain and sun, helps prevent water intrusion, and improves durability around door frames. Also adds a finished, architectural touch to your entry.	
☐	**Skylights and/or Solar Tubes** (I) Bring in natural light and reduce daytime energy use. Skylights offer views and ventilation, while solar tubes are compact and ideal for smaller or interior rooms.	
☐	**Kick-Out Flashing** (I) (L) Directs water away from siding where the roof meets a wall, helping to prevent rot and moisture damage behind the exterior. Even if your roof design seems to naturally divert water, kick-out flashing adds an extra layer of protection that's worth having.	
☐	**Toe Boards Removed From Finished Roof** (I) (L) Temporary toe boards used for roof safety should be removed cleanly, nails shouldn't be left behind or driven through finished shingles, as this can lead to leaks and damage. Nail holes need to be filled with a roofing cement or sealant to water leaks.	
Gutters		
☐	**Underground Gutter Drains** (I) (V) Route water away from the foundation for better drainage and a cleaner look. PVC or SDR piping lasts longer than corrugated and is less prone to clogging or crushing. Just be sure there's proper slope and a clear exit point.	
☐	**Gutter Downspout Style:** (I) ➔ *K-Style / Round* K-style downspouts are more common and match modern gutters well. Round downspouts offer a more traditional look and can handle water just as effectively. Go with the style that best fits your home's architecture.	
☐	**Gutter Style:** (I) ➔ *K-Style / Half-Round* Half-round gutters offer a classic, rounded look, great for traditional or historic styles, but may carry less water.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Gutter Size:** (I) ➔ *5" / 6"* 5" gutters are standard for most homes and handle average rainfall well. Upgrade to 6" if you have a larger roof, steep pitch, or live in an area with heavy rain, they carry more water and reduce the risk of overflow.	
☐	**Gutters with Gutter Guards** (I) (L) Add gutter guards to reduce clogs from leaves and debris, especially helpful if you have trees nearby. They cut down on maintenance and help keep water flowing properly, but they're not completely maintenance-free.	
☐	**Wye PVC Connector at Gutter Drain** (I) Adding a Wye fitting at your underground gutter drain gives you easy access to clear clogs if they happen. It's a smart, low-cost way to avoid digging later.	
☐	**Shingle Overhang at Drip Edge (1/2" to 3/4")** (I) Shingles should overhang the drip edge by about ½" to ¾", just enough to direct water into the gutter. Too short can cause water to wick back; too long can lead to sagging or wind damage. Aim for a clean, even edge.	
Siding		
☐	**Siding Material:** (I) (L) ➔ *Brick Siding / Wood Siding / Fiber Cement Siding / Vinyl Siding / Stucco Siding* Vinyl and fiber cement are low-maintenance and budget-friendly, while brick and stucco provide a classic, long-lasting finish. Wood offers natural warmth but requires regular upkeep. Choose based on style, climate, and care preferences.	
☐	**Exterior Brick/Stone Grout Style:** (I) ➔ *Concave Grout / Raked Grout / Deeply Recessed / German Smear / Overgrout* Grout style dramatically impacts the final look of brick or stone siding. Choose based on architectural style, water-shedding needs, and desired visual depth.	
☐	**Siding Color** (I) Color impacts curb appeal, heat absorption, and long-term maintenance. Darker shades can fade faster and retain more heat, while lighter tones reflect sunlight and show less wear. Choose a color that complements your roof, trim, and overall home style.	
☐	**Veneer Wall Material:** (I) ➔ *Brick Veneer / Stone Veneer* Brick and stone are the most common veneer options, offering durability and classic style. Alternatives like manufactured stone or concrete panels can reduce weight and cost.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Veneer Wall Color** (I) Color varies by material, brick, stone, or manufactured options, and plays a major role in overall curb appeal. Natural earth tones offer a timeless look, while grays and blacks lean modern.	
☐	**Veneer Walls:** (I) ➔ *Anchored / Adhered* Anchored veneer uses ties to secure heavier materials like brick with a drainage gap behind. Adhered veneer is lighter and bonded directly with mortar, often used for manufactured stone. Each requires different support and moisture control methods.	
☐	**Fascia Material:** (I) ➔ *Aluminum Fascia / Fiber Cement Fascia / PVC Fascia / Wood Fascia* Aluminum is low-maintenance and resists rot, while PVC offers a clean look and won't warp. Fiber cement is durable and paintable, and wood gives a traditional appearance but requires upkeep.	
☐	**Fascia Color** (I) Fascia boards can blend with the roof, match the trim, or contrast for visual impact. Color choice affects curb appeal and how clean or bold the roofline appears.	
☐	**Soffit Material:** (I) ➔ *Vinyl Soffit / Aluminum Soffit / Wood Soffit / Fiber Cement Soffit* Vinyl and aluminum are low-maintenance and common for vented soffits. Fiber cement offers durability and a clean, paintable surface, while wood adds a traditional look but needs more upkeep.	
☐	**Soffit Color** (I) (L) Typically matched to fascia or trim for a cohesive look, but can also contrast for added depth. Lighter colors brighten shaded eaves, while darker tones blend into modern designs. Choose based on overall exterior palette and desired visual effect.	
☐	**Soffit Type:** (I) ➔ *Vented / Non-Vented* Vented soffits allow airflow into the attic to reduce moisture and regulate temperature, essential for roof health. Non-vented soffits are used in sealed attic designs or specific architectural styles.	
☐	**Rainscreen** (I) A rainscreen creates an airspace between the sheathing and siding, allowing moisture to drain and air to circulate. This prevents trapped moisture, reduces the risk of rot, and extends the life of the exterior. Especially valuable in wet or humid climates and with materials like wood or fiber cement.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Exterior Window and Door Trim Style** (I) Trim style sets the tone for the home's exterior. Options range from simple flush trim to layered, craftsman, or modern profiles. It affects curb appeal and how the siding integrates with windows and doors.	
☐	**Vinyl Siding and Sun Exposure** (I) Darker vinyl colors absorb more heat and tend to fade faster with prolonged sun exposure. Lighter shades better maintain their appearance over time and reduce heat-related warping. A smart choice for long-term curb appeal in sunny climates.	
☐	**Vinyl Siding and Window Reflection** (I) (L) Intense sunlight reflected from neighboring windows, especially low-E glass, can cause vinyl siding to warp or melt. This rare but real issue typically affects homes with close setbacks. Lighter colors and heat-resistant siding can help reduce the risk.	
☐	**Brick Siding Mortar Mix** (I) The sand pile on-site is used for mixing brick mortar and should be kept clean. If dirt or debris mixes in, it can alter the mortar color and affect the uniform look of the brickwork. Protect the pile to ensure consistent results.	
☐	**Protect Veneer Walls During Construction** (I) (L) Cover brick, stone, or other veneer walls with plastic sheeting to prevent staining from mud, mortar splatter, or debris, especially in areas with clay-rich soil. Clay can leave permanent stains that are hard to remove once absorbed.	
☐	**Joint Flashing Behind Siding Butt Joints** (I) Horizontal siding should have joint flashing behind all butt joints (where two seams meet) to prevent water infiltration. This hidden layer protects the sheathing from moisture damage over time.	
☐	**Board & Batten Seams** (I) (V) ➔ *Exposed Seams / Trim Seam* The seams between boards can either be left exposed with metal flashing (Painted) or covered with trim battens for a more finished appearance. Exposed seams show off the panel edges and modern detailing, while trimmed seams hide gaps and protect joints from moisture. Plan your approach early.	
Doors and Windows		
Doors		
☐	**Interior Door Style** (I) Interior doors come in a variety of styles, such as shaker, raised panel, flat panel, or modern flush, each setting a different tone for the space. Choose based on your home's overall design theme and level of formality.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Hidden Murphy Door** (I) (V) (L) A Murphy door doubles as a functional bookcase, cabinet, or panel while concealing a doorway behind it. Ideal for hidden rooms, pantries, or offices. Requires early planning for framing depth, swing direction, and hardware support.	
☐	**Door Stop Style:** (I) (L) → *Floor Mounted Door Stop / Baseboard Mounted / Raised Baseboard (Robot Vacuum Clearance) / Hinge Pin Door Stop / Wall Mounted / Spring Door Stop / Magnetic Door Stop* Each offers different benefits, floor and baseboard stops are sturdy, hinge pin and spring styles are discreet, and magnetic stops can hold the door open when needed. Choose based on door function and room layout. If you go baseboard mounted, consider raising your doorstop for robot vacuum clearance.	
☐	**Costco Door** (I) (V) Provides direct access from the garage to the pantry, making grocery unloading quick and convenient. Plan location, security, and insulation early.	
☐	**Doggy Door (Wall Mounted)** (I) (V) (L) Ideal when no exterior door is available. Ensure proper framing, insulation, and weatherproofing. Install a nearby outlet if planning to use an electronic or microchip-activated pet door.	
☐	**Larger 36" Door Openings** (I) Wider 36" doors improve accessibility, ease furniture moving, and create a more spacious feel. Ideal for main entryways, bedrooms, and areas requiring ADA access. Plan framing accordingly during rough-in.	
☐	**Sliding Barn Door Locations** (I) Identify spots where traditional swinging doors take up too much space, barn doors are ideal for closets, pantries, laundry rooms, and offices. They save space, add style, and require wall clearance for track hardware. Plan early for structural support and switch placement.	
☐	**Pocket Door Locations** (I) (V) Perfect for tight spaces where swing doors aren't practical, ideal for bathrooms, closets, and pantries. Pocket doors slide into the wall cavity, saving floor space and offering a clean look. Plan framing early and avoid placing plumbing, electrical, or switches in the pocket wall.	
☐	**Soft-Close Pocket Doors** (I) (V) Adds a smooth, controlled glide to pocket doors, preventing slamming and reducing wear over time. Ideal for bedrooms and bathrooms where quiet operation matters. Requires compatible framing and early planning to fit the soft-close track system.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Interior Door Height** (I) → *6'8" (80") / 7' (84") / 8' (96") / Custom Height* 6'8" is standard with 8'- 9' ceilings, cheaper and leaves room for tall trim. 8' doors feel more custom and suit tall ceilings but cost more.	
☐	**Interior Door Width** (I) → *30"-32" / 36"* Most interior doors are 30"- 36", with 32" common for bedrooms and bathrooms. 36" feels more open and a must have for accessibility (wheelchair). Closets are often smaller, typically 28".	
☐	**Front Door Window:** (I) → *Sidelites / Transom* Enhance natural light and curb appeal with sidelites (vertical windows beside the door) or a transom (horizontal window above). These features brighten entryways and add architectural interest.	
☐	**Front Door Style and Color** (I) The front door sets the tone for your home's exterior. Choose a style that matches your architecture, modern, craftsman, farmhouse, etc., and a color that complements the overall palette. Consider durability, finish, and whether you want stained wood or painted fiberglass/steel.	
☐	**Front Door Height and Width** (I) (V) Standard doors are 36" wide and 80" tall, but upgrading to 42" wide or 8' tall adds a grander entry feel and improves accessibility. Ensure framing supports the larger size and check clearances for sidelites or transoms.	
☐	**Full-Size Closet Doors** (I) Standard closet doors are often 24"–28" wide, especially in secondary bedrooms or tight spaces. Upgrading to full-size 30" or 32" swing doors gives a more finished look, better access, and matches the feel of main interior doors. Common in primary suites or hall closets.	
☐	**Solid Core Bedroom Door** (I) Consider a solid core door to enhance sound insulation and privacy in bedrooms. It offers a heavier, sturdier feel than hollow core options and reduces noise transfer between rooms. Requires stronger hinges and proper framing support.	
☐	**Magnetic Door Catches** (I) (V) (P) A modern alternative to traditional ball catches, magnetic door catches ensure quiet, smooth closing. Ideal for double doors and closets, they provide a clean, latch-free look and are easy to install.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Lock Front Door After Installation** (I) Ask the builder to keep the front door locked after installation to protect it from damage during construction. This limits contractor traffic through the main entry, preserving the finish and preventing dings, scratches, or dirt.	
☐	**Front Door Security Considerations** (I) (L) If security is a concern, ensure any glass in the front door is tempered for safety. Opt for a transom window without sidelites to limit visibility and potential entry points while still allowing natural light.	
☐	**Spray Foam Around Interior Door Frames** (I) Canned spray foam can be applied to gaps around interior door frames to reduce noise transfer and improve insulation. Helps create a tighter seal, especially when paired with solid core doors. Apply carefully to avoid bowing the frame.	
☐	**Threshold Protection for Sliders and Exterior Doors** (I) (V) (L) Request threshold protection during construction to prevent damage from foot traffic, tools, and weather exposure. Essential for sliding and exterior doors to keep finishes intact until final clean. Options include taped coverings or temporary metal guards.	
☐	**Paint Inside Walls of Pocket Doors Black** (I) For sliding pocket doors, painting the inside of the pocket cavity black helps conceal the unfinished wall surface when the door is open. Prevents a visible raw edge and creates a cleaner, more finished look. Use durable paint rated for interior trim or metal, depending on the cavity material.	
Windows		
☐	**Pane** (I) → *Single Pane / Double Pane / Triple Pane* Single pane offers one layer of glass, is lowest in cost, and has the least insulation. Double pane offers two layers with gas fill, is standard in most homes, and has good energy efficiency. Triple Pane is three layers of glass, has the best insulation (great for extreme weather climates), but some with a higher cost and is heavier.	
☐	**Grid Style** (I) → *GBG / SDL* GBG (Grids Between Glass) Grids are sealed between the glass panes, making them low maintenance, easier to clean, and more cost-effective. SDL (Simulated Divided Lite) Grids are applied to the exterior of the glass, creating a more traditional, high-end look but requiring more maintenance (especially cleaning) and have a higher cost.	
☐	**Smart Window Film** (I) (L) (L) (L) Installed as a film, smart window film turns clear or frosted with a switch, offering instant privacy without blocking natural light. Ideal for bathrooms or street-facing windows. Requires low-voltage wiring and early planning for power access.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Countertop Flush Window** (I) (V) Installed at countertop height, this window creates a clean, seamless look while bringing in natural light above the sink. Ideal for kitchen or bathroom vanities. Requires precise measurements and proper waterproofing at the sill.	
☐	**Kitchen Pass-Through Window to Porch** (I) (L) A pass-through window from the kitchen to the porch enhances the flow for dining and entertaining, making it easy to serve food and drinks outdoors. Ideal for social spaces, especially with sliding or folding window styles. Use weather-resistant materials and plan for counter alignment.	
☐	**Shade Pockets (Hidden Shades)** (I) (L) A recessed area above the window conceals shades for a clean, streamlined look when open. Ideal for modern spaces and large windows, shade pockets keep hardware out of sight. Plan early for pocket depth, wiring (if motorized), and precise alignment with the window frame.	
☐	**Bi-Fold Windows** (I) Bi-fold windows fold and stack to the side, creating a wide opening for direct access from the kitchen to outdoor spaces. Ideal for serving food or drinks, they enhance indoor-outdoor flow and maximize natural light and ventilation. Requires early planning for structural support and smooth track installation.	
☐	**Skylights and/or Solar Tubes** (I) Skylights and solar tubes bring natural light into areas without windows. Skylights offer sky views, while solar tubes brighten small spaces like hallways. In bedrooms, skylights may disrupt sleep if rain noise is an issue. Consider sound sensitivity and room placement before installing.	
☐	**Reflective Privacy Window Film** (I) (V) Reflective window film adds daytime privacy, reduces heat, and improves energy efficiency by reflecting sunlight. It creates a mirrored look from the outside, while maintaining visibility from inside. At night, the effect reverses, making interiors more visible with lights on.	
☐	**Privacy Frosted Window Glass** (I) Frosted glass offers permanent privacy while allowing natural light, making it ideal for bathrooms, closets, and showers. It's a low-maintenance, stylish alternative to curtains or blinds.	
☐	**Window Spacing for King-Size Bed** (I) (V) (L) Plan for 92"–94" of space between windows (inside to inside) to fit a king-size bed comfortably. Measure your furniture to confirm spacing, ensuring balanced placement and optimal natural light without obstructing views or wall space.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Basement Egress Window** (I) If planning to finish the basement as living space, an egress window is required by code. It provides a safe emergency exit, natural light, and ventilation. Ensure proper sizing, placement, and exterior window wells or steps.	
☐	**Closet Windows** (I) Closet windows add natural light and an open feel but may cause fabric fading, heat buildup, and privacy concerns. Consider tinting or frosted glass to protect clothing and maintain privacy while improving ventilation.	
☐	**Pantry Window** (I) A pantry window adds natural light and ventilation, brightening the space and creating an open feel. However, direct sunlight may heat the area or affect food storage, so consider tinted or privacy glass to protect contents and maintain a stable environment.	
☐	**Casement Windows** (I) (L) Casement windows swing open on side hinges and are operated by a crank or handle, offering excellent ventilation and clear views. They seal tightly when closed for improved energy efficiency and are ideal for spots like over kitchen sinks or in narrow wall sections.	
☐	**Casement Window with Slider** (I) (V) A slider style casement window opens easily without a crank, offering quick, smooth operation with fewer moving parts to maintain. It also provides a clean, modern look and allows for effortless ventilation with a simple push or pull. The sliding mechanism is ADA compliant for push and pull weight but confirm with the manufacturer if this is a concern.	
☐	**Window Grid Pattern** (I) (V) (L) (L) Window grids (muntins) add classic or decorative style by dividing glass into smaller panes. Options include colonial, prairie, or custom patterns. Choose between simulated grids on the glass surface or true divided lites for an authentic look.	
☐	**Casement Window with Built-In Shade and Retractable Screen** (I) (L) (L) This casement window features integrated shades and a retractable screen for easy light control and ventilation. Ideal for convenience and clean aesthetics, it eliminates the need for separate window treatments.	
☐	**Window Color** (I) (V) Window color impacts your home's curb appeal and complements exterior finishes. Choose from standard whites and neutrals or bold colors for contrast. Consider durability, fade resistance, and whether the color is on the interior, exterior, or both. If choosing black exterior windows, some people opt for a white interior window. Coordinate with door and trim colors for a cohesive look.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Window Height(s)** (I) Window heights affect natural light, views, and privacy. Standard heights range from 36" to 72", but custom sizes accommodate specific wall layouts or furniture placement. Consider ceiling height and room function when selecting window height for balance and proportion.	
☐	**Sliding Retractable Window Screens** (I) (V) (L) Sliding retractable screens provide insect protection that's only visible when the window is open. Ideal for large or sliding windows, they preserve clear views and offer easy operation.	
☐	**Flex Screen** (I) (V) (L) A FlexScreen is a flexible, frameless window screen that easily bends to fit into window tracks without tools or tabs. It's durable, easy to remove for cleaning, and provides a cleaner, more modern look compared to traditional aluminum-framed screens.	
☐	**Inspect for Cracked or Broken Windows** (I) After the build is complete, thoroughly inspect all windows for cracks or damage. Early detection helps ensure energy efficiency, security, and prevents water leaks.	
Shutters		
☐	**Security Shutters** (I) (V) Common in Europe but rare in the U.S., security shutters provide privacy and protection from break-ins and storms. Typically metal and manual or motorized. Roll-up shades are a more common alternative.	
☐	**Hurricane Shutters:** (I) → *Roll-Up / Accordion / Bahama / Colonial / Storm Panels* These shutters protect windows from high winds, flying debris, and storm damage, with each option varying in ease of use, durability, and appearance. Plan installation based on climate, window type, and style.	
☐	**Decorative Window Shutters** (I) Non-functional and purely aesthetic, decorative shutters enhance exterior style and curb appeal. Available in various styles and materials, they frame windows to add architectural interest without operating as protection.	
Attic		
☐	**Insulated Attic Door** (I) (P) Helps reduce heat loss or gain through the attic access point, improving energy efficiency and comfort. Depending on location you may have pull-down ladders with insulated covers, swing-out doors, or scuttle hole panels with weatherstripping.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Full-Size Attic Staircase** (I) Ideal if you plan to use the attic for storage or future living space. Provides safe, easy access compared to pull-down ladders. Do this if you want regular access or need to move larger items.	
☐	**Standard-Size Attic Door** (I) (V) (L) A full-size (standard-height) door allows you to walk in and out comfortably rather than crouching or climbing through a small access hatch. Makes it easier to carry boxes, decor, or luggage in and out.	
☐	**Lighting** (I) A bulb or LED near the attic entrance usually does the job. Add more lighting if you'll use the space for storage or maintenance. Consider motion sensors for convenience.	
☐	**Attic Flooring (Cat Walk)** (I) Add plywood over joists for safe attic access, and top it with linoleum for added durability, easier cleanup, and a smoother surface for walking or moving boxes.	
☐	**Pulldown Attic Ladder** (I) A compact, fold-away option for occasional attic access. Choose an insulated model for energy savings and sturdy steps if you'll be carrying heavy items up and down.	
☐	**Attic Staircase Hidden in Closet** (I) A full-size staircase tucked inside a closet offers easy, discreet access. Ideal if the attic is used for storage or future living space. Saves hallway space while keeping access out of sight.	
☐	**Attic Lift** (I) (L) (P) A motorized platform that moves items between floors, great for heavy boxes or seasonal storage. Especially helpful for aging homeowners or frequent attic use.	
☐	**Attic Fan with Thermostat** (I) Do this to reduce heat buildup, extend roof life, and improve energy efficiency, especially in warmer climates. Just make sure the attic is properly vented to avoid pulling conditioned air from the house.	
☐	**Heat Detector** (I) (L) A smoke or heat detector in the attic provides early detection of fires that might start in wiring, insulation, or HVAC equipment before smoke reaches living areas. Because attics are dusty and experience extreme temperature swings, a heat detector is often the better choice in this space.	
☐	**Whole House Fan** (I) Pulls in cool outside air and pushes hot air out through the attic, quickly lowering indoor temps. Especially effective in dry climates with cool evenings. Not ideal in humid areas or if outdoor air quality is poor.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Porch		
☐	**Porch Ceiling Material:** (I) ➔ *Wood Ceiling / Vinyl Ceiling / Fiber Cement Ceiling* Choosing the right ceiling material affects durability, maintenance, and appearance. Fiber cement offers excellent moisture resistance and longevity with minimal upkeep. Vinyl is lightweight and low-maintenance but may have limited design options. Wood provides natural warmth and character but requires regular sealing and protection against moisture and insects.	
☐	**Porch Ceiling Color** (I) Choosing the right ceiling color can enhance the porch's ambiance and perceived height. Light, soft colors create an open, airy feel, while darker shades add warmth and intimacy.	
☐	**Spray Foam Porch Roof** (I) (L) Applying spray foam insulation on the underside of the porch roof significantly reduces heat transfer, helping to keep the porch cooler during hot summer months. This can improve comfort and reduce the need for additional shading or cooling measures.	
☐	**Deck Drainage for Dry Space Below** (I) (V) (P) Installing drainage mats or systems under deck boards channels water away into gutters, preventing pooling and moisture buildup. This creates a dry, usable space below. Ideal for patios, storage, or entertaining, while protecting structural elements from rot, mold, and pests.	
☐	**Deck Frame Protection** (I) (P) Joist tape or joist paint can be applied to the tops of joists before installing decking boards, joist tape or paint acts as a moisture barrier that helps prevent water penetration and wood rot. This simple protection extends the lifespan of the deck framing by reducing exposure to rain, sprinklers, and surface runoff.	
☐	**Gas Lanterns** (I) (L) Gas lanterns add classic charm and warm ambiance to porches, enhancing outdoor aesthetics while providing functional lighting. They require proper gas line installation and regular maintenance to ensure safe and reliable operation.	
☐	**Porch Fans** (I) Improves air circulation, helping to keep outdoor spaces comfortable during warm weather and deterring insects. Choose models rated for outdoor use with moisture-resistant finishes and sealed motors.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Porch Floor Material:** (I) (L) → *Concrete Porch Floor / Wood Decking Floor / Brick Porch Floor / Stone Porch Floor / Composite Porch Floor* Selecting the right flooring material balances durability, aesthetics, maintenance, and budget. Concrete offers strength and versatility with options for stamping and coloring. Wood decking provides natural beauty but requires regular upkeep. Brick and stone create timeless, elegant surfaces with excellent durability. Composite decking combines wood-like appearance with low maintenance and weather resistance.	
☐	**Aluminum Plinth Blocks Under Porch Posts** (I) (V) (L) These blocks protect against rot by lifting porch posts off concrete surfaces, preventing moisture wicking into the wood. They can be recessed for a clean look with a small reveal, combining durability with a neat aesthetic while ensuring stable load transfer.	
☐	**Stamped Concrete Design and Color** (I) (L) Stamped concrete enhances porches and walkways with decorative patterns and textures that mimic natural materials like stone or brick. Custom colors and finishes add style and complement the home's exterior. Proper sealing is essential to protect against weathering, stains, and fading.	
☐	**Sealing Stamped Concrete** (I) To maintain color vibrancy and extend lifespan, stamped concrete should be properly sealed after installation. Sealants protect against weathering, staining, and fading, reducing long-term maintenance needs.	
☐	**Built-In Floor Mat at Entryways** (I) (L) Helps trap dirt and moisture before entering the home, improving cleanliness and safety. These mats can be recessed or flush with the surrounding surface for a seamless look and are made from durable, weather-resistant materials suited for outdoor use.	
☐	**Porch Beam Size** (I) (L) Properly sized porch beams are critical to safely support roof loads and maintain structural integrity. Typically, beams are sized to match the width of the posts they rest on, ensuring even load transfer. Dimensions also depend on span length, wood species, and load requirements.	
☐	**Porch Post Material and Color** (I) → *Wood Posts / PVC Posts / Fiberglass Posts / Metal Posts / Screen Post Pillars* Selecting durable materials for porch posts ensures long-lasting support and complements the home's style. Common materials include wood for traditional warmth, fiberglass or PVC for low maintenance, and metal for a modern look. You can also add columns designed specifically for screened in porches if you want to go that route.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Porch Swing Mount** (I) (L) A secure and properly installed porch swing mount is essential for safety and durability. Mounts should be anchored to strong structural elements like ceiling joists, beams, or blocking capable of supporting the swing's weight plus occupants.	
☐	**Screened-In Porch** (I) Options include fixed screens for durable, permanent protection or retractable screens that can be opened or closed as needed for flexibility.	
☐	**Extended Porch Pad for Grill** (I) (L) Extending the porch pad creates a stable, level surface for a grill that can be rolled out into open space when in use. This setup improves safety by keeping the grill off combustible decking and allows flexible placement for cooking and entertaining. Ensure the pad is made of durable, non-combustible materials like concrete or stone.	
Utilities		
☐	**Record Utility Line Locations Before Backfill Occurs** (I) (L) Record a video of all utility line locations: water, gas, electric, septic before they're buried. Some may only be marked with flags or paint, but it's still worth capturing. Doing so will help you avoid damage during future landscaping or digging.	
☐	**Avoid Burying Utility Lines in Future Build Zones** (I) Make sure utility lines like power, water, and cable aren't buried where you might want to build later, like under a future pool, patio, or addition. Planning now avoids costly relocations later.	
☐	**Schedule Internet Installation Early** (I) Contact your internet provider at least 3 months before your expected move-in date. Installs often get delayed, and you don't want to move in without Wi-Fi, it kills happy move-in mood.	
Water		
☐	**Source:** (I) (V) → *City Water* / *Well Water* Know the precise underground path of your main water supply line to the house. This helps prevent accidental damage during landscaping or digging and is vital for repairs or emergency shut-offs.	
☐	**Well Pump Type:** (I) → *Submersible* / *Jet Pump* Submersible - More efficient, quieter, lasts longer. Best for deep wells. Jet - Easier to maintain but less efficient. Best for shallow wells.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Water Meter Size** (I) Verify the home's water meter size meets household demand. Most homes use a 3/4" meter, while larger homes (3,000 sq ft +) or those with multiple bathrooms, irrigation, or a pool may require a 1" meter for proper water pressure and flow.	
Electricity		
☐	**Power Lines:** (I) ➔ *Underground / Power Poles* Determine whether your property receives electrical service via underground cables or overhead power poles. Underground lines offer improved aesthetics and reduced outage risks, while overhead poles are easier to access for repairs. If lines on the street are overhead, power lines can still be ran underground to the home if desired.	
☐	**Location of Power Poles and Lines** (I) Knowing where power poles and overhead lines are situated on or near your property is important for safety, maintenance, and planning landscaping or construction. Avoid planting tall trees or building structures too close to lines to prevent hazards and outages.	
☐	**Location of Utility Meter Box** (I) (V) The placement of the utility meter box should allow easy access for readings, maintenance, and emergency shut-offs.	
☐	**Electrical Amperage** (I) ➔ *200A / 400A* Determine your main electrical service size based on total load (HVAC, appliances, EV chargers, pool equipment, etc.). Most homes use a single 200A panel. Larger homes may require 400A service, which is typically configured as two 200A panels to provide adequate capacity and room for future expansion.	
☐	**Meter Box Color** (I) (V) The color of the electrical meter box can affect heat absorption and durability. Lighter colors may reflect heat better. Confirm if local codes or HOA rules specify color requirements.	
☐	**Supplement with Solar:** (I) (L) ➔ *Solar - Roof Mounted / Solar - In the yard / Solar - Off-site* Solar energy systems can be installed on rooftops, ground-mounted in the yard, or off-site through remote facilities. Each option offers unique benefits and considerations for space, maintenance, and efficiency. Proper planning ensures optimal energy capture, integration with the home's electrical system, and long-term savings.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Gas		
☐	**Propane Tank:** (I) → *Rent / Own* Decide whether to rent a propane tank from a supplier or purchase your own. Renting often includes maintenance and refills but may have contractual obligations, while owning provides full control but requires upkeep and initial investment.	
☐	**Propane Tank:** (I) → *Buried / Above Ground* Tanks can be installed underground for a cleaner look or above ground for easier access and maintenance. Each option has distinct safety, regulatory, and installation considerations, so choose based on property layout, local codes, and personal preference.	
☐	**Type:** (I) (V) → *Natural Gas / Propane* Determine whether your home uses natural gas supplied by a municipal pipeline or propane stored onsite in tanks. Each fuel type has different delivery, storage, and cost considerations affecting appliance compatibility and overall utility management.	
☐	**Gas Meter Size** (I) → *250 CFH / 400 CFH* Verify the gas meter's capacity in cubic feet per hour (CFH) matches total household demand. Standard residential meters supply around 250 CFH, while larger homes or those with multiple gas appliances may require 400 CFH or more.	
Cable/ Internet		
☐	**Additional Service Locations:** (I) → *Detached Garage / Workshop / Pool House* Plan for cable and internet service extensions to outbuildings like detached garages, workshops, or pool houses.	
☐	**Cable/Internet Type:** (I) → *Cable / Fiber / Satellite - Starlink* Choose the internet service type that best fits your location and needs. Cable and fiber offer high-speed, reliable connections with varying availability, while satellite options like Starlink provide coverage in remote areas but may have higher latency and weather sensitivity.	
Waste		
☐	**Waste Type:** (I) → *Public Sewer / Septic System* Determine if your property is connected to a public sewer system or uses a private septic system. Each requires different maintenance, permits, and considerations for waste management and environmental impact.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Septic Tank Size** (I) (V) Tank size is based on bedroom count, not bathrooms or actual occupancy. See the images for a guideline on tank size vs bedroom count. Local code will always be the deciding factor but having some idea is always helpful.	
☐	**Septic Tank Risers** (I) (V) (L) (P) Extensions that bring septic tank access lids to ground level, making inspections and maintenance easier without digging. Risers improve safety and convenience while preserving landscaping.	
☐	**Hide Sewer Cleanout** (I) (P) Consider discreetly locating or screening the sewer cleanout to maintain curb appeal while ensuring easy access for maintenance. Use landscaping or architectural features that don't obstruct access during emergencies.	
☐	**RV Sewer Connection** (I) A dedicated sewer hookup designed to allow easy and sanitary wastewater disposal from recreational vehicles. Ensure proper placement and compatibility with standard RV sewer fittings for convenience.	
Plumbing		
☐	**Conduit in Concrete for PEX (Kitchen Island)** (I) (V) (L) Run PEX through conduit when it's embedded in concrete for a kitchen island, it protects the PEX line and allows for future replacement. Skipping conduit makes repairs much harder if there's ever a leak or issue down the line.	
☐	**Plumbing Type:** (I) (L) → *PEX / CPVC / Copper* PEX is flexible, easy to install, and great for water supply lines. Copper resists UV and bacteria growth, handles high heat and pressure, and is often chosen for premium or long-term builds due to its proven reliability. CPVC works but is more brittle than PEX and can crack over time if exposed to cold or stress. Some plumbers and inspectors strongly discourage CPVC in new construction.	
Water Heater		
☐	**Water Heater Type:** (I) (L) → *Tank / Tankless / Hybrid* Tank heaters store hot water and are cost-effective upfront. Tankless models heat on demand, saving energy and space. Hybrids combine both, using a heat pump for efficiency with a backup tank.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Water Heater Location:** (I) → *Indoor Water Heater / Outdoor Water Heater / Water Heater in Room* Choose a spot with easy access for maintenance and close to high-use fixtures to reduce wait time for hot water. Common locations include the garage, utility room, or attic. Just make sure there's proper drainage and ventilation, especially if it's in a finished space.	
☐	**Tankless Water Heater Fuel:** (I) → *Electric / Propane / Natural Gas* Gas models heat water faster and handle higher demand, making them ideal for larger households. Electric models are easier to install and better for smaller homes or areas without gas lines.	
☐	**Multiple Water Heaters - Series vs. Parallel** (I) (L) → *Series / Parallel* Series setups send water from one tank into the next, great for consistent hot water in homes with high demand. Parallel setups let both heaters work at the same time, ideal for faster recovery and shared workload.	
☐	**Water Heater Tank Size & Quantity:** (I) → *30 Gallon / 40 Gallon / 50 Gallon / 60 Gallon / 80 Gallon* 40–50 gallons is typical for 2–4 people, while larger families may need 75+ gallons or multiple tanks. Start bigger or consider a second unit if you have soaking tubs, multiple showers, or high hot water demand.	
☐	**Hot Water Recirculation System** (I) (V) Keeps hot water moving through the pipes so you get instant hot water at fixtures, no long waits or wasted water. Ideal for larger homes or layouts with distant bathrooms or kitchens. Some systems use timers or motion sensors to save energy.	
☐	**Water Manifold System** (I) Each fixture has its own shut-off at a central manifold, making it easy to isolate lines for maintenance. Fewer connections reduce leak points, but hot water may take longer to reach distant fixtures.	
☐	**Drain Pan Under Water Heater** (I) (L) Install a drain pan beneath the tank with a drain to the exterior to catch leaks and prevent water damage. Especially important if the heater is in an attic, closet, or finished space.	
☐	**Tank Drain Valve** (I) Replace the factory water heater drain with a full-port ball valve. The plastic or smaller metal drains that come with most tanks clog with sediment and can break. A ball valve's larger opening makes annual tank flushing much easier.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Gas Line		
☐	**Tankless Water Heater (Gas Line)** (I) Tankless units often require a larger gas line than standard appliances due to high BTU demands. Plan ahead to ensure proper sizing and avoid costly retrofits later. Undersized lines can limit performance or cause the unit to shut down.	
☐	**Pool Heater (Gas Line)** (I) Pool heaters require a high gas volume, often needing a dedicated, upsized gas line. Plan for this during rough-in to avoid pressure issues or performance problems later.	
☐	**Home Generator (Gas Line)** (I) Standby generators need a dedicated gas line with proper sizing to ensure reliable startup and operation, especially during high-demand times. Plan ahead if you're also powering other gas appliances.	
☐	**Grill or Firepit (Gas Line)** (I) (V) Running a dedicated gas line to your grill or firepit adds convenience and eliminates the need for propane tanks. Plan it during the rough-in stage to ensure proper placement, sizing, and shut-off access.	
☐	**Gas and Electric at Stove and/or Dryer** (I) Install both gas and electric hookups to keep your options open. Some appliances use both (like gas stoves with electric igniters), and dual hookups make future upgrades or replacements easier without additional work later.	
☐	**Appliances Requiring Gas Line:** (I) → *Gas Cooktop / Gas Oven / Gas Fireplace / Gas Dryer / Gas Furnace / Outdoor Gas Kitchen / Gas Fire Pit* Plan for gas line hookups wherever needed, whether indoors or out. Installing lines during rough-in is more cost-effective than adding them later and ensures you're ready for future appliances or upgrades.	
☐	**Accessible Gas Shut-Offs** (I) Each gas appliance should have a clearly labeled shut-off valve in an easy-to-reach spot. Don't let it end up hidden behind walls or cabinets.	
☐	**Gas Lanterns** (I) (V) Most are manually lit and burn continuously. If left on 24/7 expect some soot build-up to clean and higher gas costs. Some brands offer 120V electric ignition kits so you can ignite them from a wall switch. Plan for gas line routing and a shut-off valve during rough-in.	
☐	**Main Gas Shutoff Location** (I) Should be clearly marked and easy to access in case of emergency or maintenance. Typically located outside near the meter. Make sure everyone in the household knows its location.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Sinks and Drains		
☐	**Cast Iron Pipe for Second Floor Toilet Drain** (I) (V) (L) Using cast iron instead of PVC helps block the sound of flushing and draining from upstairs toilets. It's a solid upgrade if you want quieter living spaces below, especially in bedrooms or common areas.	
☐	**Grey Water Pipe for Washing Machine** (I) (V) A grey water laundry drain routes washing machine water to your yard for eco-friendly landscape irrigation. For those on septic, use a 2" drain with vented P-trap and 18"–30" standpipe. Slope properly and secure. On septic systems, all gray water must drain to the tank unless a separate approved system is installed.	
☐	**Hidden Floor Drain in Corner** (I) Install a low-profile drain in a corner to catch overflow from washers or water heaters. Slope floor slightly toward drain and connect to septic with a trap and vent.	
☐	**Bathtub Drain Location:** (I) → *Left / Right / Center* Make sure the drain position matches the tub you purchase - left, right, or center - based on your bathroom layout. Especially important for slab foundations, where plumbing changes are much harder and more expensive to adjust later.	
☐	**Sink and Drain Locations:** (I) → *Kitchen Sink and Drain / Bathroom Sink and Drain / Pantry Sink and Drain / Garage Sink and Drain / Laundry Sink and Drain / Wet Bar Sink and Drain / Outdoor Sink and Drain / Workshop Sink and Drain / Animal Washing Sink and Drain* Plan for all sink and drain locations early to ensure proper plumbing rough-ins. Each location may require unique venting, trap configurations, or hot/cold line setups.	
☐	**Floor Drains** (I) Include floor drains in areas prone to leaks or spills, like laundry rooms, garages, mechanical rooms, and basements. Ensure proper slope to the drain and connect to the main drain line with a trap and vent.	
☐	**Robot Vacuum/Mop Drain Line** (I) If installing a dock for a self-cleaning robot vacuum or mop, plan a dedicated drain line nearby. This allows dirty water to empty automatically without manual dumping. Tie into an existing drain if possible.	
☐	**Rarely Used Floor Drains** (I) (P) For floor drains that don't get regular use, add a bit of mineral oil to the P-trap to slow evaporation. Alternatively, use a trap seal device to prevent sewer gas smells from entering the home.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Hose Bibs		
☐	**Hose Bib on All Sides** (I) Front and back are common, but adding them to all sides is inexpensive during rough-in and adds long-term convenience.	
☐	**Porch Hose Bibs** (I) Add hose bibs near front and back porches for easy watering and cleanup. Place them discreetly but accessibly, and use frost-proof models with interior shutoffs in colder climates.	
☐	**In-Ground Hose Bib** (I) (P) (L) Install in-ground hose bibs for easy access to water in yards or gardens without dragging hoses from the house. Choose frost-proof, self-draining models with backflow protection. Ideal for large lots or areas with frequent watering needs.	
☐	**Hose Bib in Unusual Locations:** (I) → *Garden Bib / Middle Yard / Shed Bib* Add hose bibs in non-standard locations. It reduces hose length, improves access, and supports irrigation or cleanup tasks.	
☐	**Aquor House/Ground Hydrant (Press-Fit Hose Bibs)** (I) (L) Aquor hydrants use press-fit connections for easy installation and maintenance, providing reliable water access both at the house exterior and ground level. These frost-free hydrants prevent pipe freezing in cold climates and eliminate the need to drain outdoor lines seasonally, enhancing durability and convenience.	
☐	**Hot Water Hose Bib** (I) (V) (L) Install a hot water hose bib near garages, dog wash areas, or outdoor kitchens for warm water access. Use insulated piping and label clearly to avoid accidental burns. Requires a hot water line during rough-in.	
☐	**Threaded and Replaceable Hose Bib** (I) (L) Use a threaded hose bib that connects to a brass or copper fitting for easy future replacement. This setup avoids cutting pipe if the valve fails and simplifies seasonal swaps or upgrades.	
Water Filtration		
☐	**Water Filtration System:** (I) → *Whole Home / Partial* Choose between whole-home filtration for all water entering the house or partial systems for specific fixtures like the kitchen sink. Whole-home filters improve water quality throughout, while partial systems are more affordable and easier to maintain.	
☐	**Water Softener Plumbing** (I) Install piping after the main shutoff but before indoor fixtures, bypassing hose bibs. Add a bypass valve and drain line with an air gap. Follow local code for backflow prevention.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Water Softener Salt Chute** (I) Install a short PVC or metal chute from the garage or utility room wall to the brine tank for easy salt refills. Saves time and avoids hauling heavy bags through the house. Make sure the opening has a cap to keep out moisture and debris.	
Misc Plumbing		
☐	**Pot Filler:** (I) → *Standard Pot Filler / Deck Mounted Pot Filler / Coffee Pot Filler / Pet Pot Filler* A pot filler is a wall-mounted or deck mounted faucet, allowing easy filling of large pots on the stove, coffee pots, or pet drinking stations.	
☐	**Outdoor Shower** (I) Install an outdoor shower near the pool, beach entry, or back patio for easy rinsing. Use materials rated for outdoor plumbing (UV-rated CPVC, sleeved PEX, or Type L copper) and include hot and cold water lines if possible.	
☐	**Exterior Water Line Stub-Outs** (I) Add stub-outs during rough-in for future outdoor kitchens, sheds, gardens, or RV hookups. Saves time and cost if you expand later. Cap and mark clearly for easy access.	
☐	**Shower Dryer (AirMada AirJet System)** (I) (V) (L) AirMada uses built-in air nozzles to dry your shower after use, reducing moisture, mold, and cleanup. Requires PVC air lines, a blower motor, and electrical wiring. Ideal for steam showers or high-end bathrooms.	
☐	**Steam Shower** (I) A steam shower uses a powered generator to create steam within an enclosed space for a spa-like experience. It requires plumbing, electrical, and proper ventilation to manage moisture and prevent mold, along with full enclosure, waterproofing, and a vapor barrier to handle heat and humidity.	
☐	**Wet Bar Glass Chiller** (I) (L) (L) A glass chiller blasts glasses with sub-zero air or CO_2, cooling them in just a few seconds. Plan a drain line for the melted water from a glass chiller to prevent pooling or damage. Route to an existing sink drain when possible. Requires a trap and vent like other plumbing fixtures.	
☐	**Automatic Water Main Shut-Off Leak Detector** (I) (V) (P) Detects leaks and automatically shuts off the main water line to prevent flooding. Learns your home's water usage patterns to identify small leaks and will automatically turn off water. Usage and alerts can be monitored via App as well.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Built-In Wall Water Fountain/Bottle Filler** (I) (P) Integrated into walls for convenient, hands-free hydration in kitchens or mudrooms. Offers quick access for filling bottles or drinking directly. Requires dedicated water supply and drainage planning. Consider adding built in storage below the filler for a place to store water bottles.	
☐	**Water Bottle Filler Drain** (I) If installing a bottle filler or water fountain, connect the drip tray to a drain line to prevent standing water or overflow. Include a trap and vent if tied into the plumbing.	
☐	**Urinal Plumbing** (I) Requires a water supply line with shutoff, proper wall drain with trap, and venting. Plan height and spacing per code, and consider waterless options for low-use areas. Ideal for garages, workshops, or pool houses.	
☐	**Specific Location of Water Main Shut-Off** (I) Clearly label and document the exact location of the main water shut-off valve, inside the house and at the street if applicable. Place it in an accessible area, like a utility room or near the water heater.	
☐	**Fridge Water Line Shut-Off** (I) Install the fridge water line shut-off in an easily accessible spot, like a nearby cabinet or basement ceiling. Avoid placing it behind the fridge where it's hard to reach.	
☐	**Water Line for Robot Vacuum/Mop** (I) Run a cold water supply line to the docking station if using a self-filling robot vacuum or mop. Plan the location near a drain and power outlet.	
☐	**Individual Water Shut-Off Valves for Each Appliance** (I) Install dedicated shut-off valves for appliances like the fridge, dishwasher, washer, and toilets. Allows quick isolation during repairs or emergencies without cutting off water to the whole house.	
☐	**Water Hammer Arrestor Shut-Off Valves** (I) (L) Use shut-off valves with built-in water hammer arrestors at appliances like washers and dishwashers to prevent noisy pipe banging. They absorb pressure surges and protect plumbing over time.	
☐	**Exterior Wall Plumbing Avoidance** (I) Avoid running plumbing through exterior walls when possible, to prevent freezing, especially in cold climates. Instead, route lines through interior walls or floors. If unavoidable, use heavy insulation and seal all gaps.	
☐	**Plumbing for Filtered Water: Refrigerator, Sink, Bottle Filler** (I) Run a dedicated filtered water line to the fridge, kitchen sink, and bottle filler for cleaner drinking water. Use a central filter system with branches to each fixture. Plan tubing routes early to avoid retrofitting challenges.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Use Ball Valves Instead of Gate Valves** (I) Request ball valves for all shutoff points, they're more reliable, easier to operate, and less prone to failure. Gate valves can stick or break over time, especially after years of non-use. Ball valves offer a simple ¼-turn operation and better long-term performance.	
☐	**Fire Sprinkler System** (I) If required or desired, plan for a residential fire sprinkler system during framing to allow proper pipe routing and head placement. Connect to the main water supply with backflow prevention and test per local code. May lower insurance premiums.	
HVAC (Air Conditioning)		
☐	**Exterior HVAC Pipe Covers** (I) (P) Protects refrigerant lines and condensate pipes from weather, UV exposure, and physical damage. Durable materials like insulated PVC or metal shielding help maintain system efficiency and prolong component life.	
☐	**Whole House Fan** (I) A whole house fan helps cool the home by drawing in fresh outdoor air through open windows and exhausting hot indoor air through the attic. It's an energy-efficient alternative or supplement to air conditioning, especially in dry, cool evenings.	
☐	**Heat Recovery Ventilator (HRV)/Energy Recovery Ventilator (ERV)** (I) (L) HRVs and ERVs improve indoor air quality by exchanging stale indoor air with fresh outdoor air while recovering heat (and moisture, in ERVs) from the exhaust air. This energy-efficient ventilation reduces heating and cooling costs and helps maintain comfortable humidity levels.	
☐	**Paint Inside of HVAC Vents Black** (I) Can reduce visible glare and make the vent openings less noticeable, especially against dark walls or ceilings. Best done before final installation or after removing grilles. Use high-heat, low-sheen spray paint to avoid peeling and reflection.	
Ductless Mini Split		
☐	**Indoor Head Unit:** (I) → *Ceiling Cassette* / *Floor Mounted Cassette* / *Wall Mounted Cassette* Ductless mini split indoor units come in various styles to fit different room layouts and aesthetics. Ceiling cassette units distribute air evenly from a central ceiling location, ideal for larger spaces. Floor-mounted units are discreet and suitable for rooms without overhead space. Wall-mounted units are the most common, offering easy installation and effective airflow for typical living areas.	

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	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Number of Head Units Needed (Zones/Rooms)** (I) The number of indoor head units corresponds to the number of zones or rooms you want to cool or heat independently. More units provide precise temperature control and energy savings by conditioning only occupied areas.	
Central Air Conditioning		
☐	**Drain Pan Emergency Shut Off Switch** (I) (V) (P) This safety device detects water overflow in the HVAC drain pan and automatically shuts off the system to prevent water damage. Installing a shut off switch protects ceilings, walls, and floors from potential leaks caused by clogged condensate lines or drain failures.	
☐	**Number of HVAC Units:** (I) → *1 HVAC Unit / 2 HVAC Units / 3 HVAC Units* Deciding between one or two HVAC units depends on the home's size, layout, and zoning needs. Smaller or open-plan homes typically use a single unit, while larger or multi-level homes often install two units, one dedicated to the first floor and another for the second, to improve temperature control and energy efficiency. If using 3 units, you can dedicate one unit to the primary bedroom.	
☐	**HVAC Ducts** (I) Ducts distribute conditioned air throughout the home, with design, insulation, and sealing crucial for efficiency and comfort. Typically, rigid metal is used for main trunk lines from the air handler, providing durability and airflow consistency, while flexible ducts connect trunk lines to interior vents for easier routing. Fully rigid metal duct systems can be louder but often offer better airflow and longevity.	
☐	**HVAC Zoning System** (I) Divides the home into separate areas, or zones, each controlled independently for temperature and airflow. This allows customized comfort, reduces energy waste by conditioning only occupied spaces, and improves overall HVAC efficiency. Zone dampers within the ductwork open or close based on thermostat settings for precise control.	
☐	**Conditioned or Vented Location for Air Handler** (I) Helps improve equipment efficiency and longevity by maintaining stable temperatures and reducing moisture exposure. This placement minimizes strain on the system and prevents premature wear, contributing to reliable operation and lower maintenance costs.	
☐	**A/C Ductwork Location:** (I) → *Crawlspace Ductwork / Basement Ductwork / Attic Ductwork* Impacts energy efficiency, maintenance access, and vent placement, deciding between ceiling or floor vents. Crawlspaces and basements offer easier access and stable temperatures, reducing energy loss. Attic ducts face more temperature extremes, requiring good insulation and sealing to prevent efficiency loss and condensation.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Room Thermostat Sensors** (I) Monitors temperature in specific rooms or zones to provide accurate control and maintain comfort. Placing sensors away from direct sunlight, drafts, or heat sources ensures reliable readings. Some systems use remote or wireless sensors for greater flexibility in multi-zone setups.	
☐	**Smart Thermostat** (I) Offers programmable, remote, and learning capabilities to optimize heating and cooling schedules based on occupancy and preferences. They improve energy efficiency by adapting to your lifestyle and can be controlled via smartphone apps, voice assistants, or automation systems.	
☐	**Secondary Drain Pan for Air Handler** (I) Provides backup protection against condensate leaks or overflow. It helps prevent water damage to ceilings and floors by catching excess moisture if the primary drain line clogs or fails. Ensure the pan has a dedicated drain line or alert system for effective protection.	
☐	**Returns in Multiple Rooms Instead of One Central Location** (I) Using return air vents in multiple rooms improves airflow balance and indoor air quality by reducing pressure imbalances and preventing stale air pockets. This design helps maintain consistent temperatures and can reduce noise compared to a single central return.	
☐	**Transfer Grilles** (I) (L) Allows air to move between rooms when doors are closed, preventing pressure buildup, door slamming, and uneven temps. Best option is a dedicated return duct in each room. If that's not in the budget a transfer grille may be used.	
☐	**Vents Covered and Protected from Construction Debris** (I) (L) Prevents dust, dirt, and debris from entering the HVAC system, reducing contamination and the need for extensive cleaning later. Temporary coverings or filters ensure system components stay clean and maintain indoor air quality once the project is complete.	
Furnace		
☐	**Furnace Stage:** (I) → *Single Stage Furnace* / *Two-Stage Furnace* / *Multi-Stage Furnace* Furnace stages refer to how the unit operates to meet heating demand. Single-stage furnaces run at full capacity when on, which can cause temperature swings. Two-stage furnaces offer low and high settings for better comfort and efficiency. Multi-stage furnaces adjust output more precisely, providing the smoothest temperature control and energy savings.	

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	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Furnace Location:** (I) ➔ *Attic Furnace / Basement Furnace / Crawlspace Furnace* The location affects accessibility, efficiency, and maintenance. Basements and crawlspaces typically offer easier access and protection from extreme temperatures. Attic installations save floor space but may require additional insulation and maintenance considerations due to temperature fluctuations.	
☐	**Fuel Type:** (I) ➔ *Gas Furnace / Oil Furnace / Electric Furnace / Propane Furnace* Choosing the right fuel type depends on availability, cost, and heating requirements. Natural gas is common and efficient where available. Electric furnaces offer easy installation but may have higher operating costs. Propane and oil are alternatives for areas without natural gas service, each with unique storage and maintenance needs.	
☐	**Geothermal Heating** (I) Geothermal heating uses underground pipes circulating fluid to capture the earth's natural heat and transfer it indoors. This highly efficient system can also provide radiant floor heating, offering sustainable comfort with lower operating costs.	
☐	**Avoid Placing the A/C Unit Directly Under a Bathroom Vent** (I) Steam and moisture from bathroom vents can corrode the A/C unit over time, reducing efficiency and lifespan. To prevent damage, choose a dry, open location away from vent discharge for cleaner air intake and longer-lasting equipment.	
☐	**Dedicated Unit/Control for the Bedroom** (I) Installing a dedicated HVAC unit or temperature control for the bedroom allows personalized comfort, especially if you prefer it cooler than the rest of the house. This zoning approach enhances sleep quality and energy efficiency by conditioning only the desired area.	
☐	**Thermostats in One Location** (I) (V) (P) Thermostats are often placed outside the primary bedroom for convenient access and monitoring. This setup requires a remote sensor, so the thermostat accurately reads the temperature of the room(s) it controls. While simplifying control, it may limit precise comfort in multi-zone homes.	
☐	**Avoid Pinched Flexible Ducts** (I) (L) Ensure flexible ducts are free from pinches or sharp bends that restrict airflow. If a duct appears pinched, gently squeeze the insulation to check if the internal duct is compressed, which can reduce system efficiency and comfort.	
☐	**Outdoor Unit Location Considerations** (I) Position the outdoor HVAC unit away from bedrooms or entertainment areas to minimize noise disturbances. Selecting a quiet, well-ventilated spot helps maintain comfort inside the home and prolongs equipment life.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Electrical Wiring		
☐	**Smart Electrical Panel** (I) (V) (L) Smart electrical panels let you monitor and control circuits from your phone. Track usage, shut off breakers remotely, and get alerts if something's off. They're almost a necessity for solar setups and battery backups, letting you prioritize which circuits stay on during an outage or low battery levels.	
☐	**12-Gauge (20 Amp) Wiring to Outlets and 14-Gauge for Lighting** (I) Use 12-gauge wiring for 20-amp outlet circuits to safely handle higher power loads, minimizing fire risks and ensuring code compliance. For lighting circuits, 14-gauge wiring is standard but consider heavier gauge if planning for future upgrades or higher loads.	
☐	**Whole Home Surge Protector** (I) Installed at the main electrical panel that guards your entire home against voltage spikes from lightning, power surges, or utility fluctuations. Protects appliances and electronics, extending their lifespan and reducing damage risk.	
In-Wall Conduit (Smurf Tube)		
☐	**In-Wall Conduit (Smurf Tubing)** (I) (V) (L) Flexible, durable tubing installed inside walls to protect and guide electrical or low-voltage wires. Facilitates easy wire pulls and future upgrades without damaging drywall, saving time and repair costs.	
Dedicated Electrical Circuits		
☐	**Dedicated Electrical Circuits:** (I) (V) ➔ *Fridge Circuit / Freezer Circuit / Large Appliances / Outdoor Heater(s) Circuit / Bathroom Heater Circuit / Garbage Disposal Circuit / Car Charger Circuit / Sump Pump Circuit / Sauna Circuit / Structured Media Enclosure Circuit / Coffee Bar Circuit / Hot Tub Circuit* Assign dedicated circuits for each major appliance or high-demand device to prevent overload and ensure consistent, safe operation. Critical items like refrigerators, freezers, and sump pumps require uninterrupted power, while specialty equipment such as outdoor heaters, car chargers, and hot tubs demand circuits sized and protected for their unique loads. Structured media closets housing multiple devices also benefit from dedicated circuits to manage power efficiently and simplify troubleshooting.	
Electrical Power Loss		
☐	**Home Generator Wiring** (I) (V) Power essentials during an outage, like lights, fridge, and a few outlets. Requires early planning and a transfer switch for safe use.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Home Battery Backup** (I) Provides reliable power during outages by storing electricity from the grid or solar panels. Keeps essentials like lights, fridge, internet, and medical devices running when the power goes out. It's quiet, automatic, and can lower energy bills by using stored power.	
☐	**Portable Generator Transfer Switch** (I) (V) Allows you to safely power key circuits in your home like the fridge, lights, or HVAC by connecting a portable generator during a power outage. The transfer switch prevents dangerous backfeeding and makes switching to backup power fast and simple.	
☐	**Critical Items for Generator** (I) Identify critical appliances and systems you want to keep running during power outages, such as refrigerators, freezers, lighting, sump pumps, and medical equipment. Prioritize these for backup power circuits.	
Outdoor Electrical		
☐	**Built-In Heaters on the Front/Back Porch** (I) Built-in heaters provide warmth without cluttering the porch with portable units.	
☐	**Pool and/or Hot Tub Wiring and Lighting** (I) Specialized wiring and lighting installations designed to meet safety codes and withstand wet environments. Ensure GFCI protection, proper conduit use, and separate dedicated circuits to safely power pumps, heaters, and underwater lights.	
☐	**Internet/Electricity to Shed/Building** (I) Plan for dedicated wiring to provide reliable power and internet connectivity to detached structures. Use weatherproof conduit and outlets, and consider future needs like lighting, tools, or HVAC to size circuits appropriately.	
☐	**Driveway Column Lighting** (I) (L) Wiring installed to power lights mounted on driveway columns enhances nighttime visibility and curb appeal. Ensure weatherproof fixtures and wiring and consider integrating with timers or motion sensors.	
☐	**Driveway Gate:** (I) → *Gate Sensors / Driveway Gate / Gate Opener / Driveway Lights* Dedicated wiring and circuits for driveway gate components including safety sensors, gate motors, openers, and lighting. Ensure proper weatherproofing and separate circuits to maintain reliable, safe operation and easy maintenance.	
☐	**Outdoor Movie Area Conduit and Wiring** (I) Pre-installed conduit and wiring for outdoor entertainment setups allow for flexible placement of projectors, screens, speakers, and lighting. Use weather-resistant materials and plan circuits to support audio-visual equipment safely.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Pool Heater** (I) A dedicated, weatherproof circuit and wiring sized to handle the high power demands of pool heaters. Ensure compliance with local electrical codes and include GFCI protection for safety.	
Security		
☐	**Flood Lights on Each Corner of the House** (I) (L) Wiring installed to power flood lights at all corners provides comprehensive exterior illumination, deterring intruders and enhancing safety. Consider motion sensors and timers.	
☐	**Security Cameras: Wired (POE wiring)** (I) (V) (P) Wire for POE (Power Over Ethernet) cameras. Power and video through one cable. More stable than Wi-Fi and takes load off your network.	
☐	**Siren Sound to Play Inside and Outside** (I) Wiring dedicated to alarms that emit siren sounds both indoors and outdoors. This setup maximizes deterrence and ensures occupants and neighbors are alerted during emergencies.	
☐	**Security System:** (I) → *Wired / Wireless* Choose between wired systems offering reliable, tamper-resistant connections and wireless setups providing flexible installation and ease of expansion.	
☐	**Electric Shutter Wiring** (I) Dedicated wiring to power motorized shutters for windows or doors, enhancing security and privacy. Ensure wiring is weatherproof and integrated with control systems for remote operation and automation.	
Electrical Wiring Misc		
☐	**Wall-Mounted Picture Light** (I) (P) Wiring dedicated to accent lighting installed above artwork or photos. Proper placement and dimmer controls enhance visual appeal while minimizing glare and energy use.	
☐	**Wall Mounted Make-Up Mirror Wiring (Hardwired)** (I) Dedicated hardwired power supply for a wall-mounted make-up mirror ensures consistent, flicker-free lighting.	
☐	**Built-In Bunk Bed Light** (I) (L) Integrated lighting within bunk beds provides convenient, soft illumination for reading or nighttime safety. Plan wiring carefully to avoid clutter and allow individual control for each bed.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Light Above Bed for Reading** (I) A focused light fixture installed above the bed provides comfortable illumination for reading without disturbing others. Consider adjustable brightness and direction, and position switches for easy access.	
☐	**Ti-D Wire to Organize Electrical Wiring** (I) (P) Specialized wiring designed to streamline and organize electrical connections, reducing clutter and improving safety. Using Ti-D wire helps simplify installation and future maintenance.	
☐	**Gas and Electric Installed at the Stove and/or Dryer** (I) Providing both gas and electric hookups at these appliances offers flexibility for current use and future upgrades. Some stoves and dryers utilize both power sources or may be replaced with models requiring different connections, so pre-installing both ensures adaptability.	
☐	**Electric Shades or Curtains** (I) (V) Pre-wire for motorized shades or curtains, confirming shade type early as wiring requirements vary by brand and model. Plan wiring individually for each window before rough-in to ensure seamless installation and future-proofing.	
☐	**Multi-Room Audio** (I) Pre-wired audio systems that distribute sound throughout multiple rooms, enabling synchronized or independent playback.	
☐	**Intercom System** (I) Wiring installed for audio or video communication between rooms or entry points. Enhances household connectivity and security, especially when integrated with door entry and smart home systems.	
☐	**Crawlspace** (I) Ensure all wiring running through crawlspaces is properly protected with conduit or rated cable to prevent damage from moisture, pests, and physical contact.	
☐	**Garbage Disposal Switch** (I) (P) To control the garbage disposal unit, ideally located near the kitchen sink for easy access. Consider options like air switches or rocker switches for enhanced safety and convenience.	
☐	**Stair Lighting** (I) (L) Installed along staircases improves safety and ambiance. Options include recessed step lights, strip lighting, or wall-mounted fixtures, often controlled by timers, dimmers, or motion sensors for energy efficiency.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Home Theater System** (I) Pre-wiring for audio, video, and control components in a dedicated room enhances entertainment quality and reduces visible cables. Plan conduit and outlet placement for projectors, speakers, screens, and lighting controls.	
☐	**Dumbwaiter for Second Floor** (I) Electrical wiring and controls needed to operate a small freight elevator for transporting items between floors. Ensure proper circuit sizing and safety features for reliable, convenient use.	
☐	**Attic Lighting** (I) Wiring for durable, energy-efficient lighting in attic spaces, providing sufficient illumination for storage or maintenance. Consider motion sensors or switches near entry points.	
☐	**Extra Slack in Wiring Outside the Gang Box** (I) Request additional wire length inside walls beyond the gang box to facilitate easier device installation, maintenance, or future upgrades. Extra slack helps prevent strain on connections and reduces repair complexity.	
☐	**Walk Through the Electrical Panel to Understand All Labels** (I) Review and familiarize yourself with all circuit labels in the electrical panel. Make notes or create a detailed legend to ensure quick identification during maintenance or emergencies.	
☐	**Steam Shower** (I) A steam shower uses a powered generator to create steam within an enclosed space for a spa-like experience. It requires plumbing, electrical, and proper ventilation to manage moisture and prevent mold, along with full enclosure, waterproofing, and a vapor barrier to handle heat and humidity.	
Lighting Switches		
☐	**Switch Type:** (I) (V) → *Rocker Switch / Toggle Switch* Rocker switches offer a modern, flat look or toggle switches for a traditional classic feel. Both function the same, so it's mainly an aesthetic preference.	
☐	**Light Switches at Top and Bottom of Stairs** (I) Install 3-way switches at both the top and bottom of staircases. This is code in most cases but sometimes missed. Ensure placement meets your needs.	
☐	**Upstairs Master Off Switch** (I) (V) A single switch at the bottom of the stairs shuts off every upstairs light at once, preventing a trip back up when lights get left on.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Smart Switches** (I) (V) (P) Use smart switches for remote control, automation, and voice assistant integration. Lutron Diva switches can be added during or after the build. Lutron also offers luxury smart switches that require detailed planning but reduce the number of wall switches around the house.	
☐	**Wall Switch Timers** (I) (P) Install timer switches for bathrooms or exhaust fans to automatically shut off after a set time. Helps save energy and ensures lights or fans aren't left on accidentally.	
☐	**Dimmable Switches** (I) (P) Use dimmable switches in living rooms, dining areas, bedrooms, or media rooms to control light levels and set the mood. Make sure lighting is labeled dimmable and compatible with the dimmable switch.	
☐	**Humidity Sensor Switch** (I) (L) Great for bathrooms and laundry rooms, automatically turns on the exhaust fan when humidity rises. Helps prevent mold and moisture damage without relying on manual operation. Ideal for kid bathrooms.	
☐	**Bedroom Light Switch Within Reach of Bed** (I) (V) Install a second light switch near the bed for easy control without getting up. Adds convenience and is great for reading or nighttime use. Use a 3-way switch or smart switch setups.	
☐	**Occupancy Sensor Switches** (I) (V) (P) Automatically turns lights on when someone enters a room, and turns lights off after a set time of no movement. Ideal for closets, pantries, garages, and bathrooms. Helps save energy and adds hands-free convenience.	
☐	**Fireplace On/Off Switch** (I) (V) A wall-mounted switch offers quick and safe control of a gas fireplace without reaching into the unit. Typically wired to a low-voltage ignition system. Most systems require a standing pilot light to operate.	
☐	**Outdoor Flood Light Switch in Primary Bedroom** (I) (V) (L) Add a switch in the primary bedroom to control outdoor flood lights for quick access at night. Increases security and peace of mind without leaving the room. Can be combined with smart or 3-way switches.	
☐	**Exterior Lights on Astronomical Switches** (I) (P) Timer light switches automate exterior lighting to turn on and off at set times or with sunrise/sunset, improving security and convenience. Great for porch, garage, Christmas, or landscape lights when you want a simple, traditional alternative to a smart switch.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Light Switch for Exterior Lights** (I) (V) Add a dedicated switch for string lights on patios, porches, or pergolas to avoid relying on plug-in timers or unplugging manually. Place the switch indoors or in a weatherproof outdoor box for easy control.	
☐	**Determining Preferred Switch Location** (I) When unsure where to place a switch, walk into the room and pretend to turn on the light, whichever side you instinctively reach for is usually the best spot.	
☐	**Avoid Tight Switch Placement** (I) (V) Ensure switch boxes aren't placed too close to door trim, cabinetry, or walls where a full switch plate won't fit. Leave enough space for proper installation and a clean, finished look.	
Electrical Outlet		
☐	**Phone Charging Stations:** (I) (P) → *Island End Cap / In-Wall Cubby / Entryway Built-In / Charging Drawer* Plan where everyday devices will charge so cords don't take over counters and tables. In-drawer outlets are especially helpful for keeping everything out of sight.	
☐	**Outlet Style:** (I) → *Duplex / Decora* Choose between traditional duplex outlets or modern decorator-style outlets that offer a sleeker, more streamlined look.	
☐	**Childproof Outlets** (I) Tamper resistant outlets are equipped with built-in safety shutters or covers to prevent accidental insertion of objects, protecting children from electrical shock.	
☐	**Pop-Up/Pop-Out Outlets** (I) (V) (P) Outlets that retract into countertops, desks, or walls when not in use, providing a clean, clutter-free surface.	
Kitchen		
☐	**Adjustable Depth Outlet Box for Backsplash** (I) (P) An outlet gang box designed to extend or recess, allowing precise alignment with varying backsplash thicknesses. Ensures a flush, professional finish.	
☐	**Island Outlets** (I) (V) Electrical outlets installed in kitchen islands for convenient access to power while cooking or entertaining. Confirm placement and number with your builder to meet your needs and code requirements.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Outlets Under Upper Cabinets for Countertop Use** (I) Recessed or hidden outlets mounted beneath upper cabinets provide convenient access to power without disrupting backsplash aesthetics. Ideal for small appliances and keeping countertops clutter-free.	
☐	**Outlets Inside Kitchen Cabinets/Drawers (Chargers/Small Appliances)** (I) (P) (L) Built-in outlets inside cabinets or drawers allow discreet charging of devices or powering of small appliances, keeping countertops clear and organized while maintaining accessibility.	
☐	**Top of Cabinets Outlet (Decorative Lighting)** (I) Let you add subtle accent lighting that enhances ambiance and highlights design details. Plan wiring carefully to avoid visible cords and ensure easy access for future bulb changes.	
Bathroom		
☐	**Backlit Vanity Mirror Outlet** (I) (P) An outlet built into or behind the vanity mirror powers integrated LED lighting, offering even, shadow-free illumination for grooming. Plan for dimmable features and easy access to controls.	
☐	**Toilet Outlet** (I) (V) An electrical outlet positioned near the toilet to power advanced features like bidet seats, heated seats, or automatic flush systems.	
☐	**Outlets Inside Vanity Cabinets/Drawers (Chargers/Hair Tools)** (I) (L) (P) Built inside vanity storage keep chargers and hair tools hidden yet accessible, reducing countertop clutter. Consider including USB ports and surge protection for added convenience and safety.	
☐	**Towel Warmer/Dryer (Hardwired or Outlet)** (I) (L) A luxury addition that provides warm, dry towels on demand. Choose between hardwired or plug-in models based on installation ease and design.	
Bedroom		
☐	**Nightstand Outlets with USB** (I) Installing USB-C ports future-proofs charging needs and keeps cables tidy. Some prefer installing these outlets higher on the wall for easier access without bending.	
☐	**Outlets in Closets (Handheld Steamer, Air Freshener)** (I) (L) Conveniently placed outlets inside closets power handheld steamers, air fresheners, or other small appliances.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Bedside Outlets (Nightstands/Adjustable Beds/Heating Pad)** (I) Strategically placed outlets near the bed support multiple uses, from charging devices on nightstands to powering adjustable beds and heating pads.	
☐	**High Outlet in Corner of the Room for Baby Monitor** (I) (L) An elevated outlet placement provides an ideal, unobstructed location for baby monitors, improving signal range and preventing cord hazards near the crib.	
Outdoor		
☐	**Porch Wall Outlets** (I) Weather-resistant outlets installed on porch walls provide convenient power for lighting, holiday decorations, and outdoor electronics. Ensure they have protective covers and are GFCI protected for safety.	
☐	**Back Porch TV Outlet** (I) A dedicated, weatherproof outlet positioned to power outdoor TVs or entertainment systems on the back porch. Proper placement and protection ensure safe, reliable operation in varying weather conditions.	
☐	**Outdoor Porch/Patio Ceiling for Outdoor Heater (Hardwired or Outlet)** (I) A dedicated power source installed in the porch or patio ceiling to safely operate outdoor heaters. Choose between hardwired connections for permanent setups or outlets for flexible heater placement.	
☐	**Outdoor String Light Outlet with Switch** (I) An outdoor-rated outlet paired with a dedicated switch to control string lights conveniently. Enables easy on/off operation without unplugging and ensures safe, weather-resistant power delivery.	
☐	**Outlet for Pellet Grill** (I) A dedicated, weatherproof outlet to power pellet grills, ensuring reliable operation outdoors. Position the outlet within safe distance, considering grill ventilation and electrical codes.	
Garage		
☐	**240V Outlets:** (I) → *Electric Car 240v / Welder 240v / Table Saw 240v / Sauna 240v / RV Hook-Up 240v* Add dedicated 240V outlets for high-powered equipment like RVs, welders, or large woodworking tools. Each may require different amperage and plug types, so plan based on usage. Locate outlets near expected equipment for convenience and safety.	
☐	**High Outlet for Fan (Garage/Porch)** (I) Place a high-mounted outlet on the wall or ceiling for installing a fan in the garage or covered porch. Keeps cords hidden and allows for easy wiring during rough-in.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Extra Garage Outlets (Mounted High)** (I) Add elevated outlets around the garage for tools, chargers, or future upgrades like air compressors or ceiling-mounted devices. Keeps cords off the floor and improves flexibility for workspace setups.	
☐	**Outlets Inside Garage Cabinets** (I) Great for charging drill batteries, power tool banks, or USB devices without cluttering your workbench. Also useful for smart home hubs or garage Wi-Fi equipment you want out of sight.	
☐	**Retractable Extension Cord Outlet** (I) (P) Mount an outlet on the ceiling or high wall to power a retractable extension cord reel. Keeps cords off the floor and ready for use anywhere in the garage. Ideal for flexible access to power without permanent cords in the way.	
Christmas Outlets		
☐	**Fireplace Mantel** (I) (V) Outlets placed near the fireplace mantel allow easy, discreet power for holiday lights, garlands, and decorations. Consider installing switched outlets or timers for convenient control during the festive season.	
☐	**Both Sides of Front Door for Decorations** (I) Outlets installed on either side of the front door provide convenient power for holiday lighting and decor. Weatherproof and timer-compatible outlets help simplify setup and enhance curb appeal.	
☐	**Under Soffit Outlets** (I) (V) Discreetly placed outlets under soffits provide ideal power sources for holiday string lights, cameras, or decor.	
☐	**Wall Switch Timer for Christmas Lights Outlets** (I) (P) A programmable wall switch that automatically controls power to Christmas light outlets. Allows easy scheduling to turn lights on and off.	
☐	**Top and Bottom of Stairs (Decorations)** (I) Outlets strategically placed at stair landings to power holiday decorations, such as garlands or lights.	
☐	**Christmas Tree Location** (I) Outlets near the designated Christmas tree spot provide convenient, hidden power for tree lights and decorations.	

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	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Window Outlets** (I) Outlets installed near windows offer easy access for powering indoor or outdoor holiday lights and decorations. Ensure weather resistance if used outdoors and consider switch or timer controls for convenience.	
☐	**Yard Outlets for Decorations** (I) Ideal for inflatables, light sculptures, and animatronics, these outlets should be easily accessible yet discreet to maintain curb appeal. Incorporate ground-fault protection and plan outlet locations carefully to avoid unsightly extension cords and enable flexible decorating options year after year.	
☐	**Dormer Outlet Near the Window** (I) An outlet installed near dormer windows provides convenient power for seasonal decorations or lighting accents.	
Other		
☐	**Close-Call Outlets** (I) Outlets positioned near frequently used appliances or furniture to minimize extension cords and reduce trip hazards. Confirm all outlets are in ideal locations but not too close to doors, windows, cabinets, or other unsightly spots.	
☐	**Baseboard Outlets** (I) Outlets installed within or near baseboards provide low-profile power access that blends with trim work. Since baseboard outlets sit right in the path of robot vacuums, plan placement carefully, especially for devices plugged in long-term.	
☐	**Floor Outlets (Lamps, Power Recliner, Sofa, Office Desk, Movie Room Seating)** (I) Power outlets installed flush with the floor provide convenient access for lamps, power recliners, sofas, office desks, and movie room seating away from walls.	
☐	**Outlet in Laundry for Ironing or Steamer** (I) A dedicated outlet placed in the laundry area to conveniently power irons or handheld steamers.	
☐	**Night Light Location (Hallways)** (I) Strategically placed outlets for night lights in hallways improve safety by providing subtle illumination during nighttime. Consider outlets near floor level or with motion sensors.	
☐	**Built-In Night Lights** (I) (P) Outlets or switches with integrated night lights provide gentle, automatic illumination in key areas, enhancing nighttime visibility without harsh brightness.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**High Outlet in Cleaning Closet (Cordless Vacuum)** (I) A conveniently placed high outlet in the cleaning closet allows easy charging of cordless vacuum batteries without bending or clutter.	
☐	**Robot Vacuum Outlet** (I) An outlet positioned to accommodate the robot vacuum's charging dock, ideally placed low and near open floor space for easy return and docking.	
☐	**Higher Outlet at Computer Desk with USB** (I) Outlets installed higher on the wall near computer desks provide easy access for plugging in devices and peripherals.	
☐	**Structured Media Enclosure Closet** (I) A dedicated closet housing your home's networking, media, and electrical equipment in an organized, ventilated space.	
☐	**In-Wall Niche Outlet (Electronic Photo Album Display)** (I) An outlet recessed within a wall niche designed to power lamps, electronic photo frames, or digital displays. Keeps cords hidden for a clean, polished look while ensuring constant power supply.	
☐	**Dog Door Outlet** (I) (P) A dedicated outlet mounted on the wall or door powers automatic or sensor-activated dog doors.	
☐	**Electric Litter Box Location** (I) A dedicated outlet placed near the litter box area to power automatic or self-cleaning litter boxes.	
Interior Lighting		
☐	**Wafer vs Regressed** (I) (L) (L) Choose wafer lights for a thin, flush install in tight ceiling spaces (ceiling joist in the way). Choose regressed recessed lights when you want reduced glare and a higher-end lighting effect.	
☐	**Crawlspace and/or Attic Lighting** (I) Basic lighting in crawlspaces and attics offer safety and visibility during maintenance or inspections. A single bulb with a switch or motion sensor is usually sufficient.	
☐	**Under Fireplace Mantel Lighting** (I) Add LED strip or puck lighting beneath the mantel to highlight textures and create ambient glow. Great for showcasing stone or tile finishes. Use a hidden switch or smart control for a clean look.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Perimeter Recessed Lighting in Bedroom** (I) (V) Install recessed lights around the ceiling edge for a soft ambient glow without shining directly in your face. Ideal for subtle nighttime lighting and a modern look. Pair with dimmers to enhance comfort and reduce glare.	
☐	**Cabinet/Vanity Toe-Kick Lighting** (I) Add low-level LED strip lighting at the toe-kick for soft floor illumination and a modern touch. Ideal for night lighting in kitchens or bathrooms without turning on overhead lights.	
☐	**Under and Top of Cabinet Lighting** (I) (L) Add LED strips or puck lights under cabinets for task lighting and above for soft ambient glow. Enhances kitchen functionality and adds a high-end look.	
☐	**Stair Lighting** (I) (L) Adds safety and style, especially in low-light conditions. Can be placed along the wall, under treads, or on stair risers to provide subtle visibility without harsh glare.	
☐	**Shower Niche Lighting** (I) (V) (L) Provides soft, focused illumination for toiletries and adds a modern, spa-like feel. Waterproof LEDs blend seamlessly into tile work and highlight the niche without overwhelming the space.	
☐	**Cove Lighting (Hidden Recessed Lighting)** (I) Creates soft, indirect illumination by reflecting light off the ceiling or upper walls. Enhances architectural lines and adds a warm, ambient glow without visible fixtures. Often used in bedrooms, living rooms, or tray ceilings.	
☐	**Light and Fan Combo Over Shower** (I) (P) (L) Combines overhead lighting with ventilation in a single, space-saving fixture. Helps remove humidity while providing direct light where it's needed most. Must be rated for wet locations to meet code.	
☐	**Chandelier Lift** (I) (V) (P) Allows a ceiling-mounted chandelier to be lowered for cleaning or bulb changes with the push of a button. Eliminates the need for ladders in high-ceiling areas and improves safety.	
☐	**Under Shelf Lighting (Floating Shelf)** (I) Adds subtle illumination beneath floating shelves, highlighting décor or providing gentle task lighting. Great for kitchens, bars, or display walls.	
☐	**Centered Light Fixtures in Key Areas** (I) Ensure lighting is properly centered over focal points like dining tables, breakfast nooks, kitchen islands, beds, bathroom vanities, and entryways. Off-center fixtures can look awkward and affect light distribution. Double-check placements before rough-in and final install.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Wall Niche Lighting** (I) Highlights architectural niches with subtle, built-in illumination to showcase art, décor, or collectibles. Rough-in electrical early to maintain a clean look with no visible wiring, using recessed or strip lighting.	
☐	**Built-In Bunk Bed Light** (I) (L) Plan wiring during framing to run power to each bunk without exposed cords. Add wall blocking to support mounted fixtures, and place switch boxes within easy reach of each bed.	
☐	**Wall-Mounted Picture Light** (I) (P) Requires planning for low-voltage or hardwired power during rough-in to avoid visible cords. Position junction boxes high enough above the frame and ensure wall blocking is in place for secure mounting. Ideal for a clean, built-in look with no exposed wires.	
Low Voltage Wiring		
☐	**Low Voltage Wiring Installation** (I) Low voltage wiring is typically installed by specialized low-voltage contractors rather than the main electrician. Coordinate scheduling and responsibilities early to ensure smooth integration with other electrical work during construction.	
☐	**Backlit House Numbers** (I) (L) Enhances nighttime visibility with LED lighting behind each digit. They add curb appeal and improve wayfinding for guests and emergency responders.	
☐	**Hardwired Smoke and Carbon Monoxide Detectors** (I) Provides continuous power with battery backup, ensuring reliable safety monitoring. They can be interconnected so that if one alarm sounds, all do. Plan wiring early during rough-in to meet code and maximize protection.	
☐	**Camera Doorbell Wiring (POE)** (I) (V) Ensure wiring is installed at an optimal viewing angle without obstructions. Instead of typical doorbell wiring, consider Ethernet cable for a hardwired POE Doorbell camera for higher quality video.	
☐	**Pre-Wire for Electric Shades** (I) Pre-wire during construction for electric shades, confirming shade type first to determine the correct wiring needed for each window. Early planning ensures seamless installation and operation without costly retrofits.	
☐	**CAT 6 Cable (Ethernet) Uses:** (I) (V) → *Surveillance Cameras (POE) / Outdoor Movie Area / Computers / VOIP Phone / Gaming Devices / Printers / Wireless Access Points / Detached Building / TV's / Doorbell* Supports high-speed, reliable connections for devices like POE surveillance cameras, outdoor movie areas, computers, VOIP phones, gaming consoles, printers, wireless access points, detached buildings, TVs, and doorbells.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**CAT Cable Preference** (I) Choose CAT 6 cable for better performance, though CAT 5E remains adequate for most residential needs. Avoid shielded CAT cables unless specifically recommended by a technician, as they are more expensive and generally unnecessary for homes.	
☐	**Ethernet Ports (CAT 6) in Every Room** (I) (L) Install two CAT 6 Ethernet ports per room to support reliable, high-speed wired internet connections. Essential for smart homes, home offices, and streaming.	
☐	**Network Room** (I) (L) A dedicated closet houses the structured media enclosure, serving as the central hub for routers, CAT cables, and networking equipment. Keeps technology organized and accessible. Plan location, ventilation, and power during design.	
☐	**Network Room Ventilation** (I) (L) Provide ventilation or cooling in the network room when housing numerous electronic devices to prevent overheating. Use dedicated vents, exhaust fans, or mini-split HVAC systems.	
In-Wall Conduit (Smurf Tube)		
☐	**Hard-to-Reach Speaker Locations** (I) Plan speaker placement carefully to avoid hard-to-reach spots that complicate installation and maintenance. Use in-wall conduit (smurf tubes) to make future wiring upgrades easier.	
☐	**Primary Media Locations (Gaming/Entertainment/Audio)** (I) Designate wiring and power for main media areas to support high-quality audio, gaming consoles, and entertainment systems. Ensure ample outlets, network connections, and speaker wiring are accessible and organized for optimal performance and future upgrades.	
☐	**TV to Receiver Wiring** (I) Run HDMI, CAT6, or other necessary cables from the receiver to the TV for seamless audio and video connections. Plan cable routes carefully during construction to avoid visible wiring and ensure easy access for maintenance or upgrades.	
☐	**Conduit to Structured Media Enclosure** (I) Install a large-diameter conduit from the attic, crawlspace, or basement to the structured media enclosure or dedicated network room. This conduit serves as the main pathway for multiple low-voltage cables, ensuring ample capacity for current and future devices.	
☐	**Pull Line in Smurf Tubing/Conduit** (I) (L) Leave a pull line inside smurf tubing or conduit during installation to enable easy wire pulling later. This saves time and effort when adding or upgrading cables in the future.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Speakers		
☐	**Wall Controls for Each Audio Zone** (I) Wall-mounted controls in each audio zone for easy volume adjustment and source selection. Provides convenient, centralized control of multi-room audio systems.	
☐	**Speaker Wire to Every Audio Location** (I) Run speaker wire to all planned audio zones during construction to ensure flexibility and high-quality sound. Use in-wall rated cable and plan pathways carefully to avoid future wiring challenges.	
☐	**Speaker Locations** (I) Position speakers strategically for balanced sound and optimal coverage in each room. Consider furniture placement, room shape, and listening areas. Avoid spots that obstruct sound or complicate wiring access.	
Fireplace		
☐	**Under Fireplace Mantel Lighting** (I) Installing lighting beneath the fireplace mantel enhances the hearth's visual appeal and creates a warm, inviting ambiance. LED strip lights or recessed fixtures are popular choices, offering energy-efficient, low-heat illumination that highlights architectural details without distracting from the fire itself.	
☐	**On/Off Wall Switch** (I) Offers a simple, accessible control for gas or electric fireplaces, enabling quick ignition or shutdown without relying on remote controls. While remotes add convenience, some users report issues like lost remotes, battery failures, or connectivity problems. A wall switch provides a reliable, always-available alternative.	
☐	**Fireplace Hearth Height:** (I) (L) → *Floor Height / Sitting Height* Choosing the right hearth height balances safety, comfort, and aesthetics. Floor-height hearths provide a traditional look and can serve as extra seating or display space. Sitting-height hearths align with furniture levels, offering ergonomic comfort and a modern style. Ensure hearth height meets local code for safe use.	
☐	**Vent Type:** (I) (V) → *Direct Vent / Ventless* Direct vent fireplaces use sealed glass fronts and draw combustion air from outside, safely exhausting gases outdoors. Ideal for energy efficiency and indoor air quality. Ventless fireplaces don't require a chimney or vent, offering easy installation but rely on indoor air for combustion, which can affect oxygen levels and humidity.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Fuel:** (I) → *Electric / Gas / Wood Burning* Electric offers easy installation and low maintenance but limited heat output. Gas provides convenient, controllable heat with minimal cleanup. If choosing gas, ensure the pilot light is quiet. Regular maintenance and proper adjustment help prevent humming or clicking sounds. Before purchasing a gas system, ask for a demo to assess noise levels firsthand. Wood-burning fireplaces create authentic ambiance and warmth but require more maintenance and proper ventilation.	
☐	**Fireplace Locations** (I) Common placements include living rooms, family rooms, and primary bedrooms. Corner or double-sided fireplaces offer design flexibility, while central locations can provide even heat throughout open spaces. Look for opportunities in your floor plan to have double sides fireplaces. Consider proximity to venting options and clearance requirements for safety.	
☐	**Surround or Mantel** (I) Materials range from traditional wood and stone to modern metal or tile, influencing the room's style and heat resistance. A well-chosen mantel can provide display space and enhance the fireplace's role as a focal point.	
☐	**Mantel Material and Style** (I) Mantels come in various materials like wood, stone, metal, or composite, each offering different durability and aesthetics. Traditional wooden mantels add warmth and character, while stone or metal provide a sleek, modern look.	
☐	**Glass/Mesh Front Screen** (I) Front screens enhance safety by preventing sparks and embers from escaping the fireplace. Glass fronts offer a clear view of the fire with a sealed barrier that improves efficiency, especially in gas fireplaces. Mesh screens provide airflow while blocking debris and adding a traditional look, commonly used with wood-burning fireplaces.	
☐	**Measure Fireplace Hearth Height and TV Viewing Angle** (I) (L) Fireplace height can impact the optimal placement and viewing angle of a mounted TV. A hearth that's too tall or low may cause discomfort or awkward sightlines. Planning both elements together ensures a balanced, functional living space.	
Insulation / Drywall		
Insulation		
☐	**Roll/Batt:** (I) (L) → *Fiberglass / Mineral Wool / Sheep Wool* Fiberglass is the cheapest and most common. Mineral wool costs more but adds fire resistance, sound blocking, and handles moisture better. Sheep's wool is the most natural option, regulating humidity and resisting pests, great for eco-friendly builds. All 3 average R-3.5 per inch.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Spray Foam:** (I) (V) ➔ *Open-cell / Closed-cell* Used in walls, ceilings, and hard-to-reach areas, spray foam offers excellent air sealing and insulation in one step. Open-cell is softer and allows for some breathability, while closed-cell is rigid, moisture-resistant, and adds structural support.	
☐	**Blown-In** (I) Loose-fill fiberglass or cellulose is blown onto the ceiling (inside the attic) and sometimes dense-packed into walls, it fills gaps and odd spaces better than batts. It can be messy and may settle over time.	
☐	**Flash & Batt** (I) A hybrid method where a thin layer of spray foam (usually closed-cell for exterior walls) is applied first for air sealing and moisture control, then fiberglass or mineral wool batts are added on top for extra R-value at lower cost. (Spray Foam + Fiberglass)	
☐	**Sound-Damping Insulation** (I) (V) ➔ *Bedroom(s) / Bathroom(s) / Laundry / Under Stairs* Interior walls are not typically insulated. Add this to reduce noise between rooms and floors. Great for primary bedrooms, bathrooms, laundry rooms, and under stairwells to reduce appliance sounds, plumbing noise, and foot traffic.	
☐	**Insulation Ruler Check** (I) (V) Insulation rulers should be installed at the correct height to accurately measure blown-in insulation depth. Some contractors may lower the ruler to give the appearance of full coverage while using less material. Proper placement ensures the target R-value is truly met.	
☐	**Radiant Barrier and Spray Foam Compatibility** (I) (L) When radiant barrier OSB is used for roof sheathing, spray foam should not be applied directly to the foil side. Doing so reduces the barrier's effectiveness by eliminating the air gap it needs to reflect heat. Maintain proper spacing to preserve performance.	
☐	**Insulation Option by Location** (I) You can choose different insulation types for different areas. Example: Spray foam for exterior walls, sound batts for interior walls, and blown-in for the ceilings. The best IMO: Exterior continuous insulation, batt exterior wall cavity, sound batts for interior walls, blown in ceiling.	
☐	**Insulated Garage Doors** (I) (V) Especially important if the garage is conditioned, used for a gym, or shares walls with living space.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Garage Insulation** (I) Not typically standard, garage insulation is often an upgrade that improves temperature control, noise reduction, and energy efficiency. Pair with insulated garage doors for full benefit.	
☐	**Spray Foam on Porch Roof** (I) (V) (L) Applying spray foam under a porch roof helps block radiant heat and keep the space cooler during summer months. It creates an air seal that reduces heat transfer, especially under metal or dark-colored roofing.	
Drywall		
☐	**Drywall Finish Level:** (I) → *Level 0 / Level 1 / Level 2 / Level 3 / Level 4 / Level 5* Level 0–2: Basic coverage or fire taping, not suitable for finished spaces. Level 3: For heavy texture or wallpaper. Level 4: Standard and most common for painted walls with light texture. Level 5: Highest finish, required for smooth or glossy surfaces under strong lighting.	
☐	**Drywall Thickness:** (I) → *1/2" Drywall / 5/8" Drywall* The standard is 1/2" for walls and 5/8" for ceilings, but using 5/8" throughout adds durability, reduces noise, and hides imperfections better. It also resists sagging and provides a more solid feel. Ideal for high-traffic areas or homes with sound-sensitive rooms.	
☐	**Drywall Corners:** (I) (L) → *Bullnose / Square* Bullnose corners offer a soft, rounded look that adds a subtle design touch, while square corners provide a clean, sharp finish. The choice is purely aesthetic but impacts trim and baseboard compatibility.	
☐	**Wall Texture Options:** (I) → *Orange Peel / Knockdown / Skip Trowel / Swirled / Smooth / Other Border* Texture affects both appearance and how well walls hide imperfections. Orange peel and knockdown are the most common, while flat walls offer a sleek look but require more prep. Decorative options like skip trowel or swirl add character but may limit future changes.	
☐	**Ceiling Texture Options:** (I) (L) → *Orange Peel / Knockdown / Skip Trowel / Swirled / Smooth / Other Texture* Orange peel and knockdown are common and hide imperfections well, while flat ceilings offer a clean, modern finish but require higher drywall quality. Swirled and skip trowel add a more decorative touch. Choose based on style preference, maintenance, and lighting conditions.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Sound-Dampening Drywall** (I) Designed with extra mass or layered construction to reduce sound transmission between rooms. Ideal for bedrooms, bathrooms, media rooms, or shared walls. Costs more than standard drywall but offers noticeable acoustic improvement.	
☐	**No Trash Left Behind Before Insulation/Drywall** (I) (L) Ensure all construction debris, like scrap wood, wrappers, or drink bottles, is removed from wall cavities before insulation. Trapped trash can cause bulges, fire risks, or pest issues once drywall is installed.	
☐	**Plumbing Access Panels** (I) (L) Prevents the need to cut drywall for repairs and helps to inspect areas for leaking (behind tub/shower mixing valves). Best placed in closets or low-visibility areas.	
Kitchen		
☐	**Kitchen Island:** (I) → *Single Island / Double Island* Single islands provide versatile workspace and storage, ideal for most kitchens. Double islands add extra prep areas and seating but require larger spaces and careful flow planning. Make sure your kitchen island includes an overhang for seating.	
☐	**Island Bench Seating (Booth Style)** (I) Booth-style seating around a kitchen island creates a cozy, informal dining space with built-in benches. Maximizes seating efficiency and adds a comfortable, social atmosphere. Requires sufficient island size and thoughtful layout.	
Countertop		
☐	**Save Sink Cutout for Cutting Board or Removable Cover** (I) Save the countertop sink cutout for a cutting board. Note that cutting directly on the board may dull knives. For this reason, some will use it as a cheese board instead. Just make sure you ask the builder to save it.	
☐	**Countertop Thickness (Standard: 1.25")** (I) Standard countertops are typically 1.25" thick, balancing durability and aesthetics. Thicker slabs offer a premium look but add weight and cost. Consider material, edge profile, and support needs when selecting thickness.	
☐	**Countertop Material:** (I) → *Granite / Quartz / Quartzite / Marble / Concrete / Butcher Block* Choose materials based on durability, maintenance, and style preferences. Granite and quartz offer hard, low-maintenance surfaces; quartzite and marble provide natural stone beauty with varied care needs; concrete allows custom finishes but requires sealing; butcher block adds warmth but demands regular oiling.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Thick Island - Thin Perimeter Counters** (I) (V) Creates a focal point by making the island appear bolder. Thicker slab (2.5”+) adds weight and presence, while thinner 1.25” perimeter counters keep balance and cost down. Mitered edges can fake the thickness.	
☐	**Countertop Color** (I) Complement the cabinetry and overall kitchen design. Light colors brighten spaces and hide scratches less, while dark colors offer contrast and hide wear better. Consider trends, personal style, and maintenance when choosing.	
☐	**Countertop Heights** (I) Standard countertop height is around 36”, ideal for most tasks and comfortable for average users. Lower or adjustable heights benefit baking or seated work, while raised bars (42”) create casual dining spaces.	
☐	**Countertop Edge Style** (I) Edge styles range from simple straight or eased edges to decorative bevels, bullnose, or ogee profiles. The choice affects aesthetics, safety, and cleaning ease.	
☐	**Countertop Protection** (I) (L) Protect countertops with temporary coverings like plastic film, cardboard, or padded mats during construction to prevent scratches, stains, and impact damage.	
Backsplash		
☐	**Caulking at Backsplash and Countertop Seam** (I) Use grout-colored caulking, not grout, at the seam between backsplash and countertop. This flexible seal prevents cracking and water damage, as grout in this area tends to crack first. Proper application extends the lifespan of the joint.	
☐	**Backsplash Grout Type:** (I) → *Cement Grout / Epoxy Grout / Single Component Grout* Cement grout is affordable but porous and prone to staining. Epoxy grout is durable, stain-resistant, and waterproof but harder to work with. Single component grout offers easy application and moderate durability.	
☐	**Backsplash Style and Color** (I) Select backsplash style and color to complement countertops and cabinetry. Options range from classic subway tiles to modern mosaics, with colors that either blend subtly or provide bold contrast.	
☐	**Backsplash Coverage and Height** (I) (L) Decide how far and wide the backsplash extends. The standard is wall to wall lower to upper cabinets, but look for opportunities to take the backsplash to the ceiling for dramatic effect.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Backsplash Grout Color** (I) Grout color influences the tile's overall look. Matching grout creates a seamless, uniform surface, while contrasting grout highlights patterns and shapes. Darker grout hides stains better; lighter grout brightens spaces.	
Sink		
☐	**Sink Glass Rinser** (I) (P) A glass rinser sprays water from the sink deck to quickly and efficiently rinse glasses and small dishes. Ideal for busy kitchens and bars to speed up cleanup.	
☐	**Sink Garbage Disposal:** (I) → *Wall Switch / Air switch* Garbage disposals can be activated by traditional wall switches or air switches mounted on the countertop. Air switches offer added safety by isolating electrical components from water. Plan for wiring and placement ahead of time.	
☐	**Sink Drain Location:** (I) → *Side / Middle* The drain's position impacts cabinet storage and plumbing layout. Side drains free up space beneath the sink for larger items, ideal for maximizing storage. Middle drains offer straightforward plumbing and efficient water flow but can limit under-sink organization.	
☐	**Sink Mount:** (I) → *Drop-in / Under-Mount / Farmhouse / Integrated Sink* Drop-in sinks are easy to install with visible edges resting on the countertop. Under-mount sinks create a seamless look with counters and simplify cleaning. Farmhouse sinks feature a front apron for a classic style and deep basin. Integrated sinks blend with the countertop material for a sleek, modern appearance.	
☐	**Sink Style:** (I) → *Single Basin Sink / Double Sink* Single basin sinks offer a large, uninterrupted space ideal for washing oversized pots and pans. Double basin sinks provide separate areas for washing and rinsing or multitasking.	
☐	**Wall-Mounted Faucet** (I) Wall-mounted faucets free up countertop space and create a sleek, modern look. Ideal for farmhouse or apron-front sinks and easy countertop cleaning.	
☐	**Faucet Style and Color** (I) From traditional to modern, choose a faucet that complements kitchen design and functionality. Finish options like chrome, matte black, brushed nickel, or brass impact aesthetics and durability.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Sink / Workstation Brand** (I) (P) Select reputable sink and workstation brands known for durability, design, and functionality. Popular options offer integrated accessories like cutting boards and drying racks.	
☐	**Sink size: 30"-36"** (I) Sinks between 30" and 36" provide ample space for most kitchen tasks without overwhelming the countertop. Choose size based on kitchen layout, cabinet dimensions, and your cooking habits for optimal balance of function and style.	
☐	**Extra Faucet for XL Sinks** (I) For extra-large sinks, adding a second faucet improves functionality by allowing simultaneous use for tasks like washing and rinsing. Plan plumbing and deck space early to accommodate multiple fixtures.	
☐	**Removable Sink Drain Strainer** (I) (P) Catches food debris to prevent clogs while allowing easy cleaning. Essential for maintaining plumbing health and minimizing sink blockages. Choose durable, rust-resistant materials for longevity.	
☐	**Sink Bottom Wire Rack** (I) Protects the sink's surface from scratches and dents caused by pots, pans, and utensils. Allows water to drain freely, preventing standing water that can lead to stains or odors. Choose racks that fit snugly and are easy to remove for cleaning and drying.	
☐	**Sink Pedal** (I) A foot-operated sink pedal allows hands-free control of water flow, improving hygiene and convenience, especially useful when handling messy tasks or cooking. Requires compatible faucet valves and early plumbing planning for smooth installation and reliable operation.	
☐	**Sink Soap Pump** (I) Keeps countertops clutter-free and provides easy access to soap or lotion. Choose models with refillable reservoirs compatible with your preferred soap type. Plan location near the faucet for convenience and ensure compatibility with sink thickness during installation.	
☐	**Soap Dispenser Tube Kit** (I) (P) Includes the internal tubing and connections needed to link a soap dispenser to its reservoir. Quality kits ensure smooth, clog-free soap flow and easy maintenance. When selecting, consider compatibility with your dispenser model. Planning for tubing routing helps avoid leaks and prolongs dispenser life.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Filtered Water Options:** (I) (P) (P) (P) → *Under-Sink / Countertop Mount / Faucet Mount* Under-sink systems offer high-capacity filtration with hidden components, preserving countertop space but requiring more complex installation and occasional filter changes. Countertop-mounted units are easier to install and maintain but take up surface space. Faucet-mounted filters are simple and affordable but may reduce water flow and offer limited filtration.	
☐	**Instant Hot Water Dispenser** (I) Provides near-boiling water on demand for cooking, beverages, and cleaning, saving time and energy. Requires dedicated plumbing and electrical connections, often installed beside the main faucet. Consider safety features like child locks and insulated taps, especially in homes with children.	
☐	**Sink with Built-In Cutting Board and Colander** (I) Integrates prep tools directly into the sink area, saving countertop space and streamlining workflow. Cutting boards and colanders fit snugly for easy use and cleanup. Plan for accessories that are dishwasher-safe and easy to remove or store when not in use.	
☐	**Sink Drying Rack** (I) Designed to fit over or inside the sink maximizes space by allowing water to drip directly into the basin. Ideal for small kitchens, it keeps countertops clear and promotes faster drying. Look for rust-resistant materials and foldable or removable designs for easy storage and cleaning.	
Other		
☐	**Toe Kick Vacuum (Under Cabinet)** (I) (P) Requires dedicated ducting and power, so plan installation early during cabinet and flooring design. Consider convenient placement near food prep areas for maximum usability.	
☐	**Coffee/Wet Bar Sink** (I) A compact sink designed for coffee prep or wet bar use, saving space while providing water access for cleaning and beverage prep. Often includes accessories like built-in drains or mini garbage disposals.	
☐	**Pot Filler(s):** (I) (V) (P) (L) (P) → *Standard Pot Filler / Deck Mounted Pot Filler / Coffee Pot Filler / Pet Pot Filler* A wall-mounted faucet near the stove for easy pot filling, reducing trips to the sink. Also useful for coffee machines and pet water bowls. Requires proper plumbing and splash area planning to avoid obstructing burners or workspace. A deck mounted pot filler serves the same purpose but is installed directly on the countertop or sink deck.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Water Line for Coffee Maker/Ice Maker** (I) Provide dedicated water lines to coffee makers and ice makers for seamless operation without manual filling. Plan routing during plumbing rough-in, ensuring easy access for maintenance and shutoff valves for convenience.	
☐	**Built-In Wall Water Fountain/Bottle Filler** (I) (P) Integrated into walls for convenient, hands-free hydration in kitchens or mudrooms. Offers quick access for filling bottles or drinking directly. Requires dedicated water supply and drainage planning. Consider adding built in storage below the filler for a place to store water bottles.	
Appliances		
☐	**Appliances:** (I) → *Panel Ready / Built-In / Freestanding* Panel ready appliances blend seamlessly with cabinetry for a clean look but often come at a higher cost. Built-in units fit custom spaces, offering streamlined design and space-saving benefits. Freestanding appliances provide flexibility and easier replacement but may not blend as smoothly with cabinetry.	
☐	**Cooktop:** (I) → *Gas Cooktop / Electric Cooktop / Induction Cooktop* Gas offers precise heat control; electric provides even heating; induction is energy-efficient and fast but requires compatible cookware. Consider installation needs and ventilation.	
☐	**Range Hood Venting:** (I) → *Ducted / Ductless* Ducted hoods vent cooking fumes outside, offering superior air quality but require exterior vent installation. Ductless hoods recirculate filtered air indoors, easier to install but less effective at odor removal.	
☐	**Range Hood with Remote Blowers** (I) Remote blowers relocate the fan motor away from the kitchen, significantly reducing noise. Ideal for quieter cooking spaces but require additional ductwork and careful planning during installation.	
☐	**Refrigerator Size and Style** (I) Select a refrigerator size and style that fits your kitchen layout and household needs. Watch for dimensions and door swing type to avoid hitting nearby walls.	

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	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Dishwasher Style:** (I) (P) (L) ➔ *Standard Dishwasher / Two Dishwashers / Elevated Dishwasher / Dishwasher Sink Combo* Double dishwashers are great for extra busy kitchens but require extra plumbing and electrical. Raised dishwashers to counter height reduces back strain by bringing loading closer to waist level. A dishwasher sink combo Integrates a compact dishwasher with a sink, saving space in small kitchens or apartments. All options require planning for plumbing and electrical connections as well as cabinetry measurements.	
☐	**Cooktop Size: 30”-36”** (I) Choose between 30” or 36” cooktops based on kitchen size and cooking needs. Larger sizes offer more burners and workspace but require more countertop room and ventilation capacity. Plan cabinet and countertop layout accordingly.	
☐	**Double Oven** (I) Double ovens provide separate cooking chambers for multitasking and large meal prep. Ideal for families and entertaining. Requires additional wall space and proper ventilation; plan electrical and installation early.	
☐	**Range Oven** (I) A range combines a cooktop and oven in one unit, saving space and simplifying kitchen design. Available in various sizes and fuel types.	
☐	**Built-In Coffee/Cappuccino Machine** (I) Integrates seamlessly into kitchen cabinetry for a sleek, high-end look. Offers convenience with programmable settings and quick brewing. Requires dedicated electrical outlets, water supply, and drainage.	
☐	**Appliance Drain Pans** (I) (P) Placed under appliances like refrigerators, dishwashers, or water heaters to catch leaks and prevent water damage. Optional in-floor drains can be connected for efficient water removal. Plan drainage routing during installation to minimize damage risk.	
☐	**Fridge Water Line Connection** (I) Connect the fridge water line to the filtered water system to ensure clean, great-tasting water and ice. Plumbing lines may need to be routed discreetly through cabinetry, so plan pathways and access during installation to avoid leaks.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Microwave:** (I) → *Over-the-Range Microwave / Built-In Microwave / Microwave Drawer / Freestanding Microwave* Over-the-range microwaves save countertop space and often include built-in venting but sit above the stove, which can be hard to reach. Microwave drawers are installed below counters for easy access and a streamlined look but require additional cabinet space. Built-in microwaves are often built into the cabinetry above the oven, but location is personal preference. Freestanding microwaves sit on top of counter space and can be relocated easily. Note: If you have a butler's pantry, some prefer having their microwave built in there.	
☐	**Ice Maker** (I) (V) Requires water line access and proper drainage planning. Place ice makers away from bedrooms and TV rooms. They refill often and can be surprisingly noisy.	
Kitchen Cabinets		
Cabinets		
☐	**Toe Kick Lighting** (I) Installed beneath base cabinets adds subtle, low-level illumination that enhances kitchen ambiance and improves safety by lighting floor areas. LED strips are commonly used for energy efficiency and long life. This feature also highlights cabinet design and can serve as night lighting.	
☐	**Pan Storage with Built-in Lid Drawer** (I) (L) A dedicated built-In drawer for lids keeps cookware organized and easily accessible. This design prevents clutter, simplifies meal prep, and protects lids from damage by providing a designated, separate space close to pans.	
☐	**Deep Drawer Next to Wall Ovens for Pan Storage** (I) A deep drawer located next to ovens offers convenient storage for pans, baking sheets, and trays. Positioned near the cooking area, it streamlines kitchen workflow and keeps essential cookware within easy reach while maximizing otherwise unused space.	
☐	**Recessed Area Behind Fridge/Deeper Cabinets** (I) (L) Allows a standard-depth fridge to sit flush with surrounding cabinetry for a streamlined look. Alternatively, opting for deeper cabinets accommodates larger fridge models and provides extra storage space, but may impact kitchen layout and aisle width.	
☐	**Panel-Ready Appliances (Match Cabinets)** (I) Allow custom cabinet panels to be attached, seamlessly blending refrigerators, dishwashers, and other units into kitchen cabinetry. This creates a cohesive, built-in appearance that enhances overall design while maintaining full appliance functionality.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Cabinet Doors:** (I) ➔ *Solid / Glass* Solid cabinet doors offer privacy and a clean, uniform look while providing durability and easy maintenance. Glass doors add visual interest and help display dish-ware or decorative items, brightening the kitchen space. If you want both, you can select both options.	
☐	**Cabinets to the Ceiling** (I) (L) Extending cabinets to the ceiling maximizes storage space and creates a seamless, custom look. It reduces dust collection on top of cabinets and can enhance kitchen height perception. Consider accessibility for upper shelves and potential use of step stools or ladders.	
☐	**Cabinet Material:** (I) ➔ *Hardwood Cabinets / Plywood Cabinets / MDF / Particleboard* Hardwood offers strength and longevity with a natural look but comes at a higher price. Plywood sheathing provides sturdy, moisture resistant construction favored for cabinet boxes. MDF offers smooth surfaces ideal for painted finishes but may be less moisture-resistant. Particleboard is an economical option but less durable and prone to swelling if exposed to moisture.	
☐	**Cabinet Style and Color** (I) Cabinet style, from traditional shaker to sleek flat panel, shapes the kitchen's overall appearance, while color choices influence mood and brightness. Light colors can make spaces feel larger and more open, while darker tones add warmth and drama.	
☐	**Cabinet Overlay:** (I) ➔ *Full Overlay / Partial Overlay / Inset* Full overlay cabinets create a modern, seamless look with minimal frame showing. Partial overlay cabinets offer a more traditional style at a lower cost but expose more of the frame. Inset cabinets deliver a high-end, custom appearance with doors set flush inside the frame, though they are more expensive and require precise craftsmanship.	
☐	**Cabinet Hardware Style and Color** (I) Hardware style and color enhance cabinet design and functionality. Options range from classic knobs and pull to modern bar handles, available in finishes like brushed nickel, matte black, brass, or chrome.	
☐	**Deep Drawers for Lower Cabinets/Shelving for Upper Cabinets** (I) Deep drawers in lower cabinets offer easy access and ample storage for pots, pans, and bulky items, reducing bending and searching. Upper cabinets with adjustable shelving provide flexible storage for dishes, glassware, and pantry items, allowing customization to fit varying needs.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Under Sink Drawers (Wrap-Around Plumbing)** (I) (L) Designed to wrap around plumbing and maximize storage space in typically tight areas. Custom cutouts or U-shaped drawers provide accessible compartments around pipes, making efficient use of awkward spaces without sacrificing organization.	
☐	**Island Bookshelf End** (I) Adding a bookshelf to the end of a kitchen island offers functional storage for cookbooks, decorative items, or frequently used kitchen tools. It creates an inviting focal point and maximizes space without disrupting workflow.	
☐	**Toe Kick Drawers** (I) Toe kick drawers utilize the space beneath base cabinets for slim, hidden storage ideal for flat items like baking sheets, trays, or cleaning supplies. They maximize every inch of the kitchen, keeping essentials accessible yet out of sight.	
☐	**Bi-Fold Doors** (I) Bi-fold doors fold in sections to open compactly, saving space in tight areas. They provide easy access without requiring full door swing clearance, making them ideal for maximizing usable space.	
☐	**Appliance Garage** (I) Provides a dedicated, concealed space to store countertop appliances like toasters and mixers, keeping the kitchen tidy while maintaining easy access. Often featuring roll-up or bi-fold doors, it protects appliances from dust and frees up workspace.	
Organization		
☐	**Hand Towel Rack/Dryer** (I) A dedicated hand towel rack or dryer keeps towels within easy reach near the sink while allowing them to dry efficiently. Options include wall-mounted bars, pull-out racks, or integrated towel holders inside cabinets, helping maintain a tidy and functional kitchen.	
☐	**Blind Corner Storage Shelf** (I) (V) (P) (L) (L) (L) Blind corner storage shelves maximize otherwise hard-to-reach cabinet corners, providing convenient access to pots, pans, and pantry items. Solutions like pull-out shelves or rotating lazy susans improve visibility and usability in tight spaces.	
☐	**Infinity Drawer (Blind Corner)** (I) (V) (L) Rotates 360 degrees including the drawer face, turning blind corner dead space into a full-size drawer instead of a lazy susan or pull-out shelf. Made only by Riverwood Craft.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Mixer Lift** (I) (P) (L) A pull-out platform inside a cabinet that raises heavy appliances like stand mixers to countertop height for easy use, then lowers them out of sight for storage. This feature saves counter space and improves kitchen ergonomics.	
☐	**Family Command Center/Drop Zone** (I) A dedicated command center or drop zone with a family calendar, message board, and storage helps keep household schedules organized and accessible. Positioned near the kitchen or entryway, it serves as a central hub for keys, mail, and reminders, streamlining daily routines and communication.	
☐	**Pull-Out Pantry Drawers** (I) Instead of reaching deep into shelves, pull-out drawers let you slide everything out to view contents easily.	
☐	**Built-In Drawer Dividers** (I) Creates customized compartments within drawers, keeping utensils, tools, and small items neatly separated and easy to find. They enhance drawer functionality and reduce clutter for a more organized kitchen workspace.	
☐	**Pull-Out Paper Towel Dispenser** (I) Integrated into a cabinet keeps towels hidden yet easily accessible. This space-saving design declutters countertops and protects paper towels from moisture, maintaining a tidy and functional kitchen.	
☐	**Angled Utensil Drawer** (I) (P) Provides ergonomic access by tilting utensils toward the user, making it easier to see and grab frequently used tools. This design maximizes drawer space and improves kitchen workflow.	
☐	**Pull-Out Utensil Bin** (I) (P) Keeps cooking tools organized and within easy reach, neatly tucked away inside a cabinet. This space-efficient design helps declutter countertops and streamlines meal preparation.	
☐	**Built-In Knife Drawer** (I) (P) Safely stores knives in a dedicated, organized space, often featuring slots or magnetic strips to protect blades and prevent accidents. Positioned near prep areas, it enhances kitchen safety and efficiency.	
☐	**Spice Rack Drawer** (I) (P) Provides organized, easily accessible storage for spices and small bottles. Designed with angled inserts or tiered trays, it keeps labels visible and maximizes space in kitchen drawers.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Pull-Out/Slide-Out Shelves** (I) (P) Improves accessibility by bringing stored items fully into view, reducing the need to reach deep into cabinets. They enhance organization and make loading and unloading more efficient, especially in lower cabinets and pantry areas.	
☐	**Magnetic Peg Drawer** (I) (V) (L) Keeps pots, pans, lids, and containers from sliding every time you open the drawer. Traditional peg drawers use fixed hole patterns. The magnetic version uses a metal base with fully movable pegs, letting you position supports exactly where you need them.	
☐	**Vertical Cookie Sheet/Cutting Board Cabinet** (I) Designed to store cookie sheets, cutting boards, and baking pans upright maximizes space and keeps these flat items organized and easily accessible. Dividers or slots help separate items and prevent damage.	
☐	**False Front Drawer Tray (Sink Storage)** (I) (P) Fits beneath the sink's plumbing, providing hidden, shallow storage for cleaning supplies and small items. This clever use of space keeps essentials organized while concealing plumbing pipes and maintaining a clean cabinet appearance.	
☐	**Range Hood Storage** (I) Incorporating storage near or above the range hood offers convenient space for spices, cooking oils, or frequently used utensils. Properly designed cabinets or shelves maximize kitchen efficiency without obstructing ventilation or workspace.	
☐	**Open Shelving with Underside Hooks (Mugs)** (I) Open shelves equipped with underside hooks provide stylish and accessible storage for mugs, freeing up cabinet space while adding visual interest. This setup keeps mugs within easy reach and enhances kitchen décor with a personalized touch.	
☐	**Cutting Board Slide-Out (Installed Over Trash)** (I) Maximizes kitchen efficiency by providing a convenient prep surface that can be tucked away when not in use. This setup streamlines food preparation and simplifies cleanup by positioning the trash directly below for easy disposal.	
☐	**Trash Bag Holder Behind Trash Can** (I) Keeps replacement bags organized and easily accessible. This simple addition reduces clutter and speeds up bag changes, maintaining a tidy kitchen space.	
☐	**Pull-Out Trash/Recycle Bin** (I) (P) A pull-out trash and recycle bin integrated into cabinetry keeps waste concealed yet easily accessible. This design streamlines kitchen cleanup, maximizes floor space, and maintains a clean, organized appearance.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Pantry		
☐	**Appliance Garage** (I) An appliance garage hides bulky items like air fryers and crock pots in a dedicated cabinet or pantry space, keeping countertops clean while allowing easy access. Features often include roll-up or lift-up doors, built-in outlets, and ventilation.	
☐	**Costco Door (Pantry Access from Garage)** (I) (V) Provides direct access from the garage to the pantry, making grocery unloading quick and convenient. Plan location, security, and insulation early.	
☐	**Pantry Door Style:** (I) → *Clear Glass* / *Frosted Glass* / *Frosted Glass with stencil* / *Hollow Core* / *Solid Wood* / *Barn Door* / *Swinging Door* Each offers different levels of privacy, aesthetics, and functionality. Frosted glass adds light while maintaining privacy, barn doors save space, and solid wood offers durability. Consider your kitchen layout and style when selecting.	
☐	**Mini Sink** (I) A mini sink in the pantry or prep area adds convenience for quick cleanups, handwashing, or rinsing produce. Saves trips to the main kitchen sink and improves workflow. Plan plumbing access and countertop space during design.	
☐	**Pantry Countertop** (I) A pantry countertop provides extra workspace for food prep, small appliances, or storage. Choose durable, easy-to-clean materials that match or complement the main kitchen surfaces. Plan for lighting and electrical outlets nearby.	
☐	**Pantry Cabinets** (I) Pantry cabinets maximize organized storage with adjustable shelves, pull-out drawers, and clear fronts for visibility. Choose durable materials and finishes that match kitchen style. Consider deep cabinets for bulk items and easy access features like soft-close doors.	
☐	**Butler Pantry** (I) A dedicated space between the kitchen and dining area for extra storage, prep, and staging. Often includes countertops, cabinets, a sink, and sometimes appliances.	
☐	**Shelving:** (I) → *Wood Shelving* / *Wire Shelving* Choose wood shelves for a classic, sturdy look and wire shelves for better airflow and easy cleaning. Wood is ideal for heavy items and aesthetics; wire works well in humid areas to prevent moisture buildup. Consider weight capacity and maintenance when selecting.	
☐	**Dumbwaiter** (I) (V) (L) A small freight elevator designed to transport food, dishes, or other items between floors. Ideal for multi-level homes, it improves convenience and reduces carrying trips. Framing must include a dedicated shaft with proper clearances and structural support.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Bathrooms		
☐	**Humidity Sensor Switch** (I) (P) A humidity sensor switch automatically controls bathroom ventilation based on moisture levels, helping prevent mold and mildew buildup. Proper placement and calibration ensure effective humidity control and energy efficiency.	
☐	**Exhaust Fan Size (1 CFM per sq ft)** (I) Bathroom exhaust fans should provide at least 1 cubic foot per minute (CFM) of airflow per square foot of space to effectively remove moisture. Correct sizing prevents mold growth and maintains air quality.	
☐	**Exhaust Fan Locations** (I) Place exhaust fans near moisture sources like showers or tubs for optimal ventilation. Ceiling-mounted fans work well, but wall-mounted options may be used if ceiling installation isn't possible. Two fans are ideal, one for the shower area, and one for the toilet room. But if one fan is the only option, position it closer to the shower, prioritizing water removal.	
☐	**Exhaust Fan on Timers** (I) Ensures they run long enough to clear humidity without being left on all day. Options range from simple mechanical timers to digital models with preset intervals (e.g., 10–60 minutes). Helps prevent mold and saves energy with minimal user effort.	
Tub(s)		
☐	**Bathtub Protection** (I) (V) (P) Protect tubs during construction using foam board covered with plywood on the top and sides for sturdy, effective coverage. Products like Tub Armor provide basic protection but are less durable. Secure, breathable coverings prevent scratches, dents, and moisture damage, preserving the tub's finish until project completion.	
☐	**Tub Faucet Pipe Securing** (I) (V) Secure tub faucet pipes firmly to prevent movement, leaks, or strain on plumbing connections. Proper support during installation ensures stable faucet operation and reduces long-term maintenance issues. Use appropriate brackets or clamps and verify alignment before finishing walls.	
☐	**Spray Foam Around Tub for Insulation** (I) Applying spray foam insulation around the tub reduces heat loss and prevents cold spots, improving comfort. It also seals gaps to block moisture, reducing mold risk, and creates a solid foundation that supports tub stability.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Tub Filler:** (I) (P) (L) ➔ *Floor Mounted Filler / Wall Mounted Filler / Ceiling Mounted Filler* Ceiling-mounted tub fillers offer a sleek, modern look and frees up wall space but require more complex plumbing. Wall-mounted fillers are more common, easier to install, and provide flexible placement, but they can limit surrounding wall design options. A floor-mounted filler complements modern, transitional, and classic styles. It allows you to place the tub anywhere in the room, not just against a wall.	
☐	**Alternate Bathroom Tub/Shower** (I) Alternate bathrooms typically feature compact tub/shower combos or standalone showers to maximize space. Choose durable, low-maintenance materials and fixtures that fit the smaller footprint without sacrificing comfort.	
☐	**Tub on Bed of Mortar** (I) (V) Setting a tub on a bed of mortar provides a stable, level foundation that prevents movement and floor flex, reducing noise. It also helps evenly distribute weight, protecting plumbing connections and extending the tub's lifespan.	
☐	**Fiberglass Tub:** (I) ➔ *One piece / Two-Piece* One-piece fiberglass tubs have seamless construction, making them easier to clean and eliminating seams where mold can develop. Two-piece tubs consist of separate tub and surround panels, which can be easier to install in tight spaces but have more joints that may require maintenance.	
☐	**Bathtub Drain Position:** (I) ➔ *Left / Right / Center* Drain position affects plumbing layout and bathroom design. Choose left, right, or center based on existing plumbing and tub orientation. Proper placement ensures efficient drainage and easier installation while fitting the room's flow and aesthetics.	
☐	**Location of Tub Faucet:** (I) ➔ *Centered Faucet / Right Faucet / Left Faucet* Tub faucet placement impacts usability and plumbing. Side (left or right) and centered faucets depend on tub design and bathroom layout, while wall-mounted faucets save deck space and offer flexible styling.	
☐	**Tub Faucet Color and Style** (I) Choose tub faucet colors and styles that complement the bathroom's overall design. Popular finishes include chrome, brushed nickel, oil-rubbed bronze, and matte black. Styles range from classic to modern.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Tub Material:** (I) → *Fiberglass Tub / Acrylic / Cast Iron / Porcelain / Vikrell / Ceramic* Tub materials vary in durability, weight, and appearance. Fiberglass and acrylic are lightweight and affordable but less durable. Cast iron is heavy, durable, and retains heat well but requires strong floor support. Porcelain and ceramic offer classic looks but can chip. Vikrell is a durable composite with a smooth finish, combining benefits of acrylic and fiberglass.	
☐	**Tub Type:** (I) → *Freestanding Tub / Drop-in Tub / Corner Tub / Alcove Tub* Freestanding tubs offer a stylish centerpiece and flexible placement but require more space. Drop-in tubs sit within a built-up deck, providing a finished look with customizable surrounds. Corner tubs maximize bathroom space, ideal for larger rooms or unique layouts. Alcove tubs fit into a three-wall recess, saving space and often combined with shower setups.	
☐	**Double Person Tub** (I) Opt for side-by-side models, which provide optimal comfort even during single use. These tubs require more bathroom space and sturdy flooring support. Consider features like armrests and contoured backs, and choose styles that complement your bathroom's layout and design.	
☐	**Freestanding Bathroom Tub Plumbing** (I) If choosing a freestanding tub, know they require exposed plumbing, typically routed from the floor, which demands early planning, especially with slab foundations, to ensure proper placement and connections.	
Tile		
☐	**XL Shower Tiles** (I) Larger tiles are easier to clean because they have fewer grout lines, reducing areas where dirt and grime can accumulate. Keep in mind that XL tiles on the floor are considered slippery and increase fall risk if they are not textured.	
☐	**Caulking Where Wall Tile Meets Floor Tile** (I) Use caulking that matches grout color where wall tile meets floor tile, as these joint experiences movement and is prone to cracking if filled with grout. Caulk accommodates expansion and contraction, preventing cracks and water infiltration for longer-lasting, clean joints.	
☐	**Shower Niche Tile** (I) Shower niche tile is typically different from the main shower tile to create a visual accent and highlight the storage area. Whether matching or contrasting, ensure proper waterproofing and sloped shelves to prevent water pooling and mold growth.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Shower and Niche Sill Slope** (I) Tiles in areas prone to water accumulation, likes niches, sills, floors, and benches should be installed with a slight tilt to direct water away. Proper slope prevents standing water, reduces mold risk, and helps maintain tile and grout durability over time.	
☐	**Tile Entire Accent Wall** (I) Choose tiles that complement the overall color scheme and consider grout color to enhance or soften the design. Ensure proper waterproofing behind the tiles to prevent moisture issues.	
☐	**Tile Grout Type:** (I) → *Cement Grout / Epoxy Grout / Single Component Grout* Cement grout is common and affordable but requires sealing to resist stains and cracking. Epoxy grout is highly durable, stain-resistant, and waterproof, ideal for wet or high-traffic areas, though harder to install. Single component grout is premixed for easy application but less durable than epoxy, suitable for smaller or less demanding projects.	
☐	**Tile Grout Color** (I) Grout color influences the tile's overall look. Matching grout creates a seamless, uniform surface, while contrasting grout highlights patterns and shapes. Darker grout hides stains better; lighter grout brightens spaces.	
☐	**Tile Size, Color, and Style** (I) Larger tiles offer a modern, seamless look with fewer grout lines, while smaller tiles add texture and detail. Colors range from neutrals to bold hues, chosen to complement room design and lighting.	
Vanity		
☐	**Toe Kick Lighting** (I) Toe kick lighting installed beneath the vanity adds subtle, ambient illumination that enhances safety and style. It helps navigate the bathroom at night without harsh overhead lights. Choose LED strips with dimmable features and moisture-resistant ratings.	
☐	**Under Sink Drawers (Wrap-Around Plumbing)** (I) (L) Drawers designed to wrap around plumbing maximize storage space beneath the sink by contouring around pipes. Ensure drawer construction allows easy access and smooth operation despite plumbing obstacles. Proper sealing prevents moisture damage from potential leaks.	
☐	**Built-In Vanity Step (Drawer for Kids)** (I) A built-in vanity step drawer provides a hidden, sturdy platform for kids to reach the sink safely. It maximizes space by combining storage and function.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Floating Vanity** (I) Floating vanities are wall-mounted, creating a modern, open look and making floor cleaning easier. Proper installation requires strong wall support to handle weight.	
☐	**Countertop Edge Style** (I) Countertop edges come in various profiles, from simple straight or eased edges to more decorative bevels and bullnose styles. Choose an edge that complements the vanity design and balances aesthetics with ease of cleaning and durability. Rounded edges reduce chipping and improve safety.	
☐	**Countertop Heights** (I) Standard countertop height is typically 36 inches, providing comfortable use for most adults. Lower heights around 30–32 inches suit children or seated tasks, while taller countertops (up to 42 inches) accommodate standing work or accessibility needs.	
☐	**Countertop Thickness (Standard: 1.25”)** (I) Standard countertop thickness is about 1.25 inches, balancing durability and weight. Thicker countertops offer a more substantial look but may require stronger support.	
☐	**Vanity Countertop Style and Color** (I) Countertop styles range from sleek, modern slabs to textured or patterned surfaces. Colors vary from neutral tones like white, gray, and beige to bold hues and natural stone patterns. Choose styles and colors that complement the bathroom’s overall design and provide durability and ease of maintenance.	
☐	**Vanity Countertop Material:** (I) ➔ *Granite / Quartz / Marble / Quartzite* Granite is durable and heat-resistant with natural variations. Quartz offers non-porous, low-maintenance surfaces in consistent patterns. Marble provides classic elegance but requires more care due to susceptibility to staining. Quartzite combines marble’s beauty with granite’s hardness, offering durability and unique patterns.	
☐	**Vanity Style and Color** (I) Vanity styles range from traditional to modern, with options like shaker, flat-panel, or ornate designs. Colors include classic whites and neutrals, as well as bold or dark tones for statement pieces.	
☐	**Make-Up Vanity (Height: 26”–29”)** (I) Make-up vanities at a 26”–29” height are ideal for seated use. Beyond just the height, consider installing built-in USB or power outlets for easy access to hair tools and chargers. Also think about using adjustable mirrors or integrated lighting for the best visibility, especially in varying natural light conditions.	
☐	**Vanity Height (Standard: 30”–32”, Comfort: 36”)** (I) Standard vanity height is 30”–32”, suitable for most users standing comfortably. For added comfort, especially for taller individuals, a 36” height reduces bending and strain. Consider the primary users’ height and bathroom function to select the best height.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Sink		
☐	**Sink Drain Stopper:** (I) (L) (P) → *Push / Pull / Hidden / Side Mount* Push stoppers are simple to operate and have more of a modern look. Pull stoppers (traditional) offer easy control but require space behind the faucet. Hidden stoppers provide a sleek look with less visible hardware. Side mount stoppers keep controls off the faucet for cleaner aesthetics but need proper placement to avoid interference. Note that your decision can alter your vanity top decision.	
☐	**Sink Style:** (I) → *Undermount Sink / Integrated Bathroom Sink / Drop-in Sink / Pedestal / Apron Front / Console / Vessel / Trough / Wall Mounted Sink* Drop-in sinks rest on the countertop with a visible rim, making installation easier but harder to clean. Under-mount sinks are installed beneath the countertop for a seamless look and easier cleaning. Apron front sinks (farmhouse style) extend beyond the cabinet edge, adding character but requiring specific cabinetry. Wall-mounted sinks save floor space and create a minimalist look but need sturdy wall support. Integrated sinks combine sink and countertop into one piece for a sleek, modern design and easy maintenance. Pedestal sinks save space with a classic look but offer limited storage. Console sinks combine a basin with legs or a frame, adding style and some storage options. Vessel sinks sit atop the counter for a dramatic statement but may require taller faucets and more cleaning. Trough sinks are wide and shallow, ideal for shared spaces, providing a modern, functional design.	
☐	**Sink Faucet Color and Style** (I) Faucet colors like chrome, brushed nickel, matte black, and oil-rubbed bronze offer varied aesthetics from classic to modern. Styles range from traditional with curved spouts to sleek, minimalist designs. Consider functionality like single vs. double handles and water-saving features.	
☐	**Alternate Bathroom Sinks** (I) Alternate bathroom sinks often include pedestal, wall-mounted, or vessel styles, ideal for smaller spaces or guest baths. These sinks prioritize space-saving and unique design while maintaining functionality.	
☐	**Wall-Mounted Sink Faucet** (I) Wall-mounted faucets free up countertop space and create a clean, modern look. They require precise plumbing behind the wall and careful placement for comfortable use. Consider splash zones and ease of cleaning when selecting spout length and height to ensure functionality and style.	
☐	**Sink Faucet with Pull-Out Spray (with Drinking Fountain)** (I) (P) A pull-out spray faucet adds versatility for rinsing and cleaning, while an integrated drinking fountain spout provides convenient filtered water access for rinsing after brushing. Choose models with easy-to-use controls and durable, corrosion-resistant finishes for daily convenience and longevity.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Mirrors		
☐	**Mirror Style:** (I) (P) → *Classic / Backlit / Surface Mount Medicine Cabinet / Recessed Medicine Cabinet / Ceiling Mounted Mirror* Select mirror type. Choose classic framed or frameless, backlit for integrated lighting, surface mount medicine cabinet for added storage without wall modification, recessed medicine cabinet for a flush look, or ceiling-mounted mirror for a suspended design that allows for a full wall window.	
☐	**Wall-Mounted Make-Up Mirror (Hardwired)** (I) Hardwired wall-mounted make-up mirrors provide consistent lighting without relying on batteries, offering a clean look without visible cords. Proper placement near power sources and at eye level ensures optimal use.	
☐	**Ceiling-Mounted Vanity Mirror** (I) (V) Can free up counter space and create a unique design feature, especially in modern or compact bathrooms. It requires reinforced mounting points (blocking) in the ceiling and careful planning for mirror weight and swing clearance. Electrical access may also be needed for integrated lighting or smart features.	
Toilet		
☐	**Toilet Style:** (I) → *Comfort Height Toilet / Standard Height Toilet / Bidet / Wall Hung Toilet / Skirted Toilet / Tankless Toilet* Comfort height toilets are taller than standard models, typically 17”–19” from floor to seat, making sitting and standing easier. Wall-hung toilets mount directly to the wall, saving floor space and creating a sleek, modern look. Bidets combine traditional toilet functions with built-in water spray features for improved hygiene and comfort. They often require hot water connections and electrical outlets for heated seats, adjustable sprays, and air dryers. Consider these plumbing and electrical needs when selecting. Skirted toilets have a smooth, enclosed base that hides plumbing and makes cleaning easier by eliminating crevices. Their sleek design offers a modern, streamlined look.	
☐	**Bidet Toilet Utilities: Hot Water and Electrical Outlet** (I) Bidet toilets typically require a hot water supply for warm cleansing and an electrical outlet to power features like heated seats, adjustable sprays, and air dryers. If you selected a bidet toilet, make sure you have a toilet outlet selected in the electrical section and hot water from plumbing.	
☐	**Soft-Close Toilet Seats** (I) Soft-close toilet seats prevent slamming by gently lowering the lid and seat, reducing noise and wear. They offer added safety, especially in homes with children, and improve overall bathroom comfort.	
☐	**Toilet Flange Position** (I) (L) Avoid using offset toilet flanges unless absolutely necessary, as they can complicate installation and increase the risk of leaks. Proper flange placement ensures a secure, watertight connection and simplifies future maintenance.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Toilet Drain Placement** (I) Position the toilet drain centered within its space, maintaining adequate distance from the shower and vanity. Proper placement ensures comfortable use, allows for easier installation, and prevents plumbing conflicts or awkward spacing.	
Shower(s)		
☐	**Open Shower (No Door)** (I) (V) Creates a spacious, modern feel and are easier to access and clean. Proper floor slope and drainage are essential to prevent water from spilling onto surrounding floors. Consider spray containment options to minimize splashing, and be aware some users may experience cold drafts due to the open design.	
☐	**Shower Dryer** (I) (L) (L) A shower dryer helps quickly remove moisture from the shower area, reducing mold and mildew risk. It improves air circulation and speeds up drying time.	
☐	**Shower Seat:** (I) → *Bench Seat / Corner Seat* Corner seats save space and provide a compact resting spot, ideal for smaller showers. Bench seats offer more room for sitting or placing items and enhance accessibility.	
☐	**Shower Niche Lighting** (I) Shower niche lighting adds both function and ambiance, illuminating stored items and enhancing the shower's design. Use waterproof, recessed LED lights or strips rated for wet locations. Proper placement prevents glare and ensures even light distribution.	
☐	**Shower Valve Handle Location** (I) (V) Position shower valve handles for easy access when entering or exiting the shower, typically on the side wall away from direct water spray. Proper placement improves safety and convenience, allowing users to adjust water temperature without stepping under the spray.	
☐	**Wall-Mounted Body Sprays** (I) Wall-mounted body sprays add customizable water jets for a spa-like shower experience. Position sprays strategically for even coverage and user comfort, avoiding direct hits to the face. Ensure proper waterproofing and plumbing to prevent leaks and maintain durability. Adjustable spray heads increase functionality and personalization.	
☐	**Shower Guard Glass Treatment** (I) Shower Guard is a protective coating applied to glass that repels water, soap scum, and mineral buildup, keeping glass looking cleaner by preventing stains and hard water deposits. This treatment extends the life and clarity of shower doors and panels.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Shower Glass:** (I) ➔ *All Glass Shower / Partial Glass Shower* All glass showers use full-height glass panels or doors for a sleek, open look and easy cleaning but require careful sealing to prevent leaks. Partial glass showers combine glass with walls or curtains, offering more privacy and often lower cost.	
☐	**Shower Fixture Brand, Color, and Style** (I) Colors like chrome, brushed nickel, matte black, and oil-rubbed bronze offer various aesthetic options. Styles range from classic to modern. Select fixtures that complement your bathroom's design theme and provide the desired functionality.	
☐	**Two Shower Heads** (I) Dual shower heads offer customizable water flow, allowing simultaneous use or different spray patterns for enhanced comfort. They can include fixed and handheld units for versatility. Ensure your plumbing supports adequate water pressure, and consider separate controls for convenience and water efficiency.	
☐	**Handheld Shower Wand** (I) A handheld shower wand offers flexible water direction, making rinsing and cleaning easier. Ideal for kids, pets, and shaving. Consider mounting it lower to improve accessibility for these uses.	
☐	**Shower Niche (Shampoo Shelf): Size and Count** (I) Shower niches should be sized to comfortably hold shampoo bottles, soap, and other essentials, typically 12" wide by 24" high and about 3–4" deep. Multiple niches or divided sections help organize products and prevent clutter.	
☐	**Lower Wall Niche for Shaving** (I) A shaving niche at knee height is great in a shower because it gives you a safe, sturdy spot to rest your foot at a comfortable height, making leg-shaving easier and reducing the need to balance or bend awkwardly.	
☐	**Towel Holder Locations** (I) Place towel holders near shower exits and sinks for easy access when drying off. Ensure they're mounted at comfortable heights, typically 48" to 52" from the floor, and spaced to avoid overcrowding.	
☐	**Shower Glass Towel Access** (I) (L) Incorporate towel bars or hooks on shower glass panels for convenient access while showering. Choose corrosion-resistant materials and secure mounting to handle frequent use.	
☐	**Specific Shower Head Height** (I) A standard shower head height is 72" from the floor, but 80" is ideal for better coverage and comfort for most users. Rain shower heads are typically 85"-90". Adjust heights based on user needs to ensure easy reach and minimize water splashing outside the shower area.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Shower Grab Bars** (I) Shower grab bars provide stability and safety, especially for seniors or those with mobility challenges. Install bars securely at recommended heights, typically 33” to 36” from the floor, where users can easily reach them. Consider corrosion-resistant material.	
☐	**Light and Fan Combo Over Shower** (I) (P) A light and fan combo installed over the shower provides both illumination and ventilation in one unit, saving space and simplifying wiring. Ensure the fixture is rated for wet locations and sized appropriately to handle moisture removal and lighting needs effectively.	
☐	**Curbless Shower** (I) Curbless showers have no raised threshold, offering a seamless transition for easy access and a modern look. Proper floor slope and waterproofing are crucial to prevent water from spilling into adjoining areas. Ideal for accessibility, but careful design is needed to manage drainage effectively.	
☐	**Linear Shower Drain – Drain Cover Style (Match Tile/Metal)** (I) Linear shower drains offer sleek, modern drainage along one edge of the shower floor. Drain covers can either match the tile for a seamless, integrated look or be metal for a contrasting, industrial style. Proper installation ensures effective water flow and prevents clogs.	
☐	**Built-In Drain Hair Catch** (I) (P) A built-in drain hair catch traps hair and debris before they enter the plumbing, reducing clogs and maintenance. Choose designs that are easy to remove and clean without tools.	
☐	**Music in Shower** (I) Wireless or hardwired options allow streaming from devices or built-in audio sources. Ensure components are rated for wet environments and positioned for optimal sound without interfering with water flow or safety.	
☐	**Digital Water Thermostat** (I) Digital water thermostats provide precise temperature control for showers, improving safety and comfort by preventing sudden temperature changes. They often include easy-to-read displays and programmable settings.	
Misc Bathroom		
☐	**Toilet Paper Holder Style:** (I) (P) → *Standard / Niche* Standard toilet paper holders mount on walls or cabinets for easy access and simple installation. Niche holders are recessed into the wall, saving space and creating a streamlined look.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Outdoor Bathroom** (I) Outdoor bathrooms near pools or outdoor spaces provide convenient access and enhance comfort during outdoor activities. Durable, weather-resistant materials and fixtures are essential for longevity. Consider ventilation, privacy, and drainage.	
☐	**Linen Closet Shelves:** (I) → *Wood Shelving / Wire* Wood shelves offer a sturdy, solid surface ideal for stacking towels and linens neatly. Wire shelves provide better air circulation, reducing moisture buildup and mildew risk, but may require liners for smaller items.	
☐	**Radiant Floor Heating** (I) Radiant floor heating warms the bathroom from the floor up, providing even, comfortable heat. It works best with tile or stone floors and improves energy efficiency by reducing reliance on forced-air systems.	
☐	**Towel Warmer/Dryer** (I) (P) Towel warmers dry and heat towels for added comfort and reduced moisture buildup. They come in electric or hydronic models and should be installed in accessible locations near showers or tubs.	
☐	**Wet Room Bathroom** (I) Wet rooms are fully waterproofed bathrooms without traditional shower enclosures, allowing water to drain through a gently sloped floor. This open design maximizes space and accessibility. Proper waterproofing, drainage, and slip-resistant flooring are critical to prevent water damage and ensure safety. Some people opt out of this design because it doesn't trap steam for warmth during a shower.	
☐	**Wall/Ceiling Mounted Heater** (I) Wall or ceiling-mounted heaters provide targeted warmth in bathrooms without taking up floor space. Choose models rated for damp environments with safety features like automatic shutoff. Proper placement ensures even heat distribution and keeps electrical components away from water sources.	
☐	**Pocket Door** (I) Pocket doors slide into the wall cavity, saving space compared to traditional swing doors. They're ideal for tight bathrooms but require careful framing and installation. Consider hardware quality and smooth track systems for quiet, reliable operation.	
☐	**Built-In Sauna** (I) A built-in sauna adds luxury and wellness benefits to the home. Proper insulation, ventilation, and moisture-resistant materials are essential for safety and durability.	
☐	**Sink Genie – Kid's Sink See-Through P-Trap** (I) (P) The Sink Genie features a clear P-trap, great for installing in kids' sinks. Its clear trap helps with identifying objects and easy removal allows access to lodged items.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Laundry		
☐	**Hidden Drain in Laundry Room Corner** (I) (P) A discreet floor drain installed in a corner helps manage accidental flooding or leaks, protecting floors and minimizing water damage. Using mineral oil in the p-trap or a drain seal prevents evaporation and blocks sewer gas odors, maintaining a fresh environment.	
☐	**Grey Water Pipe for Washing Machine Drain** (I) (V) Safely directs used water from the washing machine to the drainage or irrigation system. Proper sizing and venting prevent backups and odors, and some setups allow grey water reuse for landscape irrigation, promoting water conservation. For those on septic, use a 2" drain with vented P-trap and 18"–30" standpipe. Slope properly and secure. On septic systems, all gray water must drain to the tank unless a separate approved system is installed.	
☐	**Robot Vacuum/Mop with Dedicated Drain and Water Refill Line** (I) A built-in station with a dedicated drain and water refill line allows robot vacuum/mop devices to empty dirty water and refill clean water automatically. This setup enhances convenience, reduces manual maintenance, and keeps the laundry or cleaning area tidy and efficient.	
☐	**Robot Vacuum Cubby** (I) (L) A designated cubby or nook provides a neat, out-of-the-way storage spot for robot vacuum units and their charging stations.	
☐	**Appliance Trench Drain Pan** (I) (V) (P) Trench-style pan lets you roll appliances on top, draining through a front grate. Requires in-floor drain. Should be installed during the rough-in plumbing phase, before flooring and appliances are set. This ensures proper placement, connection to the drainage system, and sealing to prevent leaks.	
☐	**Pet Washing Station** (I) (V) (L) A handheld sprayer, non-slip floor, and proper drainage make pet grooming easy and contained. Installed in laundry or mudrooms, it reduces mess and trips outside. Plumbing should include temperature control and a drain sized for pet hair.	
☐	**Recessed Dryer Vent Box** (I) (P) Allows the dryer to sit closer to the wall, saving space in tight laundry areas. It provides a clean, built-in look while ensuring proper venting and airflow. Installation should ensure easy access for cleaning and compliance with vent length limits.	
☐	**Jentle Jet Laundry Sink** (I) (L) Features a high-pressure, ergonomic spray faucet designed for efficient pre-soaking, stain removal, and hand washing. Its durable construction and user-friendly design make it a practical addition to any laundry or utility room.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Double Basin Sink** (I) Offers separate compartments for soaking, washing, and rinsing, improving workflow and multitasking in the laundry room. It enhances convenience and helps keep tasks organized, especially for hand-washing delicate items or treating stains.	
☐	**Sink Mount:** (I) → *Freestanding / Drop-in / Undermount* Freestanding sinks are portable and easy to install, under-mount sinks offer a sleek, seamless look with easy countertop cleaning, and drop-in sinks are the most common, featuring a rim that rests on the countertop for straightforward installation.	
☐	**Wall Mounted Faucet** (I) Frees up countertop space and simplifies cleaning around the sink area. It offers flexible installation heights and styles, making it ideal for laundry sinks where extra reach and durability are needed.	
☐	**Sink with Threaded Faucet** (I) (P) Sinks equipped with threaded faucets allow easy attachment of hoses or sprayers, enhancing versatility for tasks like rinsing or filling buckets. Especially useful in laundry and utility rooms for quick connections and efficient water use.	
☐	**Exposed Shelving:** (I) → *Wire / Wood Fascia* Wire shelves offer ventilation and help prevent dust buildup, making them ideal for drying areas. Wood shelves add warmth and a decorative touch but require proper sealing to resist moisture in laundry environments.	
☐	**Drying Rack:** (I) (P) (P) (L) → *Wall Mount / Ceiling Mounted / In-Drawer* Wall-mounted racks fold away when not in use, ceiling-mounted racks utilize overhead space with pulley systems, and in-drawer racks keep drying discreet and compact. Each option maximizes drying capacity while minimizing clutter.	
☐	**Open or Cabinet Storage for Rolling Laundry Basket** (I) (L) Designate open spaces or built-in cabinets to accommodate rolling laundry baskets, keeping them easily accessible yet neatly tucked away. Open storage offers quick access and ventilation, while cabinet storage hides clutter and protects baskets from dust.	
☐	**Built-In Litter Box Inside Cabinet (Optional Kitty Fart Fan)** (I) (L) Provides a discreet, odor-controlled space for pets, keeping the laundry or utility room tidy. Optional ventilation fans, playfully dubbed "kitty fart fans", help eliminate odors, improving air quality.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Built-In Washer and Dryer (Under Counter)** (I) Saves space and creates a streamlined look by fitting neatly beneath countertops. This setup maximizes workspace and maintains a clean aesthetic, ideal for compact or multifunctional laundry areas.	
☐	**Built-In Features:** (I) → *Folding Table (slide-out) / Drying Rack / Hanger Rod / Laundry Basket Storage (slide-out) / Ironing Board* Features like slide-out folding tables provide a handy surface for sorting and folding clothes, while pull-out drying racks offer space-saving air-drying for delicate items. A hanger rod allows easy hanging straight from the dryer or after ironing, and slide-out laundry basket storage keeps baskets neatly tucked away yet accessible. Fold-down or slide-out ironing boards save space and simplify quick touch-ups.	
☐	**Countertop Style and Color** (I) Choosing the right countertop style and color balances durability with aesthetics in the laundry room. Materials like laminate, quartz, or solid surface offer easy cleaning and resistance to stains and moisture.	
☐	**Countertop Material:** (I) → *Granite / Quartz / Quartzite / Marble* Natural and engineered stone countertops offer durable, stylish surfaces for laundry rooms. Granite and quartz provide stain resistance and easy maintenance, while quartzite and marble deliver unique veining and elegance but may require more care to prevent staining and etching. Selecting the right material balances beauty with practicality.	
☐	**Cabinet Style and Color** (I) Cabinet styles range from traditional shaker to modern flat panel, influencing the room's overall look and feel. Colors vary from bright whites and neutrals for a clean, airy vibe to darker tones that add warmth and depth.	
☐	**Steam Closet** (I) (L) (P) Uses high-temperature steam to refresh, deodorize, and gently sanitize clothes without washing. It's ideal for delicate fabrics, suits, and items needing quick freshening between washes.	
☐	**Dryer Vent Discharge: Horizontal vs. Vertical** (I) (V) (L) Run the vent horizontally through an exterior wall whenever possible. Short, straight runs are safer, easier to clean, and reduce lint buildup. Venting through the roof forces air upward, which increases lint buildup, makes cleaning harder, and raises fire risk. Always use a proper vent hood with a damper, never a screen that traps lint.	
☐	**Laundry Chute/Laundry Jet** (I) (P) Laundry chutes provide a quick, efficient way to send dirty clothes from upper floors directly to the laundry room, reducing trips and clutter. Laundry jets use pressurized air to transport laundry through sealed pipes, offering a modern alternative that can handle larger loads and multiple destinations.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Water Leak Sensors** (I) (P) Detect moisture or flooding early, alerting homeowners to potential leaks from washers, drains, or plumbing failures. Installing sensors near appliances and vulnerable areas helps prevent costly water damage and mold growth by enabling prompt response.	
☐	**Adjacent Room Laundry Access** (V) Consider adding secondary access to the laundry room from an adjacent space, such as a primary closet, bathroom, mudroom, or hallway.	
Mudroom/ Drop Zone		
☐	**Cubbies** (I) Organized, individual storage spaces perfect for shoes, bags, and gear. Great for mudrooms and drop zones to keep clutter contained and items easily accessible.	
☐	**Seating with Drawers/Storage** (I) Seating with built-in drawers or storage combines a place to sit with hidden compartments for shoes, bags, or other essentials. Ideal for maximizing space in mudrooms or drop zones while keeping areas tidy.	
☐	**In-Cabinet/In-Drawer Outlets** (I) Built-in outlets inside cabinets or drawers provide hidden charging stations for devices or small appliances. Keeps counters clear and cords out of sight. Plan electrical wiring early to accommodate usage needs.	
☐	**Shoe Storage** (I) Options include shelves, cubbies, racks, or pull-out drawers that keep shoes organized and off the floor. Drawers help keep shoes out of sight, maintaining a tidy mudroom or entryway while protecting floors and extending shoe life.	
☐	**Built-Ins with Wall Hooks** (I) Custom built-ins featuring integrated wall hooks provide organized storage for coats, bags, and hats. Plan hook placement based on household needs and space.	
Trim		
☐	**Trim Storage** (I) (V) (L) Use a trim rack to keep trim organized and off the floor, preventing damage like warping, bending, or dirt buildup.	
☐	**Drywall Return** (I) (V) Use a drywall return for a trimless, modern look. The drywall wraps into the opening instead of adding casing. Common on windows, doors, cased openings, niches, and built-ins.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Baseboard Trim Style and Size** (I) Baseboards protect walls and add finishing detail. Styles vary from plain, straight boards to detailed profiles with curves and bevels. Size should fit the room's scale. Taller baseboards suit high ceilings and larger rooms, while shorter ones work in smaller spaces.	
☐	**No Baseboard Style:** (I) ➔ *No Base / Flush Base / Reveal Base* No base leaves floors meeting walls directly, modern but less protective against damage. Flush baseboards align evenly with walls and floors, creating a smooth, minimalist look with fewer dust traps. Reveal baseboards sit slightly above the floor, forming a subtle shadow line that helps hide imperfections and makes cleaning easier by reducing buildup at the wall base.	
☐	**Shoe Molding Style** (I) Shoe molding is a thin, curved trim placed at the base of baseboards to cover gaps between the floor and baseboard. Styles are simple and subtle, typically with a rounded or beveled edge.	
☐	**Built-In Mudroom** (I) Proper trim conceals seams between built-ins and walls for a polished appearance. Choose trim based on a built-in bench, cubby, locker, or combination of all.	
☐	**Crown and Picture Rail Molding** (I) (L) Crown molding adds a decorative transition between walls and ceilings, enhancing room height and style. When installing, allow for slight gaps or flexible caulking to accommodate seasonal wood movement and prevent cracking. Picture rail molding, installed below crown molding, offers a practical way to hang artwork without damaging walls.	
☐	**Crown Molding Style** (I) Crown molding styles range from simple, clean lines to elaborate, ornate designs. Choosing the right profile depends on the room's architectural style. Modern spaces often favor minimalistic moldings, while traditional homes suit detailed, layered profiles. Keep in mind that larger, more intricate crown molding can make ceilings feel lower, so scale appropriately for room size and ceiling height.	
☐	**Interior Trim Style and Size (Around Doors and Windows)** (I) Size should be proportional, wider for large openings and high ceilings, narrower for smaller spaces. Some homeowners skip trim altogether and go with drywall only (called drywall return).	
☐	**Built-In Pantry Shelves** (I) Built-in pantry shelves maximize storage by fitting precisely into available space. Consider adjustable shelves for flexibility to store items of varying sizes. Proper trim around shelves conceals gaps and ensures a polished finish while allowing for wood movement to prevent cracking or warping.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Built-Ins Around TV or Fireplace** (I) Built-ins around TVs or fireplaces combine functionality and style, providing storage and display space. Trim should accommodate heat expansion near fireplaces and allow cable management for electronics.	
☐	**Shiplap/Board & Batten Walls** (I) Shiplap walls feature horizontal wooden boards with slight gaps, creating a clean, linear look that adds texture without overwhelming. Board & batten combines wide vertical boards with narrow battens covering seams, adding depth and architectural interest.	
Closets		
☐	**Rotating Shoe Storage** (I) (P) Use durable, low-profile trim to avoid interfering with movement and maintain a clean look.	
☐	**Open or Cabinet Storage for Rolling Laundry Basket** (I) (L) Storage designed for rolling laundry baskets should have trim that allows easy access and smooth movement. Open storage requires minimal trim for a clean look, while cabinet-style storage benefits from reinforced trim edges to protect against frequent use and potential bumps.	
☐	**Built-In Closet Shelves** (I) Trim around built-in closet shelves should allow for slight expansion and contraction of materials to prevent cracking. Using flexible or layered molding helps conceal seams and creates a polished look.	
☐	**Closet Island** (I) Trim on a closet island should be sturdy and smooth to withstand frequent contact. Rounded edges or bullnose profiles reduces potential damage.	
Custom Built-Ins		
☐	**Bunk Beds** (I) Trim around built-in bunk beds should prioritize safety and durability. Rounded edges or bullnose profiles help prevent injuries from sharp corners.	
☐	**Office Desk** (I) Trim around a built-in office desk should be smooth and durable to resist daily wear. Rounded or beveled edges reduce snagging and damage. Allow for slight material expansion to prevent cracking, and ensure the trim style complements the room's overall design for a cohesive look.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Paint		
☐	**Masking Liquid** (I) (V) (L) Apply masking liquid to all window glass before painting, drywall texture, stucco, or masonry work begins. Remove it once finish work is complete to reveal clean, undamaged glass and avoid costly replacement.	
☐	**Interior Wall Color and Sheen** (I) Choose interior wall colors based on room size, lighting, and mood. Lighter shades make spaces feel larger and brighter, while darker tones add warmth and coziness. Neutral colors offer versatility, allowing easy updates with decor changes. Test samples in different lighting before finalizing.	
☐	**Interior Trim/Baseboard Color** (I) Trim and baseboards are commonly painted white or off-white for a clean, classic look that contrasts with wall colors. For a modern or bold style, matching trim to wall color or choosing darker shades adds depth and character. Consider finish sheen, semi-gloss or satin, for durability and easy cleaning.	
☐	**Accent Wall Color(s)** (I) Accent wall colors add visual interest by contrasting or complementing the main wall colors. Choose shades that highlight architectural features or create mood without overwhelming the space. Consider how lighting and room size affect color perception to ensure balance and harmony.	
☐	**Stair Riser Color** (I) Stair risers often contrast with treads to add visual interest and depth. White or light colors brighten staircases and highlight each step, while darker risers create a sleek, modern look. Choose colors that complement overall trim and flooring.	
☐	**Exterior Color** (I) Choose exterior colors that suit the home's style and blend with the neighborhood. Lighter colors reflect heat and make the home appear larger, while darker shades add drama and hide dirt. Consider durable, weather-resistant paints to maintain appearance over time.	
☐	**Exterior Paint Sheen** (I) (L) Satin sheen on exterior surfaces offers a balance of subtle shine and durability, making it easier to clean and maintain compared to flat finishes.	
☐	**Exterior Trim Color** (I) Exterior trim colors should complement the main siding while highlighting architectural details. Light trim brightens and frames windows and doors, while darker trim adds contrast and depth. Choose durable, weather-resistant paint with a finish that withstands outdoor conditions.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Fascia Color** (I) Fascia color typically coordinates with roofing, siding, or trim to create a unified exterior look. Lighter colors can highlight rooflines, while darker tones add contrast and hide dirt. Choose weather-resistant paint to protect against sun and moisture damage.	
☐	**Soffit Color** (I) Soffit color usually complements the fascia and trim for a cohesive exterior appearance. Lighter shades help reflect sunlight and keep attic spaces cooler, while darker colors can add depth. Use durable, weather-resistant paint to protect against moisture and UV damage.	
☐	**Door Painting** (I) Paint all sides of the door, including edges, top, behind strike plates, and top of the door trim, to seal out moisture, prevent warping, and ensure a uniform finish. This also makes surfaces easier to wipe clean and extends the door's lifespan.	
☐	**Exterior Caulking Color** (I) (L) Match exterior caulking to the paint color to create a seamless look and minimize visible gaps, enhancing the home's overall finish and curb appeal.	
☐	**Dormer Window Interior Paint** (I) Paint the interior of attic dormer windows flat black with two coats to conceal raw lumber color. This creates a clean, finished look from the exterior and reduces glare from the wood surface.	
☐	**Paint for Touchups** (I) Ask your builder for leftover paint or purchase small paint samples to keep on hand for future touchups. This ensures color matches perfectly and helps maintain your walls' fresh appearance over time. If you don't want leftover cans, consider collecting the paint sample cards or taking photographs of paint can color cards for touchups later.	
Stairs		
☐	**Stair Lighting Types:** (I) (V) (P) → *Stair Riser Lighting / Wall-Mounted Stair Lighting / Hand Stair Rail Lighting / Under Step Lighting* Riser and under-step lights offer subtle, modern illumination but can be costly to install. Wall-mounted fixtures provide bright, direct light but may take up space. Handrail lighting adds discreet safety but needs custom rails and wiring. All require early wiring, plan during framing or rough-in.	
☐	**Stair Tread Material** (I) Use dimensional lumber, not plywood, for stair treads to ensure strength, durability, and safety. Dimensional lumber provides a solid, long-lasting surface that withstands heavy foot traffic better than plywood.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Stair Tread Stain Color** (I) Stain color affects stair appearance and durability. Choose finishes that resist scuffs and complement surrounding flooring and trim.	
☐	**Stair Finish:** (I) → *Hardwood Stairs / Carpet Stairs* Carpet adds warmth and reduces noise but requires more maintenance. Hardwood offers durability and a classic look but can be slippery and louder.	
☐	**Handrail Type and Design** (I) Handrails come in wood, metal, or composite materials with styles ranging from traditional to modern. Choose a design that complements the staircase and provides comfortable grip and safety. Consider code requirements and mounting options.	
☐	**Handrail Color** (I) Handrail color should complement the staircase and surrounding decor. Dark finishes add contrast and elegance, while lighter tones create a softer, more open feel. Consider durability and ease of touch-up when selecting.	
☐	**Stair Protection During Build** (I) (L) Protect stairs with temporary coverings like plywood or adhesive films to prevent scratches, dents, and dirt during construction. Essential for preserving finishes and avoiding costly repairs. Install early and maintain until final walkthrough.	
Flooring		
☐	**Primary Flooring Material, Color, and Location:** (I) → *Hardwood / Engineered Hardwood / Tile Flooring / Luxury Vinyl / Standard Vinyl / Carpet / Stone Veneer Flooring / Laminate / Concrete Flooring / Epoxy* Hardwood is classic and adds value but is prone to scratches and water damage. Engineered hardwood is durable and resists warping but can't be refinished often. Tile is waterproof and easy to clean but feels cold and hard. Luxury vinyl is affordable, realistic, and waterproof but offers less resale value. Standard vinyl is cheap and low maintenance but lacks an upscale look. Carpet is soft, warm, and quiet but stains easily and traps allergens. Stone veneer looks natural and upscale but is heavy and costly. Laminate is budget-friendly and scratch-resistant but not water-resistant. Concrete is modern and durable but can be cold and hard. Epoxy is seamless and stain-resistant but may be slippery and yellow in sunlight.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Secondary Flooring Material, Color, and Location:** (I) ➔ *Hardwood / Engineered Hardwood / Tile Flooring / Luxury Vinyl / Standard Vinyl / Carpet / Stone Veneer Flooring / Laminate / Concrete Flooring / Epoxy* Used in areas like closets, laundry rooms, or entryways. Common materials include carpet, laminate, or vinyl for durability and cost-effectiveness. Colors usually match or complement the primary flooring. Hardwood is classic and adds value but is prone to scratches and water damage. Engineered hardwood is durable and resists warping but can't be refinished often. Tile is waterproof and easy to clean but feels cold and hard. Luxury vinyl is affordable, realistic, and waterproof but offers less resale value. Standard vinyl is cheap and low maintenance but lacks an upscale look. Carpet is soft, warm, and quiet but stains easily and traps allergens. Stone veneer looks natural and upscale but is heavy and costly. Laminate is budget-friendly and scratch-resistant but not water-resistant. Concrete is modern and durable but can be cold and hard. Epoxy is seamless and stain-resistant but may be slippery and yellow in sunlight.	
☐	**Primary Bathroom Flooring Material and Color:** (I) ➔ *Hardwood / Engineered Hardwood / Tile Flooring / Luxury Vinyl / Standard Vinyl / Carpet / Stone Veneer Flooring / Laminate / Concrete Flooring / Epoxy* Tile is primarily used due to its water resistance and durability. Luxury vinyl is another strong choice, offering waterproof protection and a softer feel underfoot, though it provides less long-term value. Standard vinyl is inexpensive and easy to maintain but lacks the premium look many homeowners want. Stone flooring creates a natural, high-end aesthetic but is heavy, expensive, and can be slippery when wet. Engineered hardwood brings warmth and style but requires extra care to avoid moisture damage. Laminate is budget-friendly and scratch-resistant but not ideal for high-moisture areas. Concrete delivers a modern, seamless finish with excellent durability but feels cold and hard without added comfort features. Epoxy provides a waterproof, easy-clean surface, especially in modern or spa-style bathrooms, but it can be slick and may yellow with time. Carpet is rarely used in bathrooms due to moisture issues, but in some cases, small areas may include it for warmth at the cost of higher maintenance.	
☐	**Secondary Bathroom Flooring Material and Color:** (I) ➔ *Hardwood / Engineered Hardwood / Tile Flooring / Luxury Vinyl / Standard Vinyl / Carpet / Stone Veneer Flooring / Laminate / Concrete Flooring / Epoxy* The primary flooring material in bathrooms is typically tile due to its water resistance and durability. Luxury vinyl is another strong choice, offering waterproof protection and a softer feel underfoot, though it provides less long-term value. Standard vinyl is inexpensive and easy to maintain but lacks the premium look many homeowners want. Stone flooring creates a natural, high-end aesthetic but is heavy, expensive, and can be slippery when wet. Engineered hardwood brings warmth and style but requires extra care to avoid moisture damage. Laminate is budget-friendly and scratch-resistant but not ideal for high-moisture areas. Concrete delivers a modern, seamless finish with excellent durability but feels cold and hard without added comfort features. Epoxy provides a waterproof, easy-clean surface, especially in modern or spa-style bathrooms, but it can be slick and may yellow with time. Carpet is rarely used in bathrooms due to moisture issues, but in some cases, small areas may include it for warmth at the cost of higher maintenance.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Tile Grout Type:** [(I)] ➔ *Cement Grout / Epoxy Grout / Single Component Grout* Cement grout is the most common and affordable grout type, requiring sealing to protect against stains and cracking over time. Epoxy grout offers superior durability, stain resistance, and waterproofing, making it ideal for wet or high-traffic areas, though it is more difficult to install and costs more. Single component grout comes premixed for easier application and is suited for smaller or less demanding projects but lacks the durability of epoxy grout.	
☐	**Tile Grout Color and Line Size** [(I)] Grout color affects the overall look, matching tile creates a seamless feel, while contrasting grout highlights patterns. Common colors range from white and gray to darker shades. Line size varies from narrow (1/16") for a clean look to wider (up to 1/2") for rustic styles or uneven tiles.	
☐	**Radiant Floor Heating System** [(I)] Provides even warmth by circulating heated water or electric coils beneath flooring. Ideal for tile, stone, or concrete surfaces, it enhances comfort and can improve energy efficiency by reducing forced-air heating use.	
☐	**LVP Installation Type** [(I)] Confirm with the builder the exact luxury vinyl plank (LVP) installation method, as some use glue-down instead of floating, affecting durability and repair options.	
☐	**Subfloor Preparation for Carpet Installation** [(I)] Ensure contractors thoroughly clean the subfloor before carpet installation to prevent lumps and promote proper adhesive bonding for a smooth, durable finish.	
☐	**Flooring Installation Pattern** [(I)] Flooring should be installed with a random layout to avoid visible patterns. Avoid H-joints and waterfall/staircasing patterns unless intentionally desired for style.	
☐	**Door and Flooring Transition** [(I)] Split the door, not the jamb, so flooring changes occur beneath the door, hiding transitions from the adjacent room.	
Misc Appliances		
☐	**Spare Standup Freezer** [(I)] A vertical freezer offers additional storage separate from the refrigerator, ideal for bulk food or meal prep. Requires dedicated floor space and proper ventilation.	
☐	**Spare Fridge** [(I)] Often placed in garages, basements, or secondary kitchens. Plan for electrical access, plumbing if you require a water line, and sufficient ventilation space.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Drink Fridge** (I) A compact fridge designed specifically for beverages, ideal for kitchens, bars, pantries, or entertainment areas. Keeps drinks chilled and easily accessible without occupying full refrigerator space. Requires electrical outlet nearby and proper ventilation.	
☐	**Wine Cooler** (I) Maintains optimal temperature and humidity for storing and aging wine collections. Available in built-in or freestanding models with single or dual temperature zones.	
☐	**Washer and Dryer** (I) Come in multiple styles including front-load, top-load, stackable, and compact units to fit any laundry space. Features like energy efficiency, steam cleaning, multiple cycle options, and smart technology offer convenience and better care for your clothes. Add convenience by including a separate set in the master bedroom.	
☐	**Steam Closet** (I) (L) (P) Uses steam technology to refresh, deodorize, and sanitize clothes without washing. Perfect for delicate garments, reducing ironing, and extending wear between washes. Requires dedicated space and proper ventilation. Plan electrical access during design.	
☐	**Add Felt Pads to Appliance Bottoms** (I) Applying felt pads to the bottoms of appliances helps prevent scratches on flooring during installation and movement. A simple, cost-effective way to protect surfaces and maintain a clean, damage-free kitchen or laundry area.	
Garage		
☐	**Washer Outlet Box for Garage Pressure Washer** (I) (P) Install a standard washing machine outlet box with both hot and cold water lines in the garage to support a pressure washer. This allows you to easily adjust water temperature when rinsing vehicles, equipment, or the driveway. Make sure the box is surface-mounted or recessed for protection, and verify it drains properly to prevent standing water or freeze risks.	
☐	**Urinal in Man-Cave/Garage** (I) Provides quick, convenient access during projects. Requires water supply, drainage, and proper venting. Wall-mounted units save space and are easy to clean. Insulate pipes if the area isn't climate-controlled.	
☐	**Ice Maker/Water Fountain** (I) (P) They need proper drainage and a water line, and filtration helps with taste and long-term performance. Double-check appliance depth so it doesn't stick out or interfere with cabinets or walls.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Drain at Garage Door Threshold** (I) Prevents rainwater from entering the garage by redirecting runoff before it crosses the threshold. Ideal for sloped driveways or poor yard drainage. Connect to a proper discharge point and ensure the grate is flush with the slab to avoid trip hazards.	
☐	**Garage Floor Drain** (I) (V) Drains snow, rain, and car wash water to prevent puddles and standing moisture. Requires a slightly sloped floor for proper flow and may need code approval. Ensure it's connected to an approved drainage system and include a clean out for maintenance.	
☐	**Floor Outlets for Shop Tools** (I) Provide power directly beneath stationary tools like a table saw to reduce tripping hazards from overhead or wall cords. Plan locations early to align with tool layout. Use durable, flush-mounted covers and ensure circuits meet the tool's voltage and amperage requirements.	
☐	**Extra Lighting/Outlets** (I) Plan for more lights and outlets than you think you need, especially in work areas, storage zones, and corners. Improves flexibility for tool placement and reduces reliance on extension cords. Use separate circuits if powering heavy equipment. Consider switching some outlets for convenience.	
☐	**High Outlets** (I) Install outlets higher on the wall for TVs, air compressors, garage door openers, or battery charging stations. Helps eliminate visible cords and keeps power access above work surfaces or away from dust and debris. Plan locations based on mounted equipment or shelving layout.	
☐	**240V Outlet** (I) (V) Required for high-power equipment like welders, EV chargers, or large air compressors. Plan amperage and plug type based on specific tool requirements. Install on a dedicated circuit with appropriate breaker size, and verify local code compliance.	
☐	**Garage Side Door (Man Door)** (I) Adds convenient access without opening the main garage door. Useful for quick entry, yard access, or emergency exit. Choose a durable, weather-rated door with proper security features. Ensure it's insulated if the garage is climate-controlled.	
☐	**Double Garage Doors (Pull In/Out)** (I) (L) Provides independent access for each vehicle and allows flexible parking or workshop use. Reduces heat loss compared to a single large door. Requires adequate framing between doors and may increase opener and installation costs.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Garage Door Windows** (I) Bring in natural light and improve curb appeal. Choose frosted or tinted options for privacy. Consider placement to match home aesthetics and avoid glare on work surfaces. Insulated glass helps maintain garage temperature.	
☐	**Garage Door Style** (I) Impacts both curb appeal and functionality. Options include carriage-style, modern panels, flush designs, and custom finishes. Match the style to the home's architecture. Factor in insulation, window placement, and material (steel, wood, composite) for durability and maintenance.	
☐	**Garage Door Insulation** (I) Helps regulate garage temperature, reduces noise, and improves energy efficiency. Choose between polystyrene or polyurethane core panels, with higher R-values offering better performance. Especially important if the garage is conditioned or attached to living spaces.	
☐	**Garage Insulation** (I) Regulates temperature, reduces noise, and improves comfort for workshops or climate-controlled areas. Not always standard depending on region or builder, so request it early if needed. Insulate walls, ceiling, and garage doors using batt, rigid foam, or spray foam. Seal gaps around outlets, doors, and windows for full coverage.	
☐	**In-Ceiling Speakers** (I) Save space and keep the garage floor clear while providing quality audio for music or project tutorials. Ideal for finished garages or mancaves. Plan wiring routes before insulation and drywall. Use moisture-resistant models in non-climate-controlled areas.	
☐	**Ceiling Fan or Wall-Mounted Fan (High Outlet)** (I) (P) Improves airflow in warm garages or workshops. High-mounted fans keep floors clear and help circulate air around tools and vehicles. Install a dedicated high outlet and confirm fan placement won't interfere with lighting, doors, or garage door tracks. Choose damp-rated models for non-conditioned spaces.	
☐	**Front and Back Garage Doors** (I) One door opens to the driveway, the other to the backyard. Ideal for drive-through access, ventilation, and flexible workspace flow. Useful for moving trailers, lawn equipment, or projects between spaces. Requires proper alignment, slab extension, and possibly additional drainage. Consider a solid rear door for privacy and insulation.	
☐	**Sink (Hot & Cold) with Threaded Faucet** (I) (P) Adds utility for hand washing, cleaning tools, or filling buckets. A threaded spout allows hose attachment for added reach. Install near a drain and plan water lines early. Use a deep, durable basin and consider wall-mount or freestanding options based on layout.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Garage Door Height** (I) Standard height is 7 feet, but consider 8 feet or more for lifted trucks, vans, or overhead storage clearance. Confirm height with door supplier and opener specs. Adjust framing during rough-in if planning for taller doors.	
☐	**Garage Depth** (I) (V) Standard depth is about 20 feet, but extending to 24–28 feet provides room for larger vehicles, workbenches, or storage. Deeper garages improve usability for tools, gym space, or rear access paths.	
☐	**Built-In Floor Mat** (I) (L) Recessed into the concrete near entry doors to trap dirt, mud, or water before it spreads. Keeps floors cleaner and reduces slipping. Choose heavy-duty, removable mats sized to the recess. Plan during slab prep to ensure proper depth and drainage, if needed.	
☐	**Wi-Fi Garage Door Opener** (I) Allows remote control, status checks, and notifications via smartphone. Useful for deliveries, family access, or security. Choose models compatible with your smart home system. Ensure strong Wi-Fi coverage in the garage and consider battery backup for outages.	
☐	**Wall-Mounted Garage Door Opener** (I) (P) Frees up ceiling space for storage, lifts, or lighting by mounting beside the door. Ideal for garages with high ceilings or obstructed overhead areas. Operates quietly and often includes built-in Wi-Fi. Requires a compatible torsion spring system and nearby power outlet.	
☐	**Wireless Access Point** (I) Extends Wi-Fi coverage to garages or workshops for smart devices, streaming, or remote work. Mount centrally on the ceiling or wall for best range. Requires Ethernet wiring to the main router and nearby power. Consider weather-resistant models for unconditioned spaces.	
☐	**Wi-Fi Sprinkler Control** (I) Enables remote scheduling, weather-based adjustments, and real-time monitoring from your phone. Ideal for managing lawn zones efficiently. Install near the existing sprinkler valve wiring and provide constant power and reliable Wi-Fi.	
☐	**Retractable Extension Cord/Air Compressor Hose Reel** (I) (P) Keeps cords and hoses off the floor for a safer, more organized workspace. Mount to the ceiling or wall near common work areas. Ensure units have adequate length, retraction strength, and swivel range. Position near outlets or compressor for convenient access.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Separate Room (Lawn Equipment, Woodworking, Mancave)** (I) (L) Adds dedicated space for tools, hobbies, or relaxation without interfering with vehicle storage. Helps with dust, noise, and temperature control. Include proper lighting, outlets, and ventilation.	
☐	**Trash Can Closet** (I) (L) Keeps garbage and recycling bins out of sight while containing odors. Ideal near the garage entrance for convenience. Include ventilation and washable surfaces for easy cleaning.	
☐	**Epoxy Floor (28 Days After Concrete Finished)** (I) Durable, easy-to-clean surface ideal for garages and workshops. Wait at least 28 days after the concrete pour to allow full curing before applying epoxy. Ensure the surface is dry, clean, and properly etched for best adhesion. Two coats ensure extra smoothness and flake protection.	
☐	**Polyaspartic Floor Coating** (I) (L) A modern alternative to epoxy with similar appearance but improved performance. Cures faster, resists UV yellowing, and offers greater durability against impact and chemicals. Ideal for garages needing minimal downtime. Surface prep is still critical for proper adhesion.	
Poured Concrete (Driveway/Walkway)		
☐	**Driveway Type:** (I) ➔ *Gravel Driveway / Concrete Driveway / Asphalt Driveway / Stone Driveway* Each option varies in cost, appearance, and maintenance. Gravel is the most affordable but needs a solid base, ask for extra rock during install for better stability. Asphalt offers smooth performance, concrete is durable and low-maintenance, and stone provides a premium look with higher cost.	
☐	**Driveway Width** (I) Standard single-car driveways are about 10 feet wide, but 12–14 feet provides more comfortable clearance. Wider driveways reduce the risk of door dings.	
☐	**Driveway Turnaround Size** (I) An ideal turnaround space is about 34 feet in diameter (17-foot radius) to comfortably accommodate most vehicles.	
☐	**Concrete Driveway Cure Time & Protection** (I) Freshly poured driveways should be blocked off with cones or barriers to prevent parking during the cure period. While concrete hardens in the first few days, it takes about 28 days to fully cure, weather permitting. Early weight can cause cracking or surface damage.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Driveway Curb for Drainage** (I) (L) A slight curb or raised edge along the driveway helps direct water away from the surface and into proper drainage areas. Prevents erosion, pooling, and damage to adjacent landscaping. Best installed during the initial pour for seamless integration.	
☐	**Heated Driveway** (I) Embedded radiant heat systems melt snow and ice automatically, improving safety and eliminating the need for shoveling or salting. Can be electric or hydronic, and must be installed during the concrete pour with proper insulation and controls. A premium upgrade for cold climates.	
☐	**Heated Sidewalk** (I) Electric or hydronic heating systems can be embedded in concrete to melt snow and ice automatically. Improves safety, eliminates the need for salting or shoveling, and protects the concrete from freeze-thaw damage. Best planned during initial pour with proper insulation and controls.	
☐	**Heated Porch** (I) Radiant heating beneath a concrete porch keeps the surface clear of snow and ice in winter. Adds safety and reduces wear from salt or shoveling. Must be installed during the pour with proper insulation and thermostat control.	
☐	**Culvert Pipe Cover:** (I) → *Retaining Wall / Rocks / Landscaping* Culvert pipe ends can be hidden or blended using small retaining walls, decorative rocks, or landscaping. Improves curb appeal while protecting the pipe from erosion or damage.	
☐	**Driveway Alarm** (I) (P) (L) Sensors embedded beneath or alongside the driveway can detect vehicles or motion and trigger alerts. Useful for added security or notifications of arriving guests. Can be wired during the pour or installed later with wireless options.	
☐	**Driveway Gate:** (I) → *Driveway Pillars / Driveway Lights / Surveillance Cameras* Driveway gates can be enhanced with masonry pillars, integrated lighting, and built-in surveillance for added security and curb appeal. Plan wiring and conduit during foundation or driveway work.	
☐	**Gravel Driveway Crown** (I) (L) A properly crowned gravel driveway is higher in the center, so water drains to both sides, preventing ruts and erosion. Helps extend the life of the surface and maintain a smoother driving path.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Concrete Pads/Walkways		
☐	**Concrete Walkway Around the House** (I) (V) Keeps you off the grass, provides clean access, improves drainage, and simplifies maintenance. Also helps prevent mud buildup and should slope slightly away from the foundation.	
☐	**Extra Wide Concrete Walkways** (I) Consider widening front and side walkways to 4–6 feet for a more spacious, high-end look and improved functionality. Wider walkways create a grander approach, allow two people to walk side-by-side comfortably, and enhance curb appeal.	
☐	**Concrete Walkways: Most Direct Path** (I) Design walkways along the natural, most direct routes people will take, known as desire paths. Prevents worn-down grass and encourages consistent use.	
☐	**Additional Concrete Pads:** (I) → *Air Conditioners / Propane Tanks / Basketball Hoop / Trash Cans / Vehicle Parking* Extra pads provide stable, level surfaces for key items and help keep them off dirt or grass. Great for organizing outdoor spaces and improving drainage.	
☐	**Concrete for Future Shed** (I) Pour a slab in any location where access will be difficult after other structures or landscaping go in. Saves time later and avoids tearing up finished areas. Make sure it's level, reinforced, and sized for your future shed, with options like conduit or anchor bolts added during the pour.	
☐	**Boat Storage Parking** (I) (L) Concrete pads for boat parking should be level, reinforced, and sized to fit the full trailer footprint. Include a slight slope or drain to prevent standing water under the boat.	
☐	**Conduit Under Concrete for Future Wiring** (I) (V) (L) Installing conduit under driveways, walkways, or slabs protects wiring and allows easy access for future electrical needs like lighting, gates, or cameras. It must be planned and installed before pouring to ensure easy access and code compliance. Use durable, underground-rated materials and carefully route during site preparation.	
☐	**Concrete Stamping** (I) Stamped concrete adds texture and pattern to mimic stone, brick, or tile, giving flat surfaces a decorative finish. It's a cost-effective way to elevate patios, walkways, or driveways without using separate materials.	
☐	**Stained Concrete** (I) Available in acid-based or water-based options, it enhances patios, porches, and interior floors. Works best on clean, unsealed concrete and can be combined with stamping for added effect.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Concrete Drains:** (I) → *Porches / Garage Floor / Garage Entry / Driveway* Drains help manage water runoff in key areas like covered porches, garage floors, and where the driveway meets the garage. Prevents pooling, slipping hazards, and water intrusion.	
☐	**In-Concrete Lighting** (I) Recessed lights embedded in walkways, driveways, or pads enhance safety and add a custom look. Ideal for illuminating paths, edges, or architectural features. Must be planned before the pour with conduit and proper wiring in place.	
☐	**Expansion or Control Joints** (I) (L) Control joints are cut, usually within 6–12 hours after pouring, to prevent random cracking as concrete cures. These planned weak points let the slab expand, contract, and settle safely. Proper spacing ensures long-term durability.	
☐	**Proper Ground Prep for Concrete** (I) (V) Concrete should never be poured directly on grass, as it can lead to poor curing and uneven settling. A plastic moisture barrier should be laid down first to prevent water loss and ground contamination.	
☐	**Seal Concrete (After Curing)** (I) Seal concrete about 28 days after pouring to protect against stains and wear, especially in driveways. Skip sealing if you plan to apply epoxy later, as it can affect adhesion. Reapply every few years for continued protection.	
Exterior Items		
Landscaping		
☐	**Exterior HVAC Pipe Covers** (I) (P) Pipe covers protect and conceal HVAC refrigerant lines, providing a clean, finished look while shielding pipes from weather and physical damage. Plan installation early to coordinate with HVAC setup.	
☐	**Underground Gutter Drains** (I) (V) Connect downspouts to underground PVC or SDR piping, which offers better durability than corrugated alternatives, to efficiently channel rainwater away from the foundation.	
☐	**Water Feature** (I) Adds visual interest and tranquility to landscaping with elements like fountains, ponds, or waterfalls. Requires planning for water supply, drainage, and electrical needs.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Drip Irrigation to Porch Plant Pots** (I) Provides efficient, targeted watering to plant pots on the porch via drip irrigation, minimizing water waste. Includes a built-in drain line to prevent water buildup and protect porch surfaces.	
☐	**Drip Irrigation to Plants** (I) Delivers water directly to plant roots through a network of tubing and emitters, conserving water and promoting healthy growth. Ideal for gardens and landscaping.	
☐	**Landscape Border Type:** (I) → *Cement Border / Brick Border / Other Border* Choose from cement, brick, or other materials for landscape borders to define garden beds, walkways, or patios. Cement offers durability, brick adds classic charm, and alternatives like stone or metal provide varied aesthetics. Consider style, maintenance, and installation ease.	
☐	**Video Record Sprinkler Line Locations During Installation** (I) Recording sprinkler line placements during installation provides a valuable reference for future repairs, upgrades, or landscaping changes.	
☐	**Landscape Lighting** (I) Provides safety, security, and ambiance by illuminating pathways, patios, and landscaping features. Options include low-voltage LED, solar, and motion-sensor lights.	
☐	**Landscape Fabric (Consider Commercial Grade)** (I) Commercial-grade landscape fabric helps control weeds while allowing water and air to pass through. Durable and long-lasting, it's ideal for heavy-use garden beds and professional landscaping.	
☐	**Landscape Bed Material:** (I) → *Rock Cover / Mulch Cover / Pinestraw Cover / Bark Cover* Rocks offer durability and low maintenance; mulch and bark improve soil moisture and add organic matter; pine straw is lightweight and easy to spread. Consider aesthetics, upkeep, and cost.	
☐	**Sprinklers** (I) Identify all landscaping and lawn areas requiring irrigation coverage to ensure efficient water distribution. Plan sprinkler types, zones, and placement to avoid dry spots or overwatering.	
☐	**Grass Type** (I) Select grass based on daily sun exposure, as sun and shade tolerance greatly impact growth and health. Research which grass varieties thrive in your region's climate to ensure a lush, durable lawn suited to local conditions.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Wi-Fi Sprinkler Controller** (I) A Wi-Fi-enabled sprinkler controller allows remote scheduling and monitoring of irrigation systems via smartphone or computer. Enhances water efficiency by adjusting to weather conditions and user preferences.	
☐	**Fencing Location and Type** (I) Determine fencing placement and select materials, wood, vinyl, metal, or composite, based on privacy, security, and aesthetic needs. Consider local regulations and property lines.	
☐	**French Drains in all Low-Lying Areas** (I) Install in all low-lying spots to prevent water pooling and manage drainage effectively. These trenches filled with gravel and perforated piping redirect water away from foundations and yards.	
☐	**Fence Gates on Opposing Sides of Yard** (I) Installing gates on opposite sides of the yard improves access and flow for foot traffic, lawn care, and emergency exits. Plan gate size and location to align with pathways and ensure security.	
☐	**Artificial Turf Under Swing Sets** (I) Installing artificial turf beneath swing sets prevents grass damage and muddy spots, creating a durable, low-maintenance play area. Ideal for high-traffic zones and safer footing.	
☐	**No Plants or Trees Near Sewer Line** (I) Roots can invade and damage sewer pipes, so avoid planting trees or large shrubs near sewer lines. Keep landscaping clear to protect underground infrastructure and prevent costly repairs.	
☐	**Ensure Adequate Drainage After Final Grade** (I) Confirm proper drainage before sod installation by checking for water-collecting areas. Notify the builder of any low spots to prevent pooling and potential damage. Early correction ensures a healthy lawn and prevents future issues.	
☐	**Remove All Trash Before Final Grade** (I) Ensure all construction debris is cleared before final grading, as leftover trash can become buried and cause future landscaping problems. Early cleanup prevents damage to soil quality and improves final appearance.	
Exterior Lighting		
☐	**In-Concrete Lighting** (I) Lighting fixtures embedded in concrete surfaces highlight pathways, driveways, or patios with a sleek, modern look. Durable and low-profile, they provide safe nighttime illumination but require early installation before concrete pouring.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**String Lights** (I) Adds warm, decorative ambiance to outdoor spaces like patios, decks, or gardens. Easy to install and flexible in design, they create inviting atmospheres for entertaining. Plan power sources and secure mounting points before installation.	
☐	**Flood Lights** (I) Provides bright, wide-area illumination for security and safety around driveways, yards, and building exteriors. Options include motion-activated or dusk-to-dawn sensors for energy efficiency. Plan placement to avoid glare and ensure coverage.	
☐	**Step Lighting** (I) Step lighting enhances safety by illuminating stair treads and walkways with low-level, glare-free light. Often recessed or surface-mounted, these fixtures add subtle ambiance and prevent trips or falls.	
☐	**Tree Lighting** (I) Highlights landscaping features and adds nighttime ambiance using uplights or string lights wrapped around trunks and branches. Enhances curb appeal and outdoor enjoyment. Plan for power access and fixture placements.	
☐	**Smart Landscape Lighting Transformer** (I) Powers low-voltage landscape lighting with programmable controls, allowing remote scheduling, dimming, and energy savings. Integrates with home automation systems for convenient operation.	
☐	**Landscape Lighting (Spotlights, Garden, Bollard)** (I) Used to accent architectural features and trees, creating depth and drama. Garden lights softly illuminate plantings, while bollard lights provide pathway safety and style. Plan fixture types and placement for balanced coverage.	
☐	**Front Porch Gas Lanterns** (I) (L) Adds classic charm and warm, flickering light to front porches. They require a gas line connection and proper ventilation. Consider style, placement, and local codes when installing for both ambiance and safety.	
☐	**Exterior Wall Lighting (Up/Downlighting)** (I) Casts light both above and below, highlighting architectural details while providing ambient illumination. Ideal for enhancing curb appeal and improving nighttime visibility. Plan placement and wiring early.	
☐	**Under Soffit Lighting** (I) This lighting provides subtle, downward illumination on walkways, patios, and exterior walls. Enhances safety and highlights architectural features with a clean, integrated look. Plan wiring and fixture placement during construction.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
Outdoor Entertaining		
☐	**Built-In Grill** (I) Offers a permanent, seamless cooking station integrated into outdoor kitchens or patios. Provides durability, ample cooking space, and a polished look. Plan gas, electrical connections, and ventilation early for safe, efficient use.	
☐	**Outdoor Kitchen** (I) Combines cooking appliances, countertops, sinks, and storage to create a fully functional space for entertaining. Plan plumbing, electrical, and gas hookups early for seamless integration.	
☐	**Outdoor Heaters and Fans** (I) Consider wind patterns and seating layout to optimize heater and fan placement. Use weather-resistant, energy-efficient models with adjustable settings. Plan for safe clearance from flammable materials and ensure electrical outlets are rated for outdoor use.	
☐	**Outdoor Fireplace/Pit** (I) (L) Consider fuel type (wood, gas, propane) for ease of use and maintenance. Ensure proper ventilation and safe clearance from structures and landscaping. Plan seating arrangements to maximize heat distribution and social interaction.	
☐	**Retractable Sun/Bug Screens** (I) These offer flexible protection from sun and insects, retracting when not in use for unobstructed views. Consider motorized options for ease of use and durability. Plan mounting space, wiring (if motorized), and weather exposure during installation. Choose materials that balance visibility and UV protection.	
Miscellaneous		
Wi-Fi Enabled Upgrades		
☐	**Water Main Monitor Automatic Shut-Off** (I) (P) Monitors water flow in real-time and automatically shuts off the main supply if leaks or unusual activity are detected. Receive instant alerts on your phone to prevent water damage and costly repairs.	
☐	**Landscape Light Transformer** (I) A smart transformer that powers and controls outdoor lighting, allowing you to adjust brightness and schedules remotely. Enhances energy efficiency and adds convenience to landscape lighting management.	
☐	**Garage Door Opener** (I) Allows remote control and monitoring of your garage door via smartphone apps. Receive alerts if left open and control access securely from anywhere, enhancing convenience and home security.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Sprinkler Control** (I) Automate and manage your irrigation system remotely using smartphone apps. Adjust watering schedules based on weather conditions and save water with smart sensors and zone-specific controls.	
☐	**Individual Room HVAC Sensors** (I) These sensors monitor temperature and occupancy in each room to optimize heating and cooling. They allow remote adjustments and can improve comfort while reducing energy costs by directing HVAC only where needed.	
☐	**Electrical Panel** (I) (L) An advanced panel that provides real-time monitoring of your home's electrical usage and alerts for potential issues. From your smartphone, you can remotely turn individual breakers on or off.	
☐	**Thermostat** (I) Allows remote control of your home's heating and cooling system via smartphone. Features include scheduling, learning preferences, and energy-saving modes to maximize comfort and reduce utility bills.	
☐	**Doorbell** (I) Most video doorbells run on Wi-Fi, but if you want faster response and more reliable, higher-quality video, consider a PoE setup.	
☐	**Deadbolt** (I) A smart lock that lets you lock and unlock your door remotely via smartphone. Features often include keyless entry, temporary access codes for guests, and real-time activity notifications for enhanced security.	
☐	**Oven** (I) Allows remote monitoring and control of cooking settings through a smartphone app. Features may include preheating alerts, recipe guidance, and safety notifications.	
Pets		
☐	**Built-In Litter Box Inside Cabinet (Optional Kitty Fart Fan)** (I) (L) A discreet, enclosed litter box integrated into cabinetry to keep your home tidy and odors contained. The optional ventilation fan helps eliminate unpleasant smells, improving air quality and comfort.	
☐	**Automatic Dog Door** (I) (P) A motorized door that allows your dog to enter and exit freely, often activated by a collar sensor or smartphone control.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Exterior Automatic Water Bowl** (I) (P) A self-refilling water bowl designed for outdoor use that ensures your pet always has fresh water. Often includes sensors to detect water levels and can be controlled or monitored remotely.	
☐	**Pet Bowl Wall Niche with Drain** (I) (L) A recessed area in the wall designed to hold pet bowls securely, featuring a built-in faucet and drain to make cleaning easy and prevent water damage or messes on the floor.	
☐	**Pet Water Faucet or Pot Filler Location** (I) A dedicated low-height faucet or pot filler designed to provide easy access to fresh water for pets. Convenient for refilling bowls or washing pets without bending or lifting.	
☐	**Pet Washing Station** (I) (V) A specially designed sink or tub area for washing pets conveniently indoors. Features include easy-to-clean surfaces, integrated sprayers, and comfortable height to reduce strain during bath time.	
☐	**Retractable Dog Gate** (I) (L) A space-saving, retractable gate that provides a secure barrier for pets without bulky frames. Easily extends and retracts to block doorways or hallways, offering flexible containment and quick access.	
☐	**Pet Ramp Along Stairs** (I) (V) Add a built-in pet ramp along stairs to help small or aging pets move safely between levels. Plan during framing to integrate it properly with stair width and railing design.	
Design		
☐	**Hidden Room** (I) (L) A concealed space designed for privacy, security, or unique functionality. Often accessed through disguised doors or panels, it adds intrigue and can serve as a safe room, office, or personal retreat.	
☐	**Wine Storage** (I) Dedicated areas or cabinetry designed to store wine bottles at optimal temperature and humidity. Options range from built-in racks to climate-controlled wine rooms.	
☐	**Central Vacuum System** (I) Features a collection canister usually in the garage or basement, with PVC tubing to wall suction points or retractable hoses in the living areas. Benefits include no exhaust dust/smell recirculation, more power, quieter operation, and longer life compared to portable vacuums. Tubing should be installed before insulation, but after plumbing and ductwork. Electrician should plan for a dedicated outlet at the canister location.	

	Checklist Items	Notes
☐	**Safe Room for Severe Weather** (I) (P) A reinforced, secure space designed to protect occupants during storms or tornadoes. Built with strong materials and equipped with emergency supplies.	
☐	**Coffee Bar in Primary Bathroom or Pantry** (I) A dedicated area equipped with coffee-making appliances and storage, offering convenience and luxury. Ideal for quick morning routines or entertaining.	
☐	**Alternate Interior Wall Textures (Brick, Stucco, Shiplap, Etc.)** (I) Incorporating varied wall textures adds depth and character to interior spaces.	
☐	**Utility Room with Recessed Floor (Emergency Drainage)** (I) Designed with a lowered floor area to contain water leaks or spills. Equipped with a drain, it helps prevent water damage by directing excess water safely away from living areas.	
☐	**Murphy Bed** (I) (L) A space-saving bed that folds vertically into a wall or cabinet when not in use. Ideal for multifunctional rooms, it maximizes floor space without sacrificing comfort.	

Your Lists

Extra workspace for whatever you want to track

USE THIS FOR ADDITIONAL LISTS

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selections

Door Count

Tally every door by location and type

✓	Location	Doors	Pocket	Sliders	Other	Notes
	Exterior					
	Entryway					
	Living Room					
	Kitchen					
	Pantry					
	Butler ’ s Pantry					
	Dining					
	Breakfast					
	Powder Room					
	Primary Bedroom					
	Primary Bath					
	Bedroom 2					
	Bathroom 2					
	Bedroom 3					
	Bathroom 3					
	Bedroom 4					
	Bathroom 4					
	Closets					
	Garage					
	Laundry					
	Hallway(s)					
	Study / Office					
	Media Room					
	Game Room					
	Storage Closet(s)					
	TOTALS					

Window Count

Tally every window by location and size

✓	Location	Size 1	Size 2	Size 3	Other	Notes
	Entryway					
	Living Room					
	Kitchen					
	Pantry					
	Dining					
	Powder Room					
	Breakfast					
	Primary Bedroom					
	Primary Bath					
	Bedroom 2					
	Bathroom 2					
	Bedroom 3					
	Bathroom 3					
	Bedroom 4					
	Bathroom 4					
	Closets					
	Garage					
	Laundry					
	Hallway(s)					
	Study / Office					
	Media Room					
	Game Room					
	TOTALS					

Light Fixtures and Fan Count

Tally every light and fan by location and type

✓	Location	Can Light	Canless	Fixtures	Fans	Notes
	Exterior					
	Entryway					
	Living Room					
	Kitchen					
	Pantry					
	Dining					
	Powder Room					
	Breakfast					
	Primary Bedroom					
	Primary Bath					
	Bedroom 2					
	Bathroom 2					
	Bedroom 3					
	Bathroom 3					
	Bedroom 4					
	Bathroom 4					
	Closets					
	Garage					
	Laundry					
	Hallway(s)					
	Study / Office					
	Media Room					
	Game Room					
	TOTALS					

QUICK FAVOR... 🙏

If this checklist helped with planning your build, please leave me a review.
It means more than you know!

Checklist Bundle Review →   Just the Checklist Review →

A picture or video would be incredible but definitely not required!

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This checklist is a product of our amazing home building community of Homeowners, Contractors, and Builders! Please send me your suggestions and feedback so I can continue to improve and make this the most valuable resource for homeowners building a new construction home.

Email: Contact@BuilderBrigade.com